



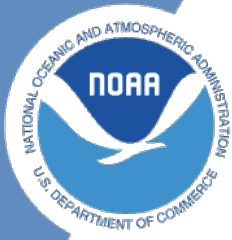
NOAA Technical Memorandum NMFS-XXX-##

Analyses to support the Dolphinfish Management Strategy Evaluation in the U.S. Atlantic

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Northwest Fisheries Science Center



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FISHERIES**

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1 Introduction

Here we will be displaying various data summaries and analyses related to dolphin management in the U.S. South Atlantic.

1.1 Details

The documentation of this data exploration was developed in R, using R Studio and Quarto.

2 Defining the regions for the operating model

Here we define the different regions to be used in the operating model, based on the areas that were defined in the industry working groups. The operating model is intended to encompass the Western Central Atlantic dolphin population and include international waters (FAO areas 21 and 31) which are thought to be connected with the stock that is exploited by U.S. fisheries.

We use the U.S. exclusive economic zone (EEZ) to differentiate between national and international waters. Note that some U.S. commercial activity occurs in high seas waters and we will account for those catches in the summaries.

2.1 Data download for the U.S. EEZ

We download the U.S. Atlantic EEZ from Marineregions.org.

```
# clear workspace and load the libraries
if (!requireNamespace("maps", quietly = TRUE)) {
  install.packages("maps") }
library(maps)

rm(list = ls())

# read in the shapefile downloaded from Marineregions.org
#library(sf)
#shp_data <- st_read("data/eez/eez.shp")
#coords <- st_coordinates(shp_data)
#co <- as.data.frame(coords)
#save(co, file = "data/eez/Marineregions_EEZ.RData")

load("data/eez/Marineregions_EEZ.RData")
head(co)
```

2 Defining the regions for the operating model

	X	Y	L1	L2	L3
1	-67.28403	45.19125	1	1	1
2	-67.28400	45.19126	1	1	1
3	-67.28387	45.19125	1	1	1
4	-67.28383	45.19125	1	1	1
5	-67.28372	45.19125	1	1	1
6	-67.28365	45.19125	1	1	1

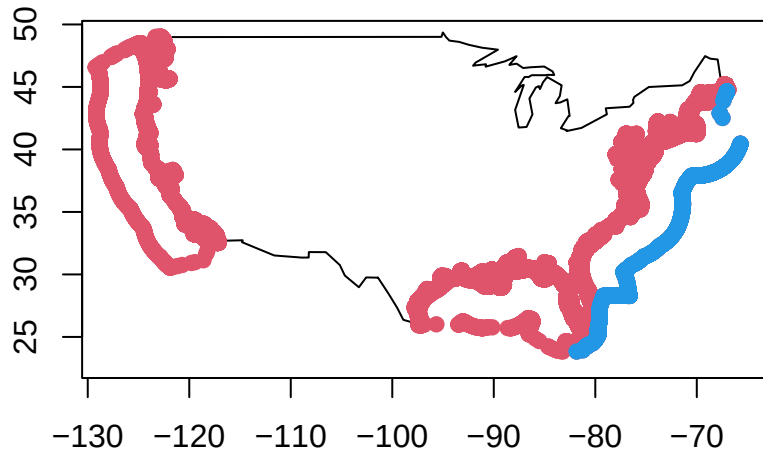
```
map("usa", xlim = c(-130, -63), ylim = c(22, 50))
axis(1); axis(2); box()
points(co$X, co$Y, pch = 19, col = 2)

# remove points that are not in the U.S. South Atlantic
co <- co[which(co$X > (-82)), ]
co <- co[-which(co$X < (-81) & co$Y > 25 & co$Y < 28), ]

#plot(co$X, co$Y, col = 0)
#text(co$X, co$Y, 1:nrow(co), cex = 0.7)
#plot(co$X, co$Y, col = 0, xlim = c(-85, -80), ylim = c(22, 25))
#text(co$X, co$Y, 1:nrow(co), cex = 0.7)

# identify the northernmost and southernmost points along the Atlantic EEZ
co1 <- co[2100:3727, ]
points(co1$X, co1$Y, col = 4, pch = 19)
```

2 Defining the regions for the operating model



2.2 Construct the U.S. EEZ

We simplify the shapefile along the U.S. coast in order to simplify computations later in the process.

```
# subset points N and S of 35N for later delineation
co2 <- co[-c(2100:3727), ]
co3 <- co2[which(co2$Y > 35), ]
co4 <- co2[which(co2$Y <= 35), ]

# reduce number of points along the coast to make computation easier
co3 <- co3[seq(1, nrow(co3), 1100), ]
co4 <- co4[seq(1, nrow(co4), 800), ]

map("usa", xlim = c(-100, -60), ylim = c(23, 50))
mtext(side = 1, "degrees W", line = 2); mtext(side = 2, "degrees N", line = 3)
mtext(side = 1, "degrees W", line = 2); mtext(side = 2, "degrees N", line = 3)
axis(1); axis(2); box()
points(co3$X, co3$Y, col = 2, pch = 19)
```

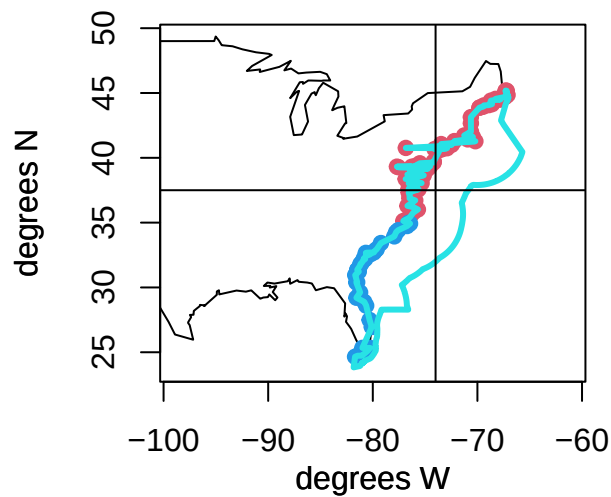
2 Defining the regions for the operating model

```
points(co4$X, co4$Y, col = 4, pch = 19)

co2 <- rbind(co3, co4)
co2 <- co2[order(co2$Y), ]
cofin <- rbind(co1, co2)

polygon(cofin$X, cofin$Y, border = 5, lwd = 3)

# make the polygon along the coast line a bit more linear
abline(h = 37.5)
abline(v = -74)
```

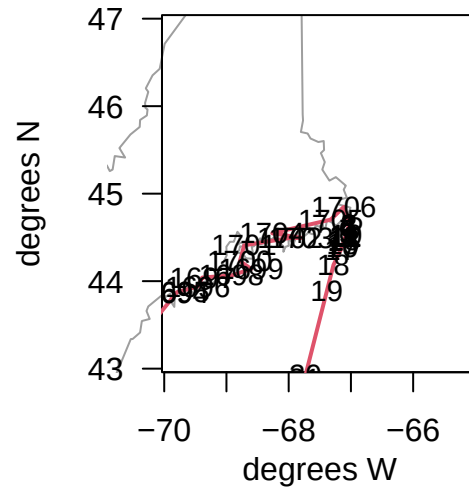


```
cofin <- cofin[-which(cofin$X < (-74) & cofin$Y > 37.6), ]
#text(cofin$X, cofin$Y, 1:nrow(cofin), cex = 0.9)
lis <- c(1634, 1639, 1688, 1710, 1711, 1712)
cofin <- cofin[-lis, ]

map(database = "usa", xlim = c(-70, -65), ylim = c(43, 47), col = 8)
mtext(side = 1, "degrees W", line = 2); mtext(side = 2, "degrees N", line = 3)
axis(1); axis(2, las = 2); box()
```

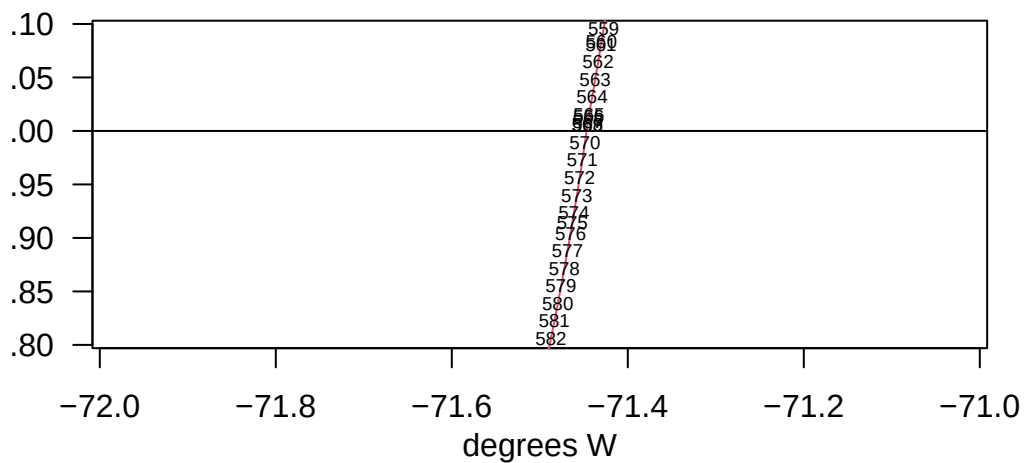
2 Defining the regions for the operating model

```
polygon(cofin$X, cofin$Y, border = 2, lwd = 2)
text(cofin$X, cofin$Y, 1:nrow(cofin), cex = 0.9)
```



```
map(database = "usa", xlim = c(-72, -71), ylim = c(34.8, 35.1))
mtext(side = 1, "degrees W", line = 2); mtext(side = 2, "degrees N", line = 3)
axis(1); axis(2, las = 2); box()
polygon(cofin$X, cofin$Y, border = 2)
text(cofin$X, cofin$Y, 1:nrow(cofin), cex = 0.6)
abline(h=35)
abline(v = -60)
```

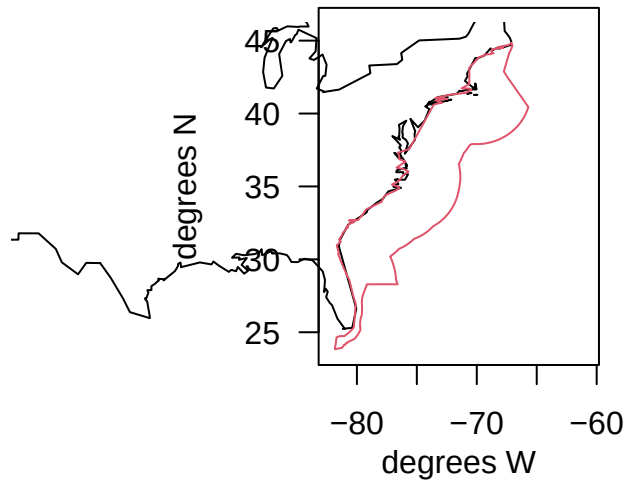
2 Defining the regions for the operating model



```
cofin <- cofin[, 1:2]

map(database = "usa", xlim = c(-83, -60), ylim = c(23, 47), col = 0)
map(database = "usa", xlim = c(-83, -60), ylim = c(23, 47), add = T)
mtext(side = 1, "degrees W", line = 2); mtext(side = 2, "degrees N", line = 3)
axis(1); axis(2, las = 2); box()
polygon(cofin$X, cofin$Y, border = 2)
```

2 Defining the regions for the operating model



```
# change the southernmost tip to exactly 24N so that it aligns with Caribbean polygon
cofin <- cofin[~which(cofin$Y < 24), ]
cofin[1624, 2] <- 24

USeez <- cofin
#write.csv(USeez, file = "eez.csv")
```

Here is a final U.S. South Atlantic EEZ polygon, with a simplified coastline to reduce computational time when subsetting data points.

2.3 Define the Caribbean region

Now we define the boundaries of the Caribbean region. Its northernmost boundary aligns with the EEZ along Florida's coast up to 28.3 degrees N, at which point the boundary cuts southeast until it intersects with the 24N boundary just east of the Bahamas, approximating the Bahamas EEZ. Its western boundary is -90 degrees W and its southern boundary is 8 degrees N (essentially the land boundary of the Caribbean Sea). Its eastern boundary is -71.1 degrees W.

2 Defining the regions for the operating model

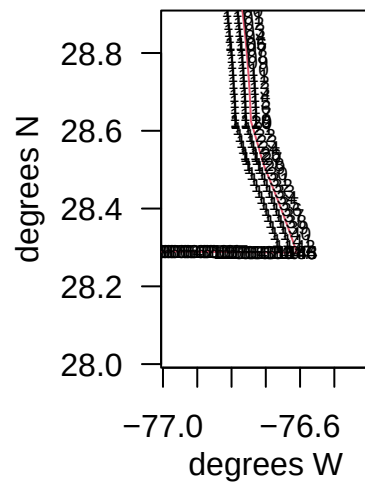
```
which.min(cofin$Y)
```

```
[1] 1624
```

```
cofin[1624, ]
```

```
      X      Y  
3723 -81.16148 24
```

```
map(database = "usa", xlim = c(-77, -76.4), ylim = c(28, 28.9))  
mtext(side = 1, "degrees W", line = 2); mtext(side = 2, "degrees N", line = 3)  
axis(1); axis(2, las = 2); box()  
polygon(cofin$X, cofin$Y, border = 2)  
text(cofin$X, cofin$Y, 1:nrow(cofin), cex = 0.6)
```

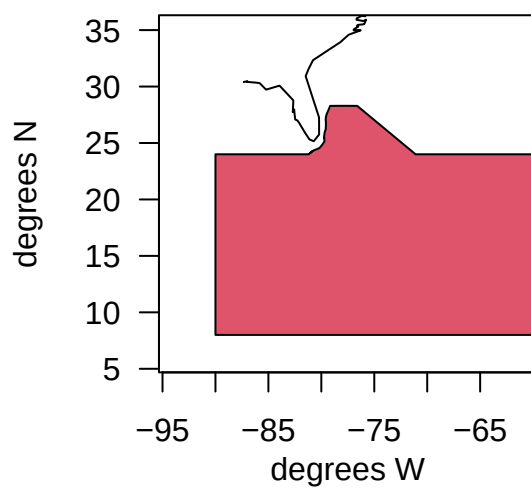


```
car1 <- cofin[1143:1624, ]  
car2 <- data.frame(cbind(c(-90, -90, -60, -60, -71.1), c(24, 8, 8, 24, 24)))  
names(car2) <- c("X", "Y")  
CAR <- rbind(car1, car2)
```

2 Defining the regions for the operating model

```
names(CAR) <- c("X", "Y")

map(database = "usa", xlim = c(-95, -60), ylim = c(5, 36))
mtext(side = 1, "degrees W", line = 2); mtext(side = 2, "degrees N", line = 3)
axis(1); axis(2, las = 2); box()
polygon(CAR$X, CAR$Y, col = 2)
```



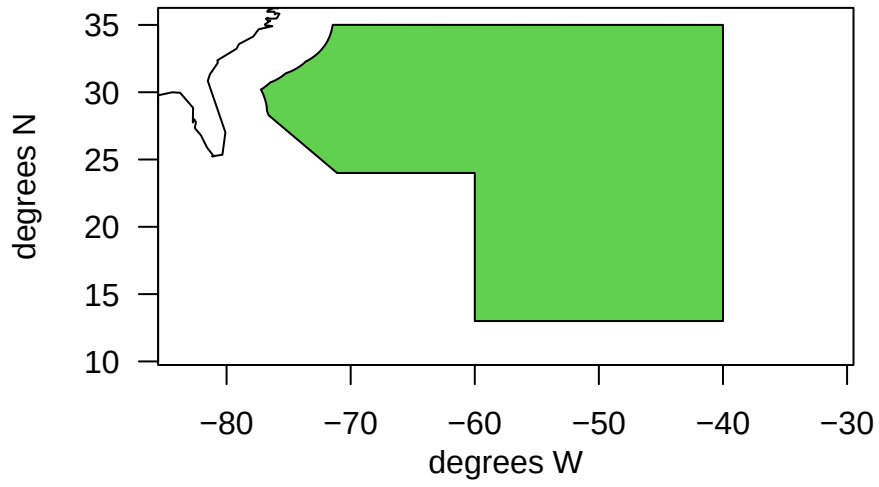
3 Define the NCA region

The North Central Atlantic (NCA) region, otherwise known as the Western Central Atlantic, is defined according to the boundaries of FAO area 31, but excluding the U.S. EEZ and Caribbean territorial seas to the West.

```
nca1 <- cofin[569:1143, ] # subset points along EEZ
nca2 <- data.frame(cbind(c(-71.1, -60, -60, -40, -40), c(24, 24, 13, 13, 35))) # define bou
names(nca2) <- c("X", "Y")
NCA <- rbind(nca1, nca2)
names(NCA) <- c("X", "Y")

map(database = "usa", xlim = c(-85, -30), ylim = c(10, 36))
mtext(side = 1, "degrees W", line = 2); mtext(side = 2, "degrees N", line = 3)
axis(1); axis(2, las = 2); box()
polygon(NCA$X, NCA$Y, col = 3)
```

3 Define the NCA region



4 Define the NED region

The Northeast Distant Waters (NED) region, otherwise known as the Northwestern Atlantic, is defined according to the boundaries of FAO area 21, but excluding the U.S. EEZ territorial seas to the West. It does include Canadian and French territorial EEZs. The northern boundary is 60 degrees north, as dolphin are not caught above this latitude.

```
which.max(cofin$Y) # find northernmost point of U.S. EEZ
```

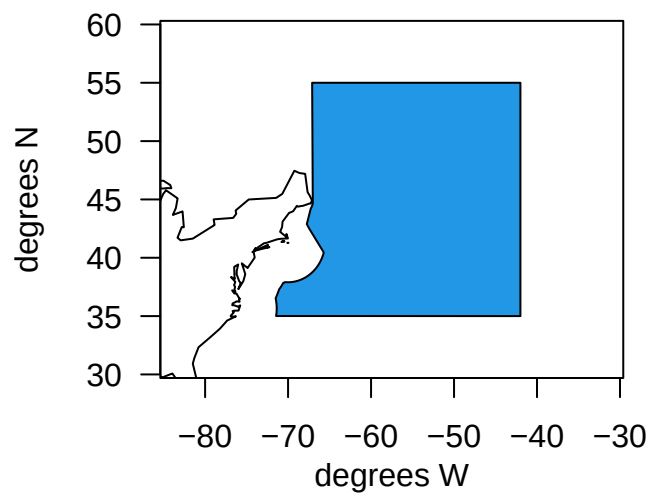
```
[1] 1702
```

```
cofin[1702, ]
```

```
      X      Y  
77844 -67.11553 44.84764
```

```
ned1 <- cofin[1:569, ] # subset points along EEZ  
ned2 <- data.frame(cbind(c(-42, -42, -67.1), c(35, 55, 55))) # define boundaries according  
names(ned2) <- c("X", "Y")  
NED <- rbind(ned1, ned2)  
names(NED) <- c("X", "Y")  
  
map(database = "usa", xlim = c(-85, -30), ylim = c(30, 60))  
mtext(side = 1, "degrees W", line = 2); mtext(side = 2, "degrees N", line = 3)  
axis(1); axis(2, las = 2); box()  
polygon(NED$X, NED$Y, col = 4)
```

4 Define the NED region



5 Define the Florida Keys region

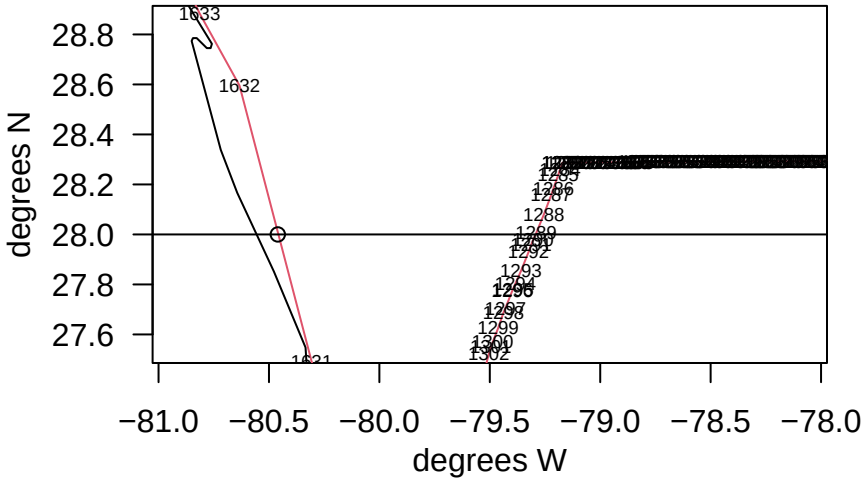
The southernmost region of the U.S. EEZ is called the FLK region, and includes waters within the EEZ boundary, north up to 28 degrees N. The boundary of 28N is chosen because it aligns with commercial logbook reporting boundaries and aligns roughly with the Brevard - Indian River County border. This is convenient because U.S. recreational statistics are summarized as groups of counties, with SE FL encompassing Miami-Dade to Indian River County and NE FL encompassing Brevard to Nassau County.

```
which.min(abs(co1$Y - 28)) # find the southernmost point
```

```
[1] 1289
```

```
map(database = "usa", xlim = c(-81, -78), ylim = c(27.5, 28.9))
mtext(side = 1, "degrees W", line = 2); mtext(side = 2, "degrees N", line = 3)
axis(1); axis(2, las = 2); box()
polygon(cofin$X, cofin$Y, border = 2)
text(cofin$X, cofin$Y, 1:nrow(cofin), cex = 0.6) # find points falling at 28N
points(-80.46, 28)
cofin[1632, ] <- c(-80.46, 28)
abline(h = 28)
```

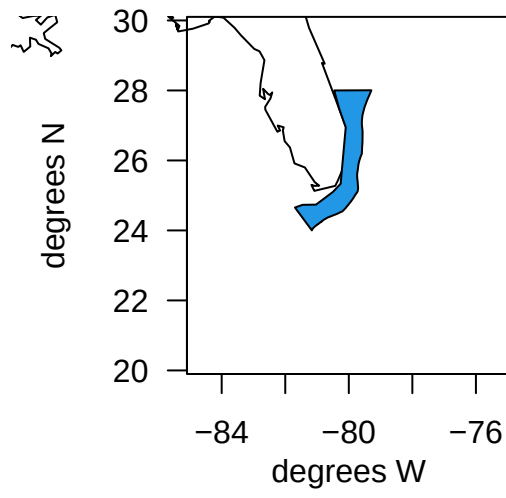
5 Define the Florida Keys region



```
FLK <- cofin[1289:1632, ] # subset points along EEZ

map(database = "usa", xlim = c(-85, -75), ylim = c(20, 30))
mtext(side = 1, "degrees W", line = 2); mtext(side = 2, "degrees N", line = 3)
axis(1); axis(2, las = 2); box()
polygon(FLK$X, FLK$Y, col = 4)
```

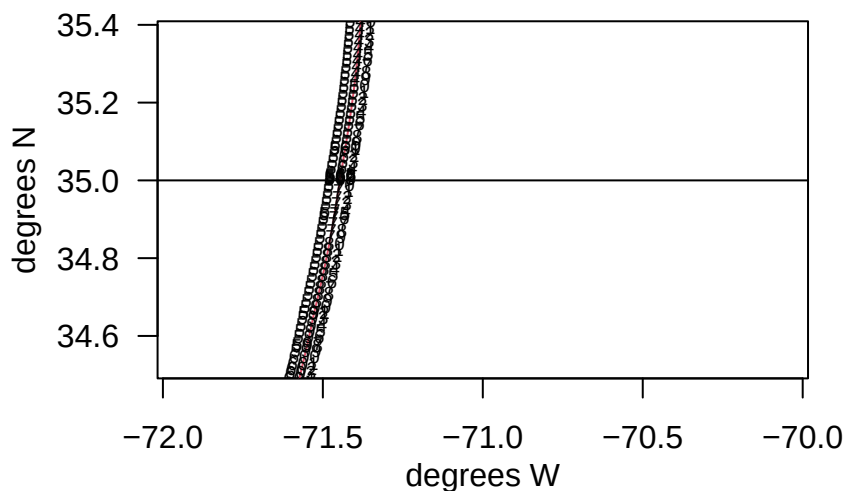
5 Define the Florida Keys region



6 Define the North Florida - South NC region

The second area that was decided upon to be defined within the operating model was northern Florida to Southern North Carolina. We form a boundary at 35 degrees north because this is the delineation between the NED and NCA regions. Also, 35N is just south of Cape Hatteras, which is a boundary for NMFS recreational data collection, as well as a boundary of commercial logbook data reporting. Therefore, all sources of data (international, U.S. commercial, and U.S. recreational) can be easily parsed along this boundary.

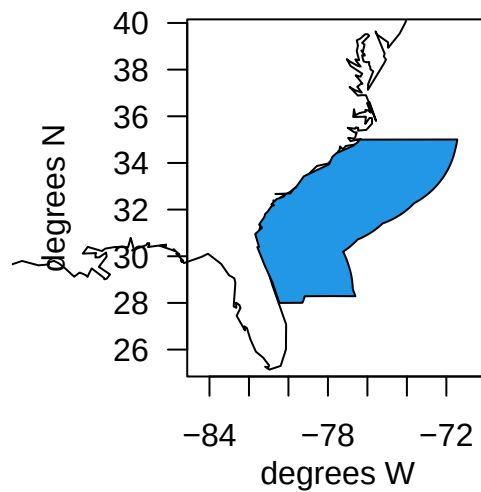
```
map(database = "usa", xlim = c(-72, -70), ylim = c(34.5, 35.4))
mtext(side = 1, "degrees W", line = 2); mtext(side = 2, "degrees N", line = 3)
axis(1); axis(2, las = 2); box()
polygon(cofin$X, cofin$Y, border = 2)
text(cofin$X, cofin$Y, 1:nrow(cofin), cex = 0.6) # find points that fall at 35N
abline(h = 35)
```



6 Define the North Florida - South NC region

```
cofin[1663, 2] <- 35
NCFL <- rbind(cofin[1632:1663, ], cofin[569:1289, ]) # subset along EEZ

map(database = "usa", xlim = c(-85, -70), ylim = c(25, 40))
mtext(side = 1, "degrees W", line = 2); mtext(side = 2, "degrees N", line = 3)
axis(1); axis(2, las = 2); box()
polygon(NCFL$X, NCFL$Y, col = 4)
```

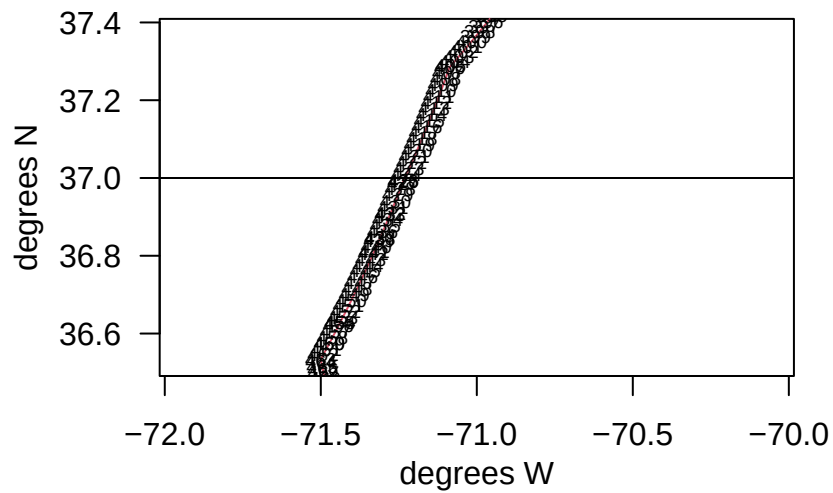


7 Define the northern North Carolina region

The third U.S. area that was decided upon to be defined within the operating model was northern North Carolina, which was intended to encompass the northern part of the state up to the Virginia border. We form a boundary at 37 degrees north because this is a boundary for commercial logbook data reporting and roughly aligns with the latitude of the state boundary between North Carolina and Virginia. Note there is a slight misalignment between this boundary and the way that U.S. recreational statistics are reported (by state), so the commercial and recreational data will be subset along slightly different boundaries for this region.

```
map(database = "usa", xlim = c(-72, -70), ylim = c(36.5, 37.4))
mtext(side = 1, "degrees W", line = 2); mtext(side = 2, "degrees N", line = 3)
axis(1); axis(2, las = 2); box()
polygon(cofin$X, cofin$Y, border = 2)
text(cofin$X, cofin$Y, 1:nrow(cofin), cex = 0.6)
abline(h = 37)
```

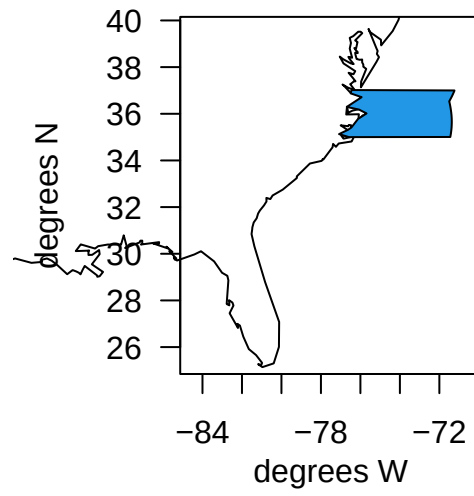
7 Define the northern North Carolina region



```
cofin[425, 2] <- 37
NNC <- rbind(cofin[1663:1673, ], cofin[425:569, ])

map(database = "usa", xlim = c(-85, -70), ylim = c(25, 40))
mtext(side = 1, "degrees W", line = 2); mtext(side = 2, "degrees N", line = 3)
axis(1); axis(2, las = 2); box()
polygon(NNC$X, NNC$Y, col = 4)
```

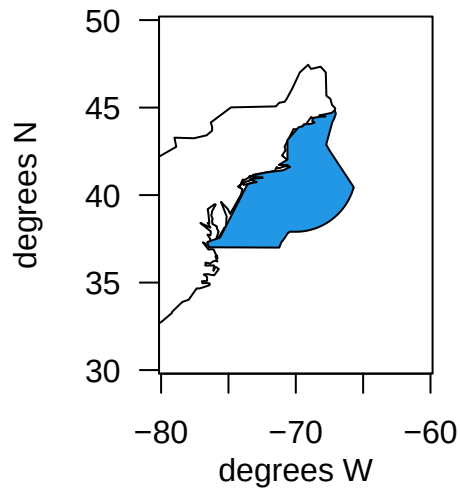
7 Define the northern North Carolina region



8 Define the Virginia and north region

The fourth region within the U.S. EEZ is the remainder of the area, which encompasses national waters from Virginia up to Maine.

```
VBM <- rbind(cofin[1673:1702, ], cofin[1:425, ])  
  
map(database = "usa", xlim = c(-80, -60), ylim = c(30, 50))  
mtext(side = 1, "degrees W", line = 2); mtext(side = 2, "degrees N", line = 3)  
axis(1); axis(2, las = 2); box()  
polygon(VBM$X, VBM$Y, col = 4)
```



8.1 Plot all of the regions

Now we will put all of the regions on a single map and check that the boundaries align.

```
png(filename = "data/eez/new_spatial_zones1.png", width= 800, height = 900)

map(database = "world", xlim = c(-92, -38), ylim = c(5, 55), col = 8)
mtext(side = 1, "degrees W", line = 2); mtext(side = 2, "degrees N", line = 3)
axis(1); axis(2, las = 2); box()

polygon(CAR$X, CAR$Y, border = 1)
polygon(NCA$X, NCA$Y, border = 1)
polygon(NED$X, NED$Y, border = 1)
polygon(FLK$X, FLK$Y, border = 1)
polygon(NCFL$X, NCFL$Y, border = 1)
polygon(NNC$X, NNC$Y, border = 1)
polygon(VBM$X, VBM$Y, border = 1)

map(database = "world", add = T, col = 8, lwd = 2)

text(-75, 15, "CAR", cex = 1.2)
text(-57, 28, "NCA", cex = 1.2)
text(-57, 42, "NED", cex = 1.2)
text(mean(FLK$X), mean(FLK$Y), "FLK", cex = 1.2)
text(-79.3, mean(NCFL$Y), "NCFL", cex = 1.2)
text(-73.8, mean(NNC$Y), "NNC", cex = 1.2)
text(-71.5, mean(VBM$Y), "VBM", cex = 1.2)

dev.off()
```

pdf

2

```
#class(CAR)

CAR$region <- "CAR"
FLK$region <- "FLK"
NCFL$region <- "NCFL"
```

8 Define the Virginia and north region

```
NNC$region <- "NNC"
VBM$region <- "VBM"
NCA$region <- "NCA"
NED$region <- "NED"

zones <- rbind(FLK, NCFL, NNC, VBM, NED, NCA, CAR)

# plot(zones$X, zones$Y, col = as.numeric(as.factor(zones$region)))

# output the coordinates to a .csv file
write.csv(zones, file = "data/eez/dolphin_OM_areas.csv", row.names = FALSE)
```

8 Define the Virginia and north region

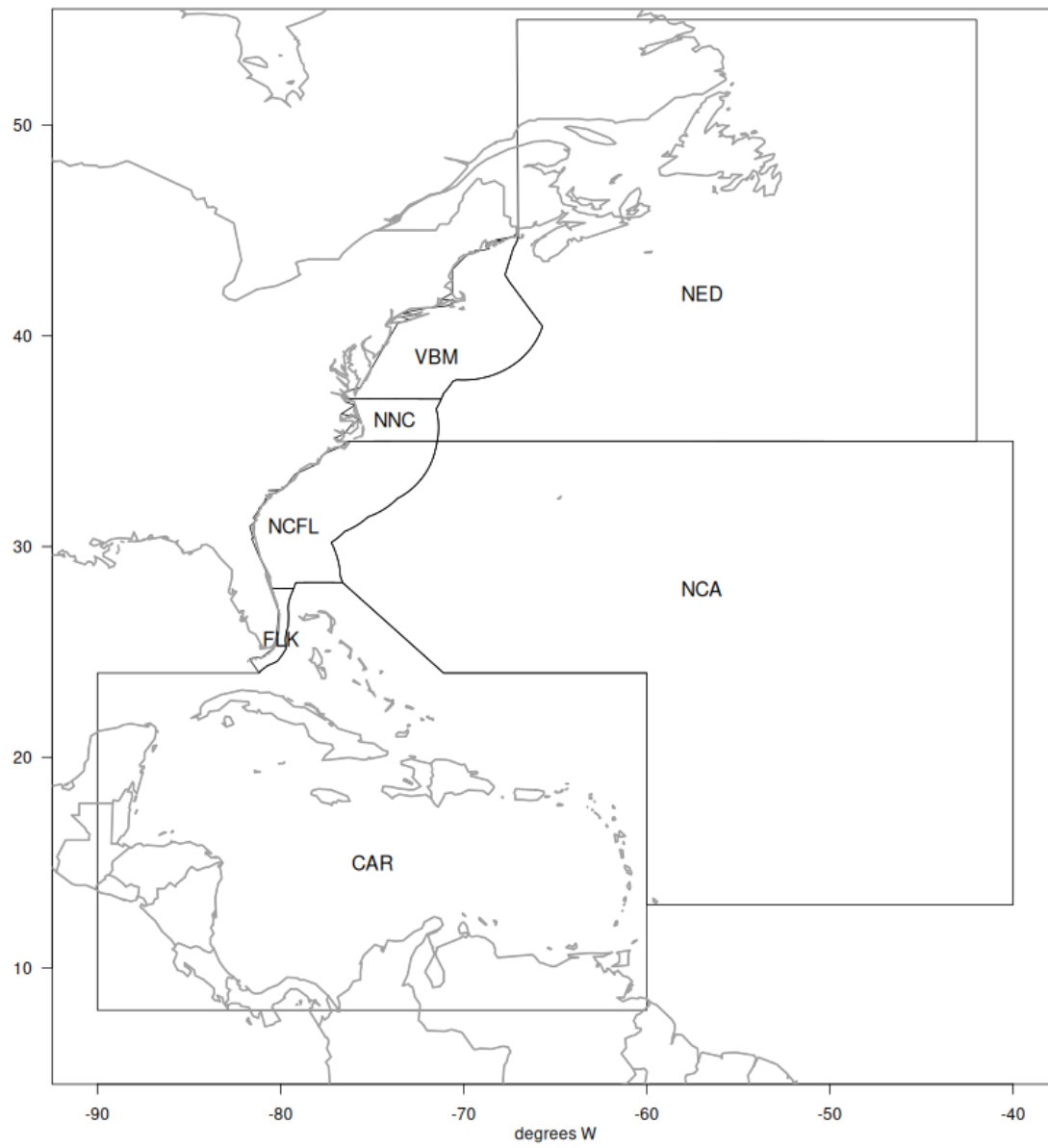


Figure 8.1: Areas defined in the operating model.

9 NOAA Fisheries recreational catch data

Here we will partition recreational catch data from NOAA Fisheries' Marine Recreational Information Program (MRIP), a standardized, peer-reviewed suite of recreational fishing surveys used to produce catch and effort estimates for quota monitoring and stock assessment in the United States. MRIP is a standardized survey suite that employs a complex statistical sampling design stratified across time, regions of the coast, and different fishing modes, which allows the intercept data to be scaled up by effort estimates to calculate total catches.

9.1 Data access and upload

Data are downloaded directly from the Miami server using the files provided to SERO for ACL monitoring. The current location is: M://SFD/SECM-SFD/ACL/2025_Jun23_MRIP_-MRFSS/. The catches are in FES MRIP and the units are in pounds whole weight.

```
# clear workspace
rm(list = ls())

# read in data file
load("data/mrip_fes_rec81_25wv2_23June25.RData") # most recent file on SFD server
head(dat)
```

	REC_ACL_MRIP_FES_ID	YEAR	MONTH	WAVE	SUB_REG	NEW_ST	NEW_STA	NEW_MODE	NEW_MODEN
1	73407425	1989	NA	4	6	9	NC	4	Priv
2	73407426	1989	NA	4	6	9	NC	4	Priv
3	73407427	1989	NA	4	6	9	NC	4	Priv
4	73407428	1989	NA	4	6	9	NC	4	Priv
5	73407429	1989	NA	4	6	9	NC	4	Priv
6	73407430	1989	NA	4	6	9	NC	4	Priv

	AREA_X	NEW_AREA	NEW_AREAN	FL_REG	NC_REG	DS	NEW_SCI
1	5	5	Inshore	NA	S	MRIP Centropristis	striata
2	5	5	Inshore	NA	N	MRIP Centropristis	striata

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3	2	2	Ocean>3mi	NA	N MRIP	Centropristis striata
4	2	2	Ocean>3mi	NA	S MRIP	Centropristis striata
5	1	1	Ocean<=3mi	NA	N MRIP	Centropristis striata
6	1	1	Ocean<=3mi	NA	S MRIP	Centropristis striata
	NEW_COM	SP_CODE	SPECIES_ITIS	SPECIES	AB1	B2
1	black sea bass	8835020301	167687		34181.4033	121019.1368
2	black sea bass	8835020301	167687		795.8612	4445.0527
3	black sea bass	8835020301	167687		549.5390	2919.4840
4	black sea bass	8835020301	167687		71823.2390	24548.2535
5	black sea bass	8835020301	167687		415.7642	87.5928
6	black sea bass	8835020301	167687		48728.5632	11859.6428
	A	B1	LBSEST_SECWWT	LBSEST_SECSOURCE	SAMPLE_SIZE_USED	
1	31761.4755	2419.9278	11457.8425	srysmwa	41	
2	584.4155	211.4457	266.7782	srysmwa	41	
3	549.5390	0.0000	484.4319	srysmwa	119	
4	33343.1844	38480.0546	63313.9276	srysmwa	119	
5	415.7642	0.0000	294.0623	srysmwa	71	
6	40585.0152	8143.5480	34464.8156	srysmwa	71	
	AVG_LEN	AVG_WGT	SRYSMWA_AVG_LEN	SRYSMWA_AVG_WGT	SRYSMWA_SAMPLE_SIZE	
1	203.4572	0.3352069	203.4572	0.3352069	41	
2	203.4572	0.3352069	203.4572	0.3352069	41	
3	296.2590	0.8815243	296.2590	0.8815243	119	
4	296.2590	0.8815243	296.2590	0.8815243	119	
5	261.9949	0.7072816	261.9949	0.7072816	71	
6	261.9949	0.7072816	261.9949	0.7072816	71	
	SRYSMWA_FLAGGED	SRYSMW_AVG_LEN	SRYSMW_AVG_WGT	SRYSMW_SAMPLE_SIZE		
1		NA	269.2563	0.7310037	231	
2		NA	269.2563	0.7310037	231	
3		NA	269.2563	0.7310037	231	
4		NA	269.2563	0.7310037	231	
5		NA	269.2563	0.7310037	231	
6		NA	269.2563	0.7310037	231	
	SRYSMW_FLAGGED	SRYSM_AVG_LEN	SRYSM_AVG_WGT	SRYSM_SAMPLE_SIZE	SRYSM_FLAGGED	
1		NA	259.7694	0.6948228	556	NA
2		NA	259.7694	0.6948228	556	NA
3		NA	259.7694	0.6948228	556	NA
4		NA	259.7694	0.6948228	556	NA
5		NA	259.7694	0.6948228	556	NA
6		NA	259.7694	0.6948228	556	NA
	SRYS_AVG_LEN	SRYS_AVG_WGT	SRYS_SAMPLE_SIZE	SRYS_FLAGGED	SRYS_AVG_LEN	
1	270.955	0.8099641	982	NA	269.1276	

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2	270.955	0.8099641		982	NA	269.1276		
3	270.955	0.8099641		982	NA	269.1276		
4	270.955	0.8099641		982	NA	269.1276		
5	270.955	0.8099641		982	NA	269.1276		
6	270.955	0.8099641		982	NA	269.1276		
	SRY_AVG_WGT	SRY_SAMPLE_SIZE	SRY_FLAGGED	SR_AVG_LEN	SR_AVG_WGT	SR_SAMPLE_SIZE		
1	0.8085211	1703	NA	303.6871	1.050403	46055		
2	0.8085211	1703	NA	303.6871	1.050403	46055		
3	0.8085211	1703	NA	303.6871	1.050403	46055		
4	0.8085211	1703	NA	303.6871	1.050403	46055		
5	0.8085211	1703	NA	303.6871	1.050403	46055		
6	0.8085211	1703	NA	303.6871	1.050403	46055		
	SR_FLAGGED	S_AVG_LEN	S_AVG_WGT	S_SAMPLE_SIZE	S_FLAGGED	VAR_B2	VAR_AB1	
1	NA	344.4373	1.364082	305089	NA	4072492794	310099094	
2	NA	344.4373	1.364082	305089	NA	2866289	258947	
3	NA	344.4373	1.364082	305089	NA	0	0	
4	NA	344.4373	1.364082	305089	NA	105731413	534702898	
5	NA	344.4373	1.364082	305089	NA	0	0	
6	NA	344.4373	1.364082	305089	NA	22265768	286196169	
	SA_LABEL	GOM_LABEL	REC_ACL	MIGRA_GRP	AGG_MODEN	JURISDICTION	PS_REG	
1	Snapper	Grouper	1		Private	State	6	
2	Snapper	Grouper	1		Private	State	5	
3	Snapper	Grouper	1		Private	Federal	5	
4	Snapper	Grouper	1		Private	Federal	6	
5	Snapper	Grouper	1		Private	State	5	
6	Snapper	Grouper	1		Private	State	6	
	COUNCILREG	GFMC_FMP	SAFMC_FMU	LBSEST_SECGWT	AGGR_AREA	AREA	FIRST_MONTH	
1	6		Y	9710.0360		NA	NA	
2	5		Y	226.0832		NA	NA	
3	5		Y	410.5355		NA	NA	
4	6		Y	53655.8708		NA	NA	
5	5		Y	249.2054		NA	NA	
6	6		Y	29207.4709		NA	NA	
	LAST_MONTH	ALT_FLAG	CHTS_CL	CHTS_H	CHTS_RL	CHTS_WAB1C	CHTS_WAB1H	MODE_FX
1	NA	0	0	0	0	0	0	7
2	NA	0	0	0	0	0	0	7
3	NA	0	0	0	0	0	0	7
4	NA	0	0	0	0	0	0	7
5	NA	0	0	0	0	0	0	7
6	NA	0	0	0	0	0	0	7
	NEW_SEASN	SEASON						

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```
1          NA
2          NA
3          NA
4          NA
5          NA
6          NA
```

```
#apply(dat[2:18], 2, table, useNA = "always")
```

```
# confirm nomenclature for dolphin and subset by species -----
```

```
table(dat$NEW_COM[grepl("dolphin", dat$NEW_COM)])
```

```
dolphin
9377
```

```
table(dat$NEW_SCI[grepl("dolphin", dat$NEW_COM)])
```

```
Coryphaena hippurus
9377
```

```
d <- dat[which(dat$NEW_COM == "dolphin"), ]
#apply(d[2:18], 2, table, useNA = "always")
d <- d[which(d$YEAR < 2025), ]      # take out 2025 because incomplete year
tot <- tapply(d$LBSEST_SECWWT, d$YEAR, sum, na.rm = T)
```

9.2 Separate Gulf and Atlantic recreational catches

Now we filter the data set to separate out the Gulf versus Atlantic catches.

```
# codes for WFL regions: 1 (NW FL Panhandle- Escambia to Dixie co.), 2 (SW FL Peninsula- Le
# subregional codes: 6 is Atlantic and 7 is Gulf
table(d$FL_REG, d$SUB_REG, useNA = "always")
```

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	4	5	6	7	<NA>
1	0	0	0	387	0
2	0	0	0	110	0
3	0	0	0	568	0
4	0	0	1022	0	0
5	0	0	312	0	0
<NA>	96	585	3836	2426	0

```
unique(d$NEW_STA)
```

```
[1] "NC"      "FLE"     "FLW"     "SC"      "GA"      "MS"      "AL"      "LA"
[9] "TX"      "FLE/GA"  "RI"      "VA"      "DE"      "MD"      "NJ"      "CT"
[17] "MA"      "NY"      "LA/MS"   "AL/FLW"
```

```
d1 <- d[which(d$COUNCILREG == 6), ]
dg <- d[which(d$COUNCILREG == 7), ]
table(d1$COUNCILREG)
```

```
6
6419
```

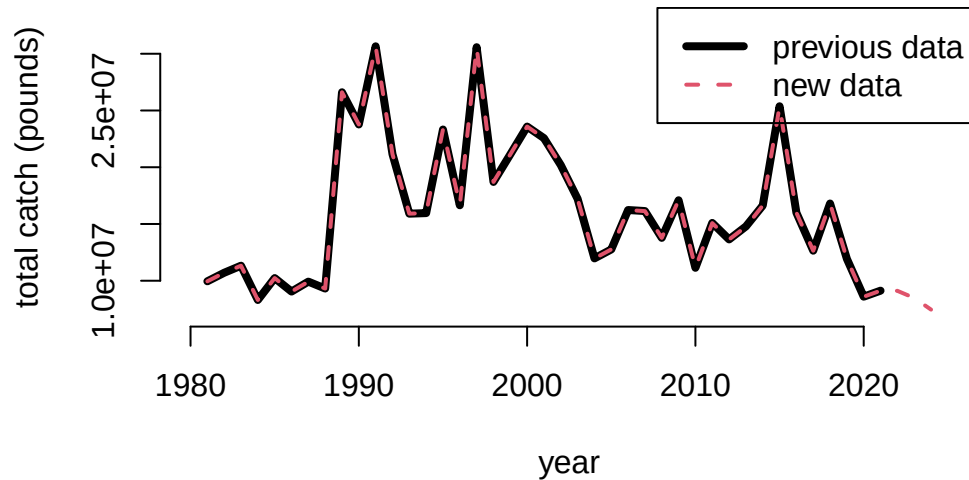
Now we can summarize the total dolphin catches in weight for the U.S. Atlantic, and compare to previous values sent for quota monitoring. We see that the values are almost identical.

```
# summarize by year and compare -----
```

```
tot1 <- tapply(d1$LBSEST_SECWWT, d1$YEAR, sum, na.rm = T)
#head(tot1)
```

```
old <- read.csv("data/RecreationalDolphinLandings_SAandGOM_MLarkin.csv", skip = 6)
plot(old$Year, old$ATL, type = "l", xlab = "year", ylab = "total catch (pounds)", lwd = 4,
     xlim = c(1980, 2025), ylim = c(7*10^6, 3.3*10^7), bty = "n")
lines(as.numeric(names(tot1)), tot1, lwd = 2, col = 2, lty = 2)
legend("topright", c("previous data", "new data"), col = c(1, 2), lwd = c(4, 2), lty = c(1,
```

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9.3 Partition catches by area and sector

Now we will partition out the total catches according to the dolphin MSE areas. The areas are as follows:

- FLK: Florida Keys to Indian River County County (FL)
- NCFL: Brevard (FL) to Southern NC (South of Hatteras)
- NNC: Northern NC (North of Hatteras to NC/VA border)
- VBM: Virginia to Maine

```
# separate out 4 regions -----
```

```
d1$region <- "VBM"
```

```
# select for FLK
```

```
# FL_REG codes: 4: SE FL- Miami-Dade to Indian River County.; 5: NE FL- Brevard to Nassau C
```

```
table(d1$FL_REG, d1$NEW_STA, useNA = "always")
```

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	CT	DE	FLE	FLE/GA	FLW	GA	MA	MD	NC	NJ	NY	RI	SC	VA
3	0	0	0	0	568	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
4	0	0	1022	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
5	0	0	312	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
<NA>	14	114	0	1794	0	54	20	125	1344	108	73	62	644	165

<NA>	
3	0
4	0
5	0
<NA>	0

```
d1$region[which(d1$FL_REG == 3 | d1$FL_REG == 4)] <- "FLK"

# select for NCFL
d1$region[which(d1$FL_REG == 5)] <- "NCFL"
lis <- c("SC", "GA", "FLE/GA") # NCFL states
d1$region[which(d1$NEW_STA %in% lis)] <- "NCFL"
# NC_REG codes: N: North of Cape Hatteras; S: South of Cape Hatteras
table(d1$NC_REG, d1$NEW_STA, useNA = "always")
```

	CT	DE	FLE	FLE/GA	FLW	GA	MA	MD	NC	NJ	NY	RI	SC	VA
	14	114	1334	1794	568	54	20	125	586	108	73	62	644	165
N	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	420	0	0	0	0	0
S	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	338	0	0	0	0	0
<NA>	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

<NA>	
	0
N	0
S	0
<NA>	0

```
d1$region[which(d1$NC == "S")] <- "NCFL"

# select for NNC
d1$region[which(d1$NC == "N")] <- "NNC"
```

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```
table(d1$FL_REG, d1$NEW_STA, d1$region)
```

```
, , = FLK
```

	CT	DE	FLE	FLE/GA	FLW	GA	MA	MD	NC	NJ	NY	RI	SC	VA
3	0	0	0	0	568	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
4	0	0	1022	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
5	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

```
, , = NCFL
```

	CT	DE	FLE	FLE/GA	FLW	GA	MA	MD	NC	NJ	NY	RI	SC	VA
3	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
4	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
5	0	0	312	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

```
, , = NNC
```

	CT	DE	FLE	FLE/GA	FLW	GA	MA	MD	NC	NJ	NY	RI	SC	VA
3	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
4	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
5	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

```
, , = VBM
```

	CT	DE	FLE	FLE/GA	FLW	GA	MA	MD	NC	NJ	NY	RI	SC	VA
3	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
4	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
5	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

```
table(d1$NC_REG, d1$NEW_STA, d1$region) # check classification
```

```
, , = FLK
```

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	CT	DE	FLE	FLE/GA	FLW	GA	MA	MD	NC	NJ	NY	RI	SC	VA
	0	0	1022	0	568	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
N	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
S	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

, , = NCFL

	CT	DE	FLE	FLE/GA	FLW	GA	MA	MD	NC	NJ	NY	RI	SC	VA
	0	0	312	1794	0	54	0	0	0	0	0	0	644	0
N	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
S	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	338	0	0	0	0	0

, , = NNC

	CT	DE	FLE	FLE/GA	FLW	GA	MA	MD	NC	NJ	NY	RI	SC	VA
	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
N	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	420	0	0	0	0	0
S	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

, , = VBM

	CT	DE	FLE	FLE/GA	FLW	GA	MA	MD	NC	NJ	NY	RI	SC	VA
	14	114	0	0	0	0	20	125	586	108	73	62	0	165
N	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
S	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

```
# summarize by Gulf and Atlantic regions and check against total -----
atl <- tapply(d1$LBSEST_SECWWT, list(d1$YEAR, d1$region), sum, na.rm = T)
GULF <- tapply(dg$LBSEST_SECWWT, dg$YEAR, sum, na.rm = T)

table(rownames(atl) == names(GULF))
```

TRUE

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```
rec <- cbind(GULF, atl)

#plot(rowSums(rec), tot)
rowSums(rec)/tot
```

```
1981 1982 1983 1984 1985 1986 1987 1988 1989 1990 1991 1992 1993 1994 1995 1996
    1    1    1  NA    1    1    1    1    1    1    1    1    1    1    1
1997 1998 1999 2000 2001 2002 2003 2004 2005 2006 2007 2008 2009 2010 2011 2012
    1    1    1    1    1    1    1    1    1    1    1    1    1    1    1
2013 2014 2015 2016 2017 2018 2019 2020 2021 2022 2023 2024
    1    1    1    1    1    1    1    1    1    1    1    1
```

```
write.csv(rec, file = "data/recLandings.csv")
```

Now we will separate out the catches by recreational sector and plot the totals by region and sector.

```
# separate out by for hire vs. private rec -----
d1$sector <- "ForHire"

d1$sector[which(d1$NEW_MODEN == "Shore")] <- "Rec"
d1$sector[which(d1$NEW_MODEN == "Priv")] <- "Rec"

table(d1$sector, d1$NEW_MODEN, useNA = "always")    # check classification
```

	Cbt	Cbt/Hbt	Hbt	Priv	Shore	<NA>
ForHire	1616	119	2912	0	0	0
Rec	0	0	0	1750	22	0
<NA>	0	0	0	0	0	0

```
tot <- tapply(d1$LBSEST_SECWWT, list(d1$YEAR, d1$region, d1$sector), sum, na.rm = T)

head(tot)
```

```
, , ForHire
```

```
FLK    NCFL    NNC    VBM
```

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```
1981 354639.5 74702.50 256755.24 1400.247
1982 347458.2 92271.42 27578.44 2749.224
1983 1020005.8 41784.04 88690.53 5379.177
1984 1021086.8 74658.81 NA 4203.048
1985 717523.0 172989.65 58514.13 8880.857
1986 1562354.0 63555.89 817192.26 61658.193
```

```
, , Rec
```

```
      FLK      NCFL      NNC      VBM
1981 8942641 322505.7      NA      NA
1982 8422673 1711834.7 78367.161 18727.290
1983 10000662 119370.4 44226.032 5456.237
1984 6717044 486079.7      NA      0.000
1985 7925301 1162708.4 77477.096 112944.274
1986 5699311 736872.0 2549.586 103945.134
```

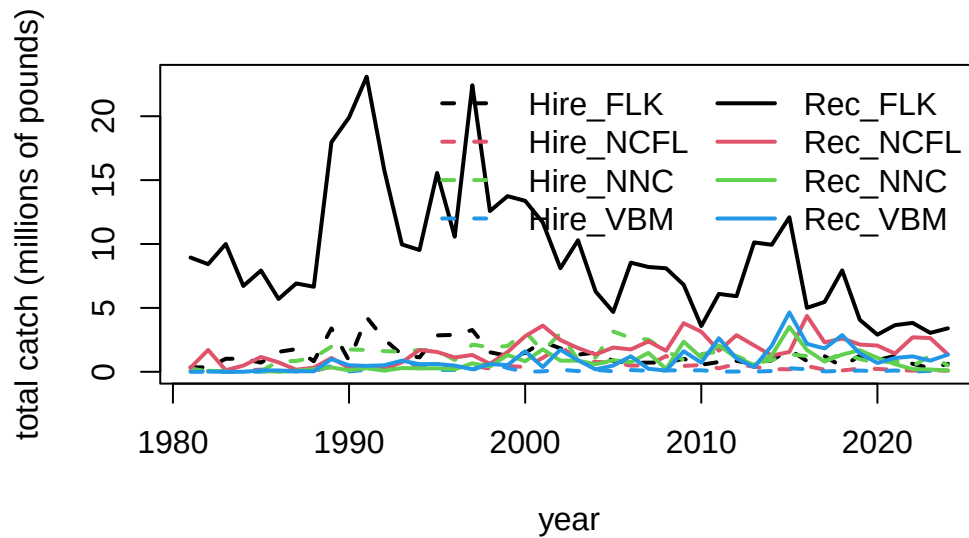
```
fin <- data.frame(cbind(tot[, , 1], tot[, , 2]))
names(fin) <- c("Hire_FLK", "Hire_NCFL", "Hire_NNC", "Hire_VBM",
               "Rec_FLK", "Rec_NCFL", "Rec_NNC", "Rec_VBM")
head(fin)
```

```
      Hire_FLK Hire_NCFL Hire_NNC Hire_VBM Rec_FLK Rec_NCFL Rec_NNC
1981 354639.5 74702.50 256755.24 1400.247 8942641 322505.7      NA
1982 347458.2 92271.42 27578.44 2749.224 8422673 1711834.7 78367.161
1983 1020005.8 41784.04 88690.53 5379.177 10000662 119370.4 44226.032
1984 1021086.8 74658.81      NA 4203.048 6717044 486079.7      NA
1985 717523.0 172989.65 58514.13 8880.857 7925301 1162708.4 77477.096
1986 1562354.0 63555.89 817192.26 61658.193 5699311 736872.0 2549.586
      Rec_VBM
1981      NA
1982 18727.290
1983 5456.237
1984 0.000
1985 112944.274
1986 103945.134
```

```
matplot(rownames(fin), fin/10^6, lty = c(rep(2, 4), rep(1, 4)),
        col = rep(1:4, 2), type = "l", lwd = 2,
```

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```
      xlab = "year", ylab = "total catch (millions of pounds)")
legend("topright", colnames(fin), lty = c(rep(2, 4), rep(1, 4)), col = rep(1:4, 2), lwd = 2)
```



```
# check that totals match
cor(rowSums(fin, na.rm = T), tot1)
```

```
[1] 1
```

```
mean(rowSums(fin, na.rm = T) - tot1) # very tiny differences
```

```
[1] 4.233284e-11
```

Here are the catches (in pounds) for years 1981 to 2024.

9.4 Looking at extent of discarding

Discard estimates (known as B2 estimates) are provided in numbers by the MRIP survey but are not available in the Southeast Region Headboat Survey. We can look at the

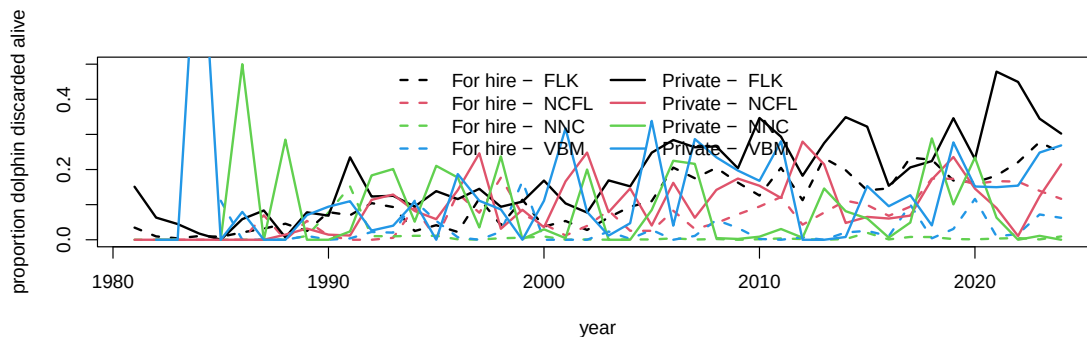
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overall numbers of dolphinfish caught versus reported released from the MRIP survey to get an understanding of the extent of discarding.

```
d1$perdis <- d1$B2 / (d1$AB1 + d1$B2) # percent discarded is B2 (fish released alive) / to

# calculate mean discard rate by year, region, sector -----
dis <- tapply(d1$perdis, list(d1$YEAR, d1$region, d1$sector), mean, na.rm = T)
disr <- tapply(d1$perdis, list(d1$region, d1$sector), mean, na.rm = T)

matplot(rownames(dis), cbind(dis[, , 1], dis[, , 2]), lty = c(rep(2, 4), rep(1, 4)), col =
        type = "l", lwd = 2, xlab = "year", ylab = "proportion dolphin discarded alive", yll
legend("top", c(paste("For hire - ", colnames(dis)), paste("Private - ", colnames(dis))),
        lty = c(rep(2, 4), rep(1, 4)), col = rep(1:4, 2), lwd = 2, ncol = 2, bty = "n")
```



```
round(disr * 100, 2) # discarding rates by region and sector
```

	ForHire	Rec
FLK	10.79	18.76
NCFL	9.44	11.23
NNC	0.94	9.62
VBM	2.94	12.69

According to the MRIP survey and the reported numbers, discarding generally increases over time, excluding some highly anomalous estimates from the early years which are driven by low sample sizes. Discarding is generally higher in the private sector compared to the for-hire sector, and is highest in the Florida Keys region.

9.5 Split the catches by season

The dolphin MSE operates on a seasonal time step and thus the catches and discards must be parsed apart by individual season and year. This is not straightforward because MRIP estimates are reported in two-month waves (Jan - Feb, Mar - Apr, May - Jun, etc.), and the seasons are 3-month periods (Dec - Feb, Mar - May, Jun - Aug, Sep - Nov). For the two waves that have to be split into seasons (e.g., December is lumped with January and February; June is lumped with July and August), we split the wave 50/50%, i.e, we make the assumption that half of the catch in that wave occurs in one season and the other half occurs in the next season.

```
# define seasons -----
table(d1$WAVE, useNA = "always")
```

```
0    1    2    3    4    5    6 <NA>
5  407  718 1230 1439 1095  581  944
```

```
d1$YRWAVE <- paste0(d1$YEAR, "_", d1$WAVE)
```

```
totw <- tapply(d1$LBSEST_SECWWT, list(d1$YRWAVE, d1$region, d1$sector), sum, na.rm = T)
```

```
f <- data.frame(cbind(totw[, , 1], totw[, , 2]))
```

```
names(f) <- c("Hire_FLK", "Hire_NCFL", "Hire_NNC", "Hire_VBM", "Rec_FLK", "Rec_NCFL", "Rec_
head(f)
```

	Hire_FLK	Hire_NCFL	Hire_NNC	Hire_VBM	Rec_FLK	Rec_NCFL	Rec_NNC
1981_2	NA	NA	NA	NA	2793285.5	270968.46	NA
1981_3	300873.764	NA	254049.420	NA	3915698.3	NA	NA
1981_4	50017.460	NA	2705.821	NA	905621.2	51537.26	NA
1981_5	3748.301	NA	NA	NA	479834.0	NA	NA
1981_6	NA	NA	NA	NA	848201.5	NA	NA
1981_NA	NA	74702.5	NA	1400.247	NA	NA	NA
Rec_VBM							
1981_2	NA						
1981_3	NA						
1981_4	NA						
1981_5	NA						
1981_6	NA						
1981_NA	NA						

9 NOAA Fisheries recreational catch data

```
f$YEAR <- as.numeric(substr(rownames(f), 1, 4))
f$WAVE <- as.numeric(substr(rownames(f), 6, 8))
head(f) # table with catches separated by wave and year
```

	Hire_FLK	Hire_NCFL	Hire_NNC	Hire_VBM	Rec_FLK	Rec_NCFL	Rec_NNC
1981_2	NA	NA	NA	NA	2793285.5	270968.46	NA
1981_3	300873.764	NA	254049.420	NA	3915698.3	NA	NA
1981_4	50017.460	NA	2705.821	NA	905621.2	51537.26	NA
1981_5	3748.301	NA	NA	NA	479834.0	NA	NA
1981_6	NA	NA	NA	NA	848201.5	NA	NA
1981_NA	NA	74702.5	NA	1400.247	NA	NA	NA

	Rec_VBM	YEAR	WAVE
1981_2	NA	1981	2
1981_3	NA	1981	3
1981_4	NA	1981	4
1981_5	NA	1981	5
1981_6	NA	1981	6
1981_NA	NA	1981	NA

```
f[is.na(f)] <- 0

f <- f[which(f$YEAR >= 1985), ]
f <- f[which(f$YEAR <= 2024), ]

table(f$YEAR)
```

1985	1986	1987	1988	1989	1990	1991	1992	1993	1994	1995	1996	1997	1998	1999	2000
7	7	7	7	7	7	7	7	7	7	7	7	6	6	6	6
2001	2002	2003	2004	2005	2006	2007	2008	2009	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016
6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	7	7	7	6
2017	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024								
6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6								

```
table(f$WAVE)
```

```
0 1 2 3 4 5 6
15 40 40 40 40 40 40
```

9 NOAA Fisheries recreational catch data

```
# deal with NAs in many locations -----
# calculate percentages of catch by wave, for each region and fleet
avw <- tapply(d1$LBSEST_SECWWT, list(d1$WAVE, d1$region, d1$sector), sum, na.rm = T)
avw <- avw[-1, , ]
avw <- data.frame(cbind(avw[, , 1], avw[, , 2]))
names(avw) <- c("Hire_FLK", "Hire_NCFL", "Hire_NNC", "Hire_VBM", "Rec_FLK", "Rec_NCFL", "Rec_NNC", "Rec_VBM")
avwp <- apply(avw, 2, function (x) x / sum(x, na.rm = T))
#colSums(avwp)

# go through each column, find NAs and fill in waves by percentages
pre_colsum <- colSums(f, na.rm = T) # column sums to check later

lis <- which(f$WAVE == 0) # list of rows with NA wave data

for (i in 1:8) { # loop through each column
  for(j in lis) { # loop through list of NA waves
    if (f[j, i] > 0) { # if there are NA wave catches, split by known proportion from other waves
      miscatch <- avwp[, i] * f[j, i] # missing catch is known proportion * NA wave catch
      f[which(f$YEAR == f$YEAR[j] & f$WAVE != 0), i] <- f[which(f$YEAR == f$YEAR[j] & f$WAVE != 0), i] + miscatch
      f[j, i] <- 0 # set to zero after catch is attributed to waves
    }
  }
}
f[lis, 1:8] # should be all zeros now
```

	Hire_FLK	Hire_NCFL	Hire_NNC	Hire_VBM	Rec_FLK	Rec_NCFL	Rec_NNC	Rec_VBM
1985_NA	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
1986_NA	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
1987_NA	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
1988_NA	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
1989_NA	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
1990_NA	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
1991_NA	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
1992_NA	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
1993_NA	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
1994_NA	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
1995_NA	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
1996_NA	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
2013_0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
2014_0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

9 NOAA Fisheries recreational catch data

```
2015_0      0      0      0      0      0      0      0      0
```

```
pos_colsum <- colSums(f, na.rm = T)
pre_colsum[1:8] == pos_colsum[1:8] # check that catch was parsed correctly - column sums s
```

```
Hire_FLK Hire_NCFL Hire_NNC Hire_VBM Rec_FLK Rec_NCFL Rec_NNC Rec_VBM
      TRUE      TRUE      TRUE      TRUE      TRUE      TRUE      TRUE      TRUE
```

```
f <- f[which(f$WAVE != 0), ] # remove NA waves which now contain no catch

# split waves 3 and 6 50/50% to parse into seasons -----
lis <- which(f$WAVE == 3 | f$WAVE == 6) # list of 3 and 6 waves for all years

for (i in lis) {
  # go through list of waves
  temp <- f[i, ] / 2 # split catch in half
  temp[9] <- f$YEAR[i] # reformat year and wave data columns
  temp[10] <- f$WAVE[i]
  temp <- rbind(temp, temp) # create two half-waves and relabel with new wave reference n
  temp[1, 10] <- temp[1, 10] - 0.5
  temp[2, 10] <- temp[2, 10] + 0.5
  f <- rbind(f, temp) # concatenate with main data table
}

f <- f[-lis, ] # remove waves that have been split in half

pos_colsum <- colSums(f, na.rm = T)
pre_colsum[1:8] == pos_colsum[1:8] # check that catch was parsed correctly - column sums s
```

```
Hire_FLK Hire_NCFL Hire_NNC Hire_VBM Rec_FLK Rec_NCFL Rec_NNC Rec_VBM
      TRUE      TRUE      TRUE      TRUE      TRUE      TRUE      TRUE      TRUE
```

```
f <- f[order(f$YEAR, f$WAVE), ] # reorder table in chronological order

f$YEAR[which(f$WAVE == 6.5)] <- f$YEAR[which(f$WAVE == 6.5)] + 1 # add year to December wa
f$WAVE[which(f$WAVE == 6.5)] <- 0.5 # change December wave to small number so it gets summ

table(f$WAVE)
```

9 NOAA Fisheries recreational catch data

```
0.5  1  2 2.5 3.5  4  5 5.5
40  40 40 40 40 40 40 40
```

```
f$seas <- cut(f$WAVE, breaks = c(0, 1.5, 3, 4.5, 6))
#table(f$seas)
f$seas1 <- NA
f$seas1[which(f$seas == "(0,1.5)")] <- "DJF" # Dec Jan Feb is 0.5 and 1
f$seas1[which(f$seas == "(1.5,3)")] <- "MAM" # Mar Apr May is 2 and 2.5
f$seas1[which(f$seas == "(3,4.5)")] <- "JJA" # Jun Jul Aug is 3.5 and 4
f$seas1[which(f$seas == "(4.5,6)")] <- "SON" # Sep Oct Nov is 5 and 5.5

temp <- tapply(f[, 1], list(f$seas1, f$YEAR), sum, na.rm = T)
temp1 <- matrix(temp)
for (i in 2:8) {
  temp2 <- matrix(tapply(f[, i], list(f$seas1, f$YEAR), sum, na.rm = T))
  temp1 <- cbind(temp1, temp2)
}

findat <- data.frame(sort(rep(as.numeric(colnames(temp)), 4)),
                     rep(rownames(temp), ncol(temp)), temp1)
names(findat) <- c("year", "season", names(f)[1:8])

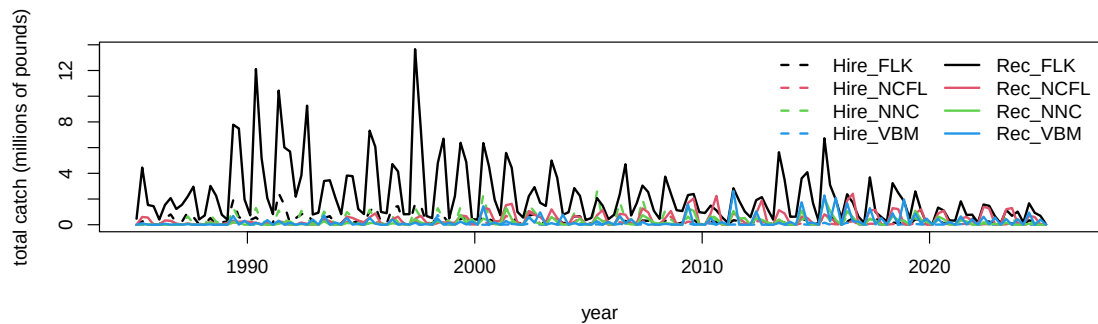
colSums(f[, 1:8], na.rm = T) == colSums(findat[, 3:10], na.rm = T) # check that total catch
```

Hire_FLK	Hire_NCFL	Hire_NNC	Hire_VBM	Rec_FLK	Rec_NCFL	Rec_NNC	Rec_VBM
TRUE	TRUE	TRUE	TRUE	TRUE	TRUE	TRUE	TRUE

We plot the results by region and sector, over the time series of year and season. We can clearly see the seasonality in the catch by region.

```
findat$yrseas <- findat$year + as.numeric(as.factor(findat$season))/4-0.125
matplot(findat$yrseas, findat[, 3:10]/10^6, lty = c(rep(2, 4), rep(1, 4)), col = rep(1:4, 2),
        xlab = "year", ylab = "total catch (millions of pounds)")
legend("topright", colnames(findat[, 3:10]), lty = c(rep(2, 4), rep(1, 4)), col = rep(1:4,
```

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```
# check that totals match
cbind(colSums(findat[, 3:10], na.rm = T), colSums(fin[-c(1:5), ], na.rm = T))
```

	[,1]	[,2]
Hire_FLK	55604999	54887476
Hire_NCFL	16909916	16736926
Hire_NNC	57944903	57886388
Hire_VBM	5836953	5828072
Rec_FLK	371462933	363537632
Rec_NCFL	70803866	69641157
Rec_NNC	32556596	32479119
Rec_VBM	40081529	39968585

```
# the values should be close but slightly >1 because the last data set includes December 19
colSums(findat[, 3:10], na.rm = T) / colSums(fin[-c(1:5), ], na.rm = T)
```

Hire_FLK	Hire_NCFL	Hire_NNC	Hire_VBM	Rec_FLK	Rec_NCFL	Rec_NNC	Rec_VBM
1.013073	1.010336	1.001011	1.001524	1.021800	1.016696	1.002385	1.002826

Here we will format the data for input to the operating model.

```
tab3 <- findat

flt <- c(rep("Hire", nrow(tab3)*4), rep("Rec", nrow(tab3)*4))

yrmon <- as.numeric(tab3$yrseas)
yrs <- floor(yrmon)
```

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```
qrt <- (yrmon - floor(yrmon)) * 4 + 0.5
area <- c(rep("FLK", nrow(tab3)), rep("NCFL", nrow(tab3)),
         rep("NNC", nrow(tab3)), rep("VBM", nrow(tab3)))
area <- rep(area, 2)

findat1 <- data.frame(yrs, qrt, flt, area, matrix(as.matrix(tab3[,3:10])))
names(findat1) <- c("Year", "Quarter", "Fleet", "Area", "Catch_lbs")
head(findat1)
```

	Year	Quarter	Fleet	Area	Catch_lbs
1	1985	1	Hire	FLK	4462.09
2	1985	2	Hire	FLK	253487.38
3	1985	3	Hire	FLK	380811.37
4	1985	4	Hire	FLK	41469.99
5	1986	1	Hire	FLK	40545.41
6	1986	2	Hire	FLK	501184.61

```
#plot(findat1$Catch_lbs, type = "l")
#plot(findat1$Catch_lbs ~ factor(findat1$Area))
#plot(findat1$Catch_lbs ~ factor(findat1$Quarter))
#plot(findat1$Catch_lbs ~ factor(findat1$Year))

findat1 <- findat1[which(findat1$Year <= 2022), ]
findat1 <- findat1[which(findat1$Year >= 1986), ]
#apply(findat1, 2, table)

findat <- findat[which(findat$year >=1986 & findat$year <= 2022), ]
#check that the numbers are exactly the same
tapply(findat1$Catch_lbs, list(findat1$Area, findat1$Fleet), sum, na.rm = T)
```

	Hire	Rec
FLK	54012811	357091651
NCFL	16532764	65643193
NNC	56097190	32197622
VBM	5736592	37749487

```
colSums(findat[3:10], na.rm = T)
```

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Hire_FLK	Hire_NCFL	Hire_NNC	Hire_VBM	Rec_FLK	Rec_NCFL	Rec_NNC	Rec_VBM
54012811	16532764	56097190	5736592	357091651	65643193	32197622	37749487

```
# output final numbers in correct format
write.csv(findat1, file = "data/FINAL_files/rec_catch_TomFormat.csv", row.names = FALSE)
```

10 NOAA Fisheries commercial data

We do not display the commercial data analysis here because it is based on logbook reporting and trip ticket databases, which both contain confidential data. The code for processing the commercial data can be seen in the file “commercial.R” and the steps are outlined below.

10.1 Analysis of logbook data

We first use the pelagic longline logbook data to understand how the fleet operates in the high seas on a seasonal basis. These numbers are used later to estimate the seasonality of the international catches, because those are only reported on an annual basis but quarterly values are needed.

The steps are as follows:

1. Read in the pelagic longline data which contains set level entries including location of fishing, target species, gear used, other details of the fishing trip and number of dolphin caught, discarded alive, discarded dead, and the total pounds of dolphin kept.
2. Format the longitude and latitude of the sets into decimal degrees, and find the points that fall within each of the seven polygons representing the areas of the operating model. Check that subsetting was done correctly and add an area identifier.
3. Look at the characteristics of the dolphin catch and calculate the discard rates by trip. Dead discarding rate is found to be 1.4% on average and total discard rate is 2.9% on average.
4. Standardize date formatting and add identifier for season (quarter). Specify a new year variable to allow December to be grouped with January and February.
5. Summarize the total dolphin catch (in pounds) by year, quarter, and area.

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6. Convert the total pounds by year-quarter and area to proportions such that each year-quarter combination has four seasonal proportions summing to one. Save the matrix of proportions for later analysis.

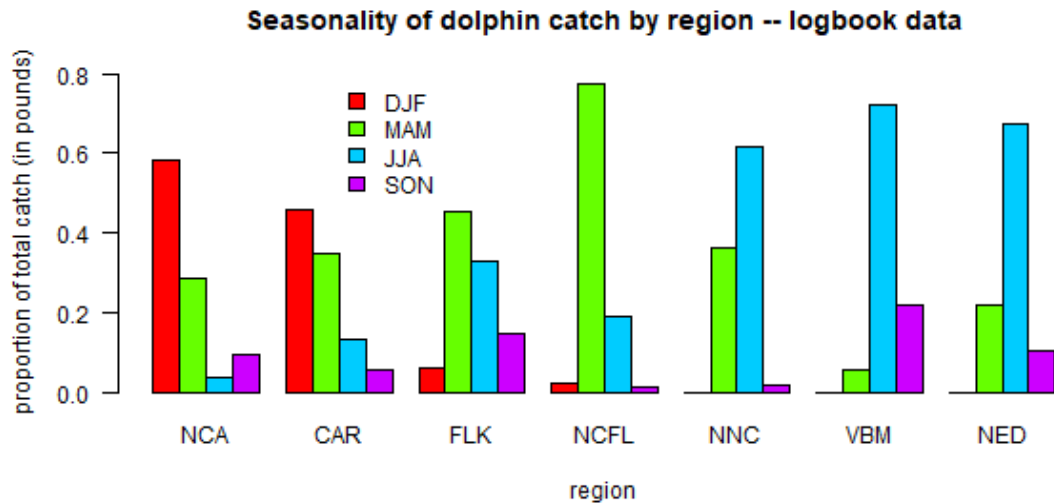


Figure 10.1: Seasonality of the pelagic longline fleet according to the logbook data. Figure shows the proportion of dolphin catch occurring in each season, for each region of the operating model.

10.2 Analysis of trip ticket data

Not all of the commercial dolphin catch activity is reported in the logbooks because dolphin are targeted via a variety of permits and gear types, not all of which have the same reporting requirements. Therefore, in order to parse the commercial catches by year, area and quarter, we use the commercial trip ticket data compiled by NOAA Fisheries. These are the same data used for quota monitoring and thus are the best representation of the total catch.

The steps are as follows:

1. Read in the trip ticket data file, which contains commercial dolphinfish landings for the Atlantic coast from 1986-2023, including all landings by year even if the gear type or area is unknown. The dataset specifies the year and month of

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landing, an area of fishing, gear, and the state where landed. Pounds are in units of whole weight.

2. Read in operating model regions and classify the list of logbook areas into those seven regions. Assign each reported area to an operating model region accordingly.
3. Standardize date formatting and add identifier for season (quarter). Specify a new year variable to allow December to be grouped with January and February.
4. Summarize the landings by year-quarter, gear (PLL gear vs. other gears) and region.
5. For most combinations of year-quarter, region and gear, there are substantial landings for which the area of fishing is unknown and therefore the region cannot be defined. We assume that those landings follow the same distribution with regard to region as the other landings for that year-quarter and gear combination. For each year-quarter/gear combination, we calculate the proportion of catch that occurs in each of the seven regions. The total landings of unknown regions are multiplied by those proportions and then added to the landings from known regions. In cases where none of the areas are known for that year-quarter/gear combination, proportions from the quarter immediately previous to that quarter are used. Sum the landings by gear type to get the total landings for each year-quarter and region.
6. Reformat the data according to the specifications needed for input to the operating model (columns specifying the year, quarter, fleet, area and total catch).
7. Sum landings by year from the original data file and the final outputs to ensure that data were processed correctly and no catch is missing.

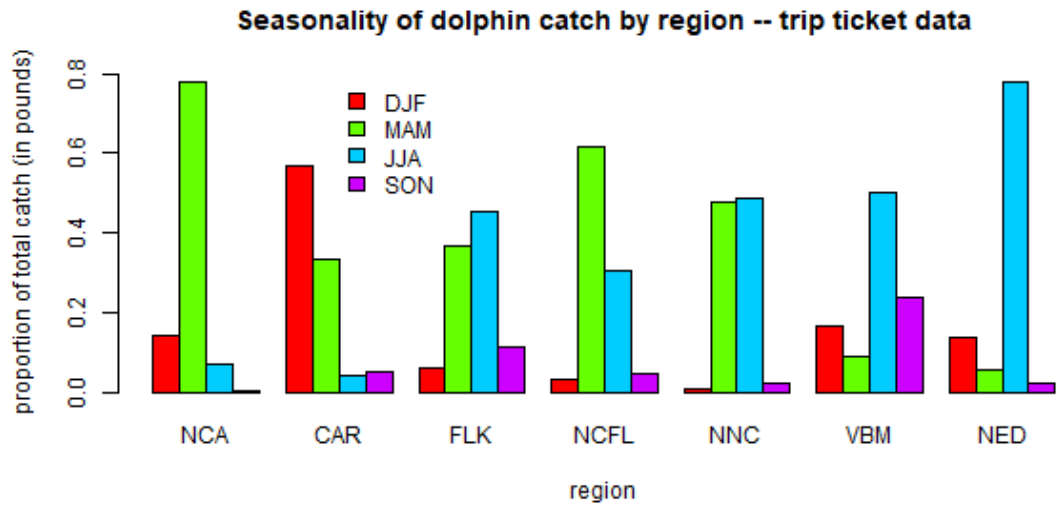


Figure 10.2: Seasonality of the commercial dolphin catch according to the trip ticket data. Figure shows the proportion of dolphin catch occurring in each season, for each region of the operating model.

11 Analysis of international catches in the high seas

Here we will explore commercial and recreational catch data as estimated by the Sea Around Us Project. This data set includes reported data for fisheries worldwide as well as reconstructed estimates for unreported catches. For each country, project scientists assemble available data on catch and use additional sociological and fishing data plus expert information and opinion, to produce their best estimates of total catch from all fishing sectors and for all species globally.

11.1 Data access and upload

The high seas data are accessed in the Basic Search High seas section of the site. The individual regions can be clicked on (e.g., Atlantic, Western Central) and then the data are downloaded using the Download Data button.

The current version of data in use is version 50.1, accessed June 2024 (the data files can be found on github in the SEFSC-dolphin-analyses/data /SAU/ folder). This was still the most recent version of data available as of September 2025.

11.2 Read in the high seas catches

First we read in the high seas catches for the Western Central Atlantic and Northwest Atlantic zones. These are equivalent to FAO areas 21 and 31.

```
# clear workspace
rm(list = ls())

if(!require("pals")) install.packages("pals")
library(pals)
```

11 Analysis of international catches in the high seas

```
# find data files
hslis <- dir("data/SAU/")[grep("HighSeas", dir("data/SAU/"))]

# identify areas 21 and 31
hslis[1]; hslis[3]
```

```
[1] "SAU HighSeas 21 v50-1.csv"
```

```
[1] "SAU HighSeas 31 v50-1.csv"
```

```
#download data
h1 <- read.csv(paste0("data/SAU/", hslis[1]))
h3 <- read.csv(paste0("data/SAU/", hslis[3]))

# confirm correct areas
#unique(h1$area_name)
#unique(h3$area_name)

hs <- rbind(h1, h3)
```

We extract the data for dolphinfish and look at the characteristics of the catches. Most of the catches are in the Western Central Atlantic, and the primary fishing entities are Venezuela and Saint Lucia. The fishing sector is all industrial, and the vast majority of the catch is reported landings, with only a tiny fraction of discards or unreported landings listed in the database. The gear type is primarily long line.

```
# check species name and filter out dolphinfish
unique(hs$common_name)[grep("dolphin", unique(hs$common_name))]
```

```
[1] "Common dolphinfish"
```

```
hs <- hs[which(hs$common_name == "Common dolphinfish"), ]

# look at the categories within each column of data
apply(hs[1:13], 2, table)
```

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\$area_name

Atlantic, Northwest Atlantic, Western Central	113	160
---	-----	-----

\$area_type

high_seas
273

\$year

1985	1986	1999	2000	2001	2002	2003	2004	2005	2006	2007	2008	2009	2010	2011	2012
1	1	1	1	1	1	1	6	4	1	5	10	5	8	10	12
2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019									
24	22	30	33	33	29	34									

\$scientific_name

Coryphaena hippurus
273

\$common_name

Common dolphinfish
273

\$functional_group

Large pelagics (≥ 90 cm)
273

\$commercial_group

Perch-likes
273

\$fishing_entity

Barbados	Belize
6	3

11 Analysis of international catches in the high seas

	Brazil	Canada
	19	18
	Guyana	Panama
	1	1
	Saint Lucia	Saint Vincent & the Grenadines
	5	28
	Spain	Suriname
	80	1
	Trinidad & Tobago	USA
	14	74
	Venezuela	
	23	
\$fishing_sector		
Industrial		
	273	
\$catch_type		
Discards Landings		
	5	268
\$reporting_status		
	Reported	Unreported
	253	20
\$gear_type		
artisanal fishing gear		
	7	
	bottom trawl	gillnet
	9	11
	hand lines	longline
	17	187
	pole and line	pots or traps
	19	9
		unknown by source
		13
\$end_use_type		
	Direct human consumption	Fishmeal and fish oil
	5	194
		37

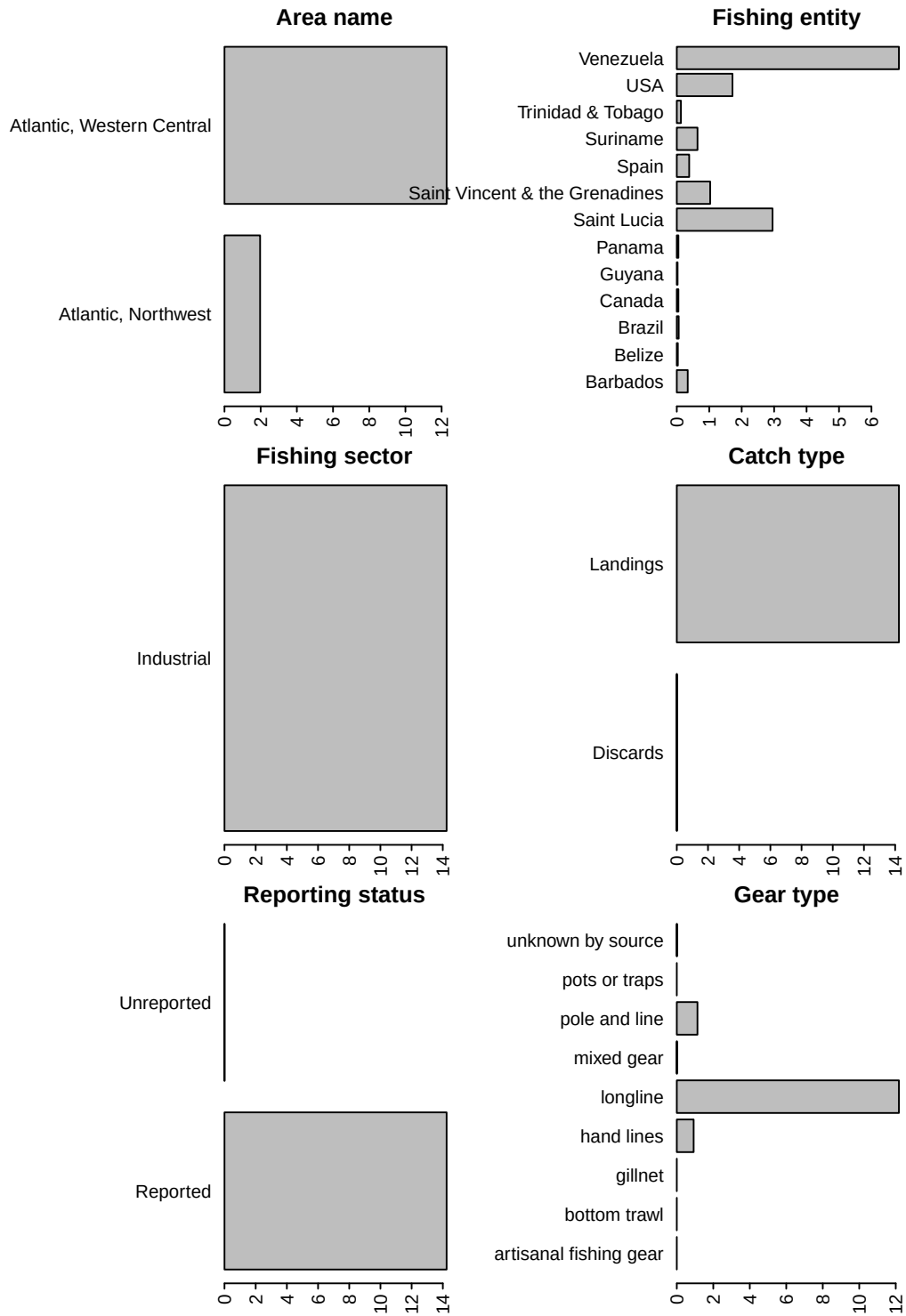
11 Analysis of international catches in the high seas

Other
37

```
# convert from metric tonnes to pounds
hs$pounds <- hs$tonnes * 1000 * 2.20462

# produce barplot of key data fields
par(mar = c(3, 20, 3, 1), mfrow = c(3, 2), mex = 0.5)
barplot(tapply(hs$pounds/10^6, hs$area_name, sum, na.rm = T), las = 2, xlab = "millions of
#barplot(tapply(hs$pounds/10^6, hs$area_type, sum, na.rm = T), las = 2, ylab = "millions of
#barplot(tapply(hs$pounds/10^6, hs$year, sum, na.rm = T), las = 2, ylab = "millions of poun
barplot(tapply(hs$pounds/10^6, hs$fishing_entity, sum, na.rm = T), las = 2, xlab = "million
barplot(tapply(hs$pounds/10^6, hs$fishing_sector, sum, na.rm = T), las = 2, xlab = "million
barplot(tapply(hs$pounds/10^6, hs$catch_type, sum, na.rm = T), las = 2, xlab = "millions of
barplot(tapply(hs$pounds/10^6, hs$reporting_status, sum, na.rm = T), las = 2, xlab = "milli
barplot(tapply(hs$pounds/10^6, hs$gear_type, sum, na.rm = T), las = 2, xlab = "millions of
```

11 Analysis of international catches in the high seas



11 Analysis of international catches in the high seas

```
round(tapply(hs$pounds, hs$catch_type, sum, na.rm = T) / sum(hs$pounds) * 100, 2) # << 1%
```

Discards	Landings
0.03	99.97

```
round(tapply(hs$pounds, hs$reporting_status, sum, na.rm = T) / sum(hs$pounds) * 100, 2) #
```

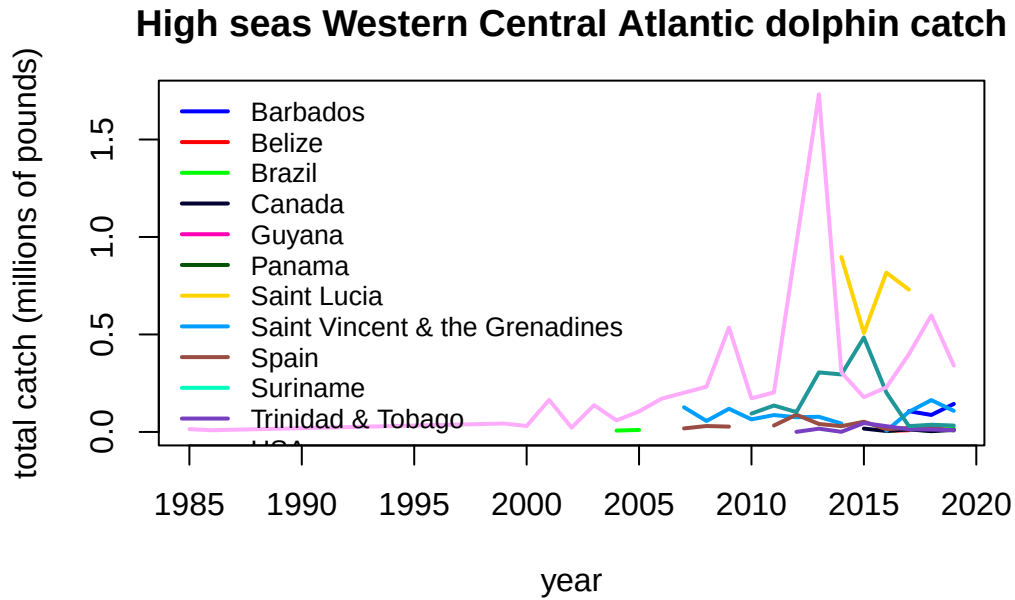
Reported	Unreported
99.97	0.03

11.3 Summarize the high seas catches

We plot the annual catches by fishing entity to look at trends over time.

```
hs$fishing_entity <- as.factor(hs$fishing_entity)
hs$fishing_entity <- droplevels(hs$fishing_entity)

par(mar = c(5, 5, 3, 1), mfrow = c(1, 1))
tab <- tapply(hs$pounds, list(hs$year, hs$fishing_entity), sum, na.rm = T)
matplot(as.numeric(rownames(tab)), tab/10^6, type = "l", col = glasbey(ncol(tab)), lty = 1,
        main = "High seas Western Central Atlantic dolphin catch")
legend("topleft", colnames(tab), col = glasbey(ncol(tab)), lty = 1, lwd = 2, cex = 0.8, bty
```



Finally we output the subset of high seas dolphin catch for the two areas. Because we have already accounted for the USA catches in our national reporting and are aiming to only summarize international catches here, we filter out the USA catches from the Sea Around Us database.

```
hs <- hs[which(hs$fishing_entity != "USA"), ]

hs$year <- factor(hs$year, levels = 1950:2019)
tab <- tapply(hs$pounds, list(hs$year, hs$area_name), sum, na.rm = T)
tab[is.na(tab)] <- 0
tail(tab, 40)
```

	Atlantic, Northwest Atlantic,	Western Central
1980	0.000	0.000
1981	0.000	0.000
1982	0.000	0.000
1983	0.000	0.000
1984	0.000	0.000
1985	0.000	14037.129
1986	0.000	8748.399
1987	0.000	0.000

11 Analysis of international catches in the high seas

1988	0.000	0.000
1989	0.000	0.000
1990	0.000	0.000
1991	0.000	0.000
1992	0.000	0.000
1993	0.000	0.000
1994	0.000	0.000
1995	0.000	0.000
1996	0.000	0.000
1997	0.000	0.000
1998	0.000	0.000
1999	0.000	43168.296
2000	0.000	30284.627
2001	0.000	164272.223
2002	0.000	22147.477
2003	0.000	137103.181
2004	0.000	66058.258
2005	0.000	115171.863
2006	0.000	170522.101
2007	14687.527	330838.620
2008	28552.636	340863.719
2009	18719.121	662720.661
2010	4510.085	232093.837
2011	21589.424	300498.224
2012	72398.812	1059210.392
2013	34741.604	2471791.396
2014	27922.953	1247462.983
2015	90313.638	710059.125
2016	15319.433	1094893.891
2017	34806.933	1374259.739
2018	29328.358	885814.754
2019	21870.621	632747.157

```
# write summary to merge with EEZ data
write.csv(tab, file = "data/SAU/high_seas_by_year.csv")
```

11.4 Distribute the high seas catches across quarters of the year

The international catches are only reported as annual catches and do not have any month or season associated with them. However, the MSE operating model requires seasonal catches. The majority of the international catches are caught by longline, so we will assume that the fleet distribution of the U.S. pelagic longline is representative of the seasonality of the international high seas fleets. Now we parse the annual catches according to the seasonality of the U.S. fleet.

At the time of analysis, the SAU database only contained catches to 2019, so we interpolated the 2019 values to cover years 2020 - 2022.

```
# read in the percentage of the catch by area and year-quarter combinations from the U.S. P
load("data/outputs/per_PLLcatch_by_area_yearquarter.RData")

tab <- tab[which(rownames(tab) >= 1997), ] # PLL data are only available from 1997 on
#tab[nrow(tab), ]
tab <- rbind(tab, tab[nrow(tab), ], tab[nrow(tab), ], tab[nrow(tab), ]) # interpolate 2019
tail(tab)
```

	Atlantic, Northwest	Atlantic, Western Central
2017	34806.93	1374259.7
2018	29328.36	885814.8
2019	21870.62	632747.2
	21870.62	632747.2
	21870.62	632747.2
	21870.62	632747.2

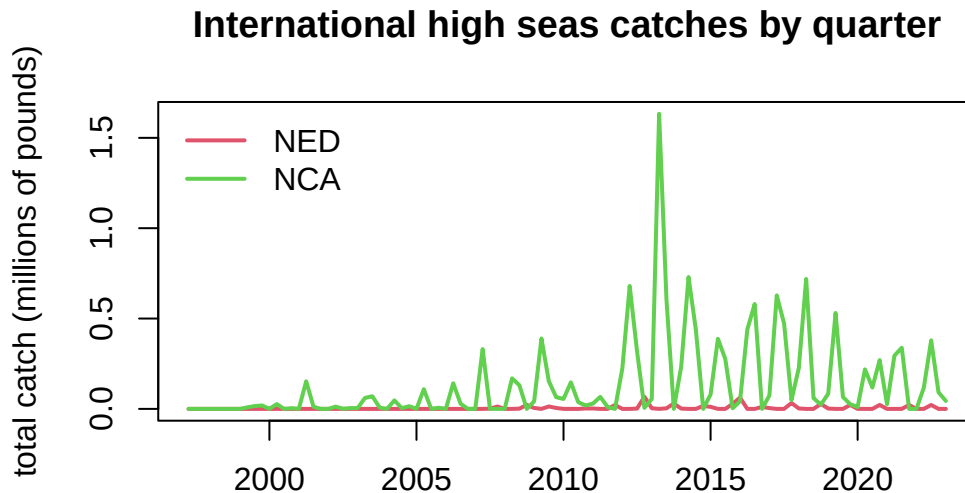
```
NED <- percatch[, , 1] # create matrices for final catch data
NCA <- percatch[, , 1]

for (i in 1:ncol(percatch)) {
  NED[, i] <- percatch[, i, 7] * tab[i, 1] # these are the percentages for the NED (Atlant
  NCA[, i] <- percatch[, i, 1] * tab[i, 2] # these are the percentages for the NCA (Weste
}

# plot the parsed out data by year-quarter
yrs <- sort(rep(as.numeric(colnames(NCA)), 4))
qrt <- rep(1:4, length(yrs)/4)
```

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```
matplot(yrs + qrt/4, cbind(matrix(NED), matrix(NCA))/10^6, lty = 1, lwd = 2,
        col = 2:3, type = "l", main = "International high seas catches by quarter",
        xlab = "", ylab = "total catch (millions of pounds)")
legend("topleft", c("NED", "NCA"), lwd = 2, col = 2:3, bty = "n")
```



```
# save NED data in this format because it needs to be combined with Canadian EEZ catches
save(NED, file = "data/outputs/NED_year_quarter.RData")
```

Finally, we format the data in the format for input into the operating model. We only include NCA here, as the NED high seas catches must be combined with international catches in territorial waters of Canada and France in the NED region.

```
# format for operating model
flt <- rep("Intl", length(yrs))
are <- rep("NCA", length(yrs))
findat <- data.frame(cbind(yrs, qrt, flt, are, matrix(NCA)))
names(findat) <- c("Year", "Quarter", "Fleet", "Area", "Catch_lbs")
findat$Catch_lbs <- as.numeric(findat$Catch_lbs)
head(findat)
```

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	Year	Quarter	Fleet	Area	Catch_lbs
1	1997	1	Intl	NCA	0
2	1997	2	Intl	NCA	0
3	1997	3	Intl	NCA	0
4	1997	4	Intl	NCA	0
5	1998	1	Intl	NCA	0
6	1998	2	Intl	NCA	0

```
#plot(findat$Catch_lbs, type = "l")
#plot(findat$Catch_lbs ~ factor(findat$Area))
#plot(findat$Catch_lbs ~ factor(findat$Quarter))
#plot(findat$Catch_lbs ~ factor(findat$Year))
#apply(findat, 2, table)
#barplot(tapply(findat$Catch_lbs, list(findat$Quarter, findat$Area), sum, na.rm = T), beside = TRUE)
write.csv(findat, file = "data/FINAL_files/NCA_Intl_TomFormat.csv", row.names = FALSE)
```

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12.1 Data access and upload

For catches within each country's exclusive economic zones, data are downloaded from the Sea Around Us site (Pauly, Zeller, and Palomares, 2020.). In the Biodiversity by Taxon Tools and Data, we filter by EEZ for All regions, and then filter by Taxon at the Species level for Common dolphinfish (*Coryphaena hippurus*). After clicking "View graphs" one can access the full data set using the "Download Data" button.

12.2 Read in the catches within exclusive economic zones (EEZs)

Now we read in the catches reported by each country or jurisdiction's respective EEZ. Because we have extracted dolphin catches for EEZs worldwide, we need to separate out the catches for the Atlantic Ocean basin.

```
# load libraries
library(pals)

rm(list = ls())
d <- read.csv("data/SAU/SAU Taxa 600006 v50-1.csv", header = T, sep = ",") # v. 50.1 - Jun
head(d)
```

	area_name	area_type	year	scientific_name	common_name
1	Australia	eez	1950	<i>Coryphaena hippurus</i>	Common dolphinfish
2	Australia	eez	1950	<i>Coryphaena hippurus</i>	Common dolphinfish
3	Australia	eez	1950	<i>Coryphaena hippurus</i>	Common dolphinfish
4	Bahamas	eez	1950	<i>Coryphaena hippurus</i>	Common dolphinfish
5	Barbados	eez	1950	<i>Coryphaena hippurus</i>	Common dolphinfish
6	Bermuda (UK)	eez	1950	<i>Coryphaena hippurus</i>	Common dolphinfish

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	functional_group	commercial_group	fishing_entity	fishing_sector
1	Large pelagics (>=90 cm)	Perch-likes	Australia	Industrial
2	Large pelagics (>=90 cm)	Perch-likes	Australia	Industrial
3	Large pelagics (>=90 cm)	Perch-likes	Australia	Industrial
4	Large pelagics (>=90 cm)	Perch-likes	Bahamas	Recreational
5	Large pelagics (>=90 cm)	Perch-likes	Barbados	Recreational
6	Large pelagics (>=90 cm)	Perch-likes	Bermuda (UK)	Artisanal

	catch_type	reporting_status		gear_type
1	Landings	Reported		longline
2	Landings	Reported		longline
3	Landings	Reported		longline
4	Landings	Unreported	recreational fishing gear	
5	Landings	Unreported	recreational fishing gear	
6	Landings	Reported	small scale lines	

	end_use_type	tonnes	landed_value
1	Fishmeal and fish oil	0.003373202	3.438170e-05
2	Direct human consumption	6.739657104	1.040254e+04
3	Other	0.003373202	3.438170e-05
4	Direct human consumption	48.665105143	8.262728e+00
5	Direct human consumption	0.009158559	4.846886e-04
6	Direct human consumption	1.511085514	3.199403e+03

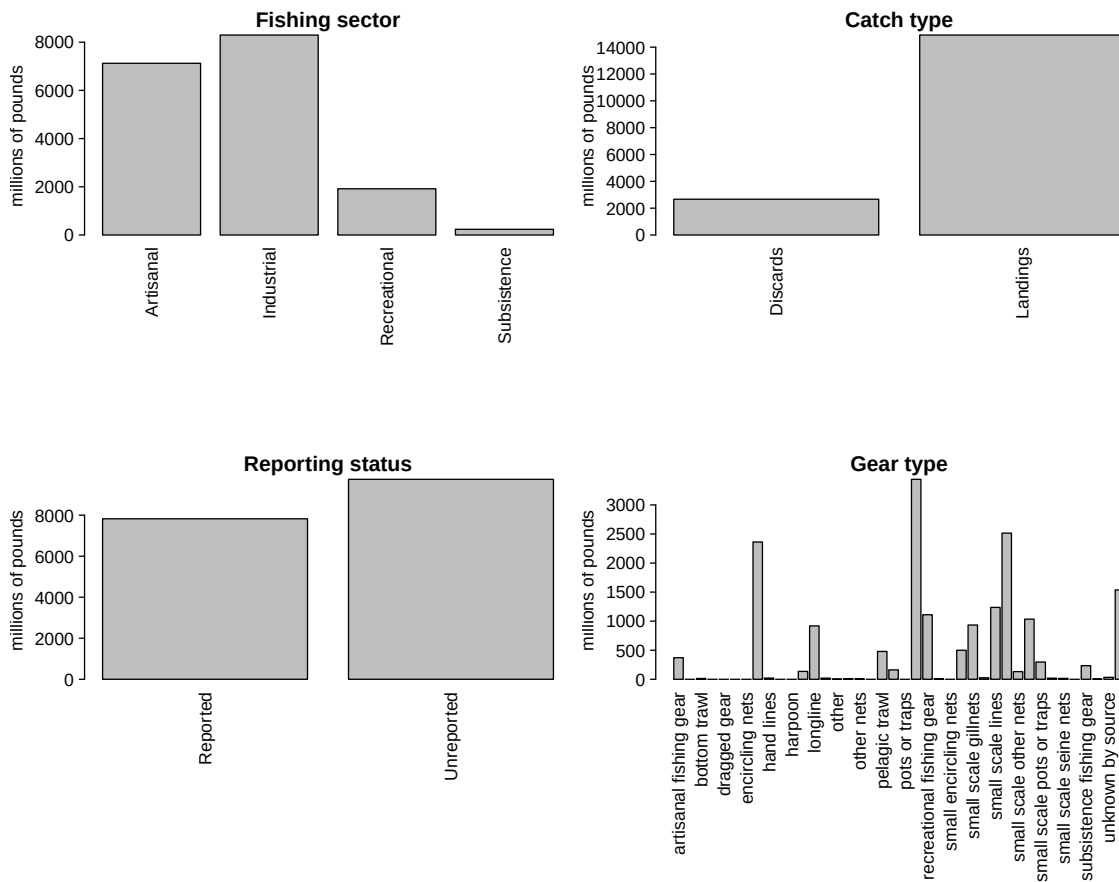
```
#dim(d)
#apply(d[1:13], 2, table)

# convert tonnes to pounds
d$lbs <- d$tonnes * 1000 * 2.20462
```

We look at the characteristics of the catches within EEZs. These are largely industrial and artisanal in nature. Landings are the majority of the catch but discards are also present. There are more unreported landings than reported landings and a variety of gear types are used.

```
# look at characteristics of data
par(mfrow = c(2, 2), mar = c(20, 7, 3, 1), mex = 0.5, mgp = c(5.5, 1, 0))
barplot(tapply(d$lbs, d$fishing_sector, sum, na.rm = T)/10^6, las = 2, ylab = "millions of pounds")
barplot(tapply(d$lbs, d$catch_type, sum, na.rm = T)/10^6, las = 2, ylab = "millions of pounds")
barplot(tapply(d$lbs, d$reporting_status, sum, na.rm = T)/10^6, las = 2, ylab = "millions of pounds")
barplot(tapply(d$lbs, d$gear_type, sum, na.rm = T)/10^6, las = 2, ylab = "millions of pounds")
```

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```
round(tapply(d$lbs, d$catch_type, sum, na.rm = T) / sum(d$lbs) * 100, 2) # 15% are discards
```

```
Discards Landings
15.18    84.82
```

```
round(tapply(d$lbs, d$reporting_status, sum, na.rm = T) / sum(d$lbs) * 100, 2) # 55% are unreported
```

```
Reported Unreported
44.52    55.48
```

12.3 Separating the EEZs by area

Now we have to manually assign the different EEZs to respective areas. We separate the geographical areas within the Atlantic Ocean (North and South) and lump all other EEZs into “other oceans.” This latter category is largely the Pacific Ocean and to a lesser extent the Indian Ocean. We remove the high seas catch from this database as it is not ocean-specific and we have extracted the ocean-specific high seas catch previously.

```
# remove the high seas catch from this database
d <- d[which(d$area_type != "high_seas"), ]
d$fishing_entity <- as.factor(d$fishing_entity)
d$fishing_entity <- droplevels(d$fishing_entity)
table(d$area_type) # this should be all "eez"
```

```
eez
63056
```

```
# Western Central Atlantic EEZs
WCA <- c("Bahamas", "Barbados", "Cayman Isl. (UK)", "Dominica", "Dominican Republic", "Grenada",
        "Aruba (Netherlands)", "Haiti", "Guadeloupe (France)", "Jamaica", "Martinique (France)",
        "Montserrat (UK)", "Nicaragua (Caribbean)", "Puerto Rico (USA)", "Saint Kitts & Nevis",
        "Saint Lucia", "Saint Vincent & the Grenadines", "Trinidad & Tobago", "US Virgin Islands",
        "St Barthelemy (France)", "St Martin (France)", "Curaçao (Netherlands)", "Bonaire",
        "Saba and Sint Eustatius (Netherlands)", "Sint Maarten (Netherlands)", "Honduras (Caribbean)",
        "Colombia (Caribbean)", "Mexico (Atlantic)", "Turks & Caicos Isl. (UK)", "Guyana",
        "Antigua & Barbuda", "Belize", "British Virgin Isl. (UK)", "French Guiana", "Cuba",
        "Anguilla (UK)", "Suriname", "Costa Rica (Caribbean)", "Guatemala (Caribbean)",
        "Panama (Caribbean)", "Bermuda (UK)", "Curaçao (Netherlands)")

# Brazil
Bra <- c("Brazil (mainland)", "Fernando de Noronha (Brazil)",
        "St Paul and St. Peter Archipelago (Brazil)")

# Canada
Can <- c("Canada (East Coast)", "Saint Pierre & Miquelon (France)")

# United States
USA <- c("USA (East Coast)", "USA (Gulf of Mexico)")
```

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```
# Northeast Atlantic EEZs
NEA <- c("Canary Isl. (Spain)", "Spain (mainland; Med and Gulf of Cadiz)", "Spain (Northwest)",
        "Spain (mainland, Med and Gulf of Cadiz)",
        "France (Atlantic Coast)", "Portugal (mainland)", "Azores Isl. (Portugal)")

# Eastern Central Atlantic EEZs
ECA <- c("Madeira Isl. (Portugal)", "Cape Verde", "Equatorial Guinea", "Benin",
        "Sao Tome & Principe ", "Sao Tome & Principe", "Morocco (Central)", "Ghana",
        "Côte d'Ivoire", "Côte d'Ivoire", "Guinea", "Liberia", "Sierra Leone", "Nigeria",
        "Guinea-Bissau", "Senegal", "Cameroon", "Gambia", "Mauritania", "Morocco (South)",
        "Gabon", "Congo; R. of", "Congo, R. of", "Congo (ex-Zaire)")

# Southeastern Atlantic EEZs
SEA <- c("Angola", "Namibia", "South Africa (Atlantic and Cape)",
        "Ascension Isl. (UK)", "Saint Helena (UK)", "Tristan da Cunha Isl. (UK)")

# Southwest Atlantic EEZs
SWA <- c("Trindade & Martim Vaz Isl. (Brazil)", "Uruguay")

# Mediterranean EEZs
Med <- c("Italy (mainland)", "Libya", "Malta", "Syria", "Sicily (Italy)", "Sardinia (Italy)",
        "Balearic Islands (Spain)", "Cyprus (North)", "Cyprus (South)",
        "Gaza Strip", "Greece (without Crete)", "Crete (Greece)", "Lebanon",
        "Turkey (Mediterranean Sea)", "Egypt (Mediterranean)", "Israel (Mediterranean)",
        "Algeria", "Albania", "Croatia", "Montenegro", "Morocco (Mediterranean)",
        "France (Mediterranean)", "Corsica (France)")

# add variable to specify region
d$reg <- "other oceans"
d$reg[which(d$area_name %in% WCA)] <- "Western Central Atlantic EEZs"
d$reg[which(d$area_name %in% Bra)] <- "Brazil EEZ"
d$reg[which(d$area_name %in% Can)] <- "Canadian EEZ"
d$reg[which(d$area_name %in% USA)] <- "United States EEZ"
d$reg[which(d$area_name %in% NEA)] <- "Northeast Atlantic EEZs"
d$reg[which(d$area_name %in% ECA)] <- "Eastern Central Atlantic EEZs"
d$reg[which(d$area_name %in% SEA)] <- "Southeast Atlantic EEZs"
d$reg[which(d$area_name %in% SWA)] <- "Southwest Atlantic EEZs"
d$reg[which(d$area_name %in% Med)] <- "Mediterranean Sea EEZs"
```

Now we will check that we have classified the regions correctly.

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```
# check region designation
othlis <- unique(d$area_name[which(d$reg == "other oceans")])
print("EEZs of all other oceans: ")
```

```
[1] "EEZs of all other oceans: "
```

```
othlis
```

```
[1] "Australia"
[3] "Taiwan"
[5] "French Polynesia"
[7] "Andaman & Nicobar Isl. (India)"
[9] "Japan (main islands)"
[11] "Korea (South)"
[13] "Nauru"
[15] "Northern Marianas (USA)"
[17] "Marshall Isl."
[19] "Pakistan"
[21] "Philippines"
[23] "Viet Nam"
[25] "Tonga"
[27] "USA (West Coast)"
[29] "Wallis & Futuna Isl. (France)"
[31] "Guatemala (Pacific)"
[33] "Mexico (Pacific)"
[35] "Korea (North, Yellow Sea)"
[37] "Mauritius"
[39] "Christmas Isl. (Australia)"
[41] "Timor Leste"
[43] "Jarvis Isl. (USA)"
[45] "Indonesia (Central)"
[47] "Kiribati (Line Islands)"
[49] "New Caledonia (France)"
[51] "Lord Howe Isl. (Australia)"
[53] "Ecuador (mainland)"
[55] "Fiji"
[57] "Norfolk Isl. (Australia)"
[59] "Pitcairn (UK)"
[61] "Costa Rica (Pacific)"
"China"
"Mayotte (France)"
"Hong Kong (China)"
"Indonesia (Eastern)"
"Japan (Daito Islands)"
"Hawaii Northwest Islands (USA)"
"Niue (New Zealand)"
"Micronesia (Federated States of)"
"Palau"
"Papua New Guinea"
"Seychelles"
"Tokelau (New Zealand)"
"Hawaii Main Islands (USA)"
"Wake Isl. (USA)"
"Samoa"
"Kiribati (Gilbert Islands)"
"Japan (Ogasawara Islands)"
"Korea (North, Sea of Japan)"
"Solomon Isl."
"Johnston Atoll (USA)"
"Palmyra Atoll & Kingman Reef (USA)"
"Howland & Baker Isl. (USA)"
"Indonesia (Indian Ocean)"
"Kiribati (Phoenix Islands)"
"Vanuatu"
"Myanmar"
"El Salvador"
"Malaysia (Peninsula West)"
"Peru"
"Colombia (Pacific)"
"Nicaragua (Pacific)"
```

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[63] "Panama (Pacific)"	"Thailand (Andaman Sea)"
[65] "Thailand (Gulf of Thailand)"	"Cook Islands"
[67] "Kermadec Isl. (New Zealand)"	"Tuvalu"
[69] "Honduras (Pacific)"	"American Samoa"
[71] "Galapagos Isl. (Ecuador)"	"New Zealand"
[73] "Brunei Darussalam"	"Malaysia (Sabah)"
[75] "Malaysia (Sarawak)"	"Guam (USA)"
[77] "Clipperton Isl. (France)"	"South Africa (Indian Ocean Coast)"
[79] "Singapore"	"Easter Isl. (Chile)"
[81] "Madagascar"	"Réunion (France)"
[83] "Chagos Archipelago (UK)"	"Comoros Isl."
[85] "Mozambique Channel Isl. (France)"	"Kenya"
[87] "Mozambique"	"Somalia"
[89] "Tanzania"	"Glorieuse Islands (France)"
[91] "Yemen (Socotra)"	"Oman"
[93] "St Paul & Amsterdam Isl. (France)"	"Iran (Sea of Oman)"
[95] "Desventuradas Isl. (Chile)"	"India (mainland)"
[97] "Maldives"	"Tromelin Isl. (France)"
[99] "Cambodia"	"Sri Lanka"
[101] "Malaysia (Peninsula East)"	"Bangladesh"

```
print("U.S. EEZs outside the Atlantic Ocean: ")
```

```
[1] "U.S. EEZs outside the Atlantic Ocean: "
```

```
othlis[grep("USA", othlis)]
```

[1] "Hawaii Northwest Islands (USA)"	"Northern Marianas (USA)"
[3] "Hawaii Main Islands (USA)"	"USA (West Coast)"
[5] "Wake Isl. (USA)"	"Johnston Atoll (USA)"
[7] "Palmyra Atoll & Kingman Reef (USA)"	"Jarvis Isl. (USA)"
[9] "Howland & Baker Isl. (USA)"	"Guam (USA)"

```
print("French EEZs outside the Atlantic Ocean: ")
```

```
[1] "French EEZs outside the Atlantic Ocean: "
```

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```
othlis[grep("France", othlis)]
```

```
[1] "Mayotte (France)"           "Wallis & Futuna Isl. (France)"
[3] "New Caledonia (France)"     "Clipperton Isl. (France)"
[5] "Réunion (France)"          "Mozambique Channel Isl. (France)"
[7] "Glorieuse Islands (France)" "St Paul & Amsterdam Isl. (France)"
[9] "Tromelin Isl. (France)"
```

```
unique(d$area_name[which(d$reg == "Western Central Atlantic EEZs")]) # Western Central EE
```

```
[1] "Bahamas"
[2] "Barbados"
[3] "Bermuda (UK)"
[4] "Cayman Isl. (UK)"
[5] "Dominica"
[6] "Dominican Republic"
[7] "Grenada"
[8] "Guadeloupe (France)"
[9] "Haiti"
[10] "Jamaica"
[11] "Martinique (France)"
[12] "Montserrat (UK)"
[13] "Puerto Rico (USA)"
[14] "Saint Kitts & Nevis"
[15] "Saint Lucia"
[16] "Saint Vincent & the Grenadines"
[17] "Trinidad & Tobago"
[18] "US Virgin Isl."
[19] "St Barthelemy (France)"
[20] "St Martin (France)"
[21] "Curaçao (Netherlands)"
[22] "Bonaire (Netherlands)"
[23] "Saba and Sint Eustatius (Netherlands)"
[24] "Sint Maarten (Netherlands)"
[25] "Honduras (Caribbean)"
[26] "Colombia (Caribbean)"
[27] "Mexico (Atlantic)"
[28] "Turks & Caicos Isl. (UK)"
[29] "Costa Rica (Caribbean)"
```

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```
[30] "Panama (Caribbean)"
[31] "Antigua & Barbuda"
[32] "Belize"
[33] "British Virgin Isl. (UK)"
[34] "Cuba"
[35] "French Guiana"
[36] "Guyana"
[37] "Anguilla (UK)"
[38] "Suriname"
[39] "Venezuela"
[40] "Guatemala (Caribbean)"
[41] "Aruba (Netherlands)"
[42] "Nicaragua (Caribbean)"
```

```
unique(d$area_name[which(d$reg == "Brazil EEZ")]) # Brazil EEZs:
```

```
[1] "Brazil (mainland)"
[2] "Fernando de Noronha (Brazil)"
[3] "St Paul and St. Peter Archipelago (Brazil)"
```

```
unique(d$area_name[which(d$reg == "Canadian EEZ")]) # Canadian EEZs:
```

```
[1] "Canada (East Coast)" "Saint Pierre & Miquelon (France)"
```

```
unique(d$area_name[which(d$reg == "United States EEZ")]) # United States EEZs:
```

```
[1] "USA (East Coast)" "USA (Gulf of Mexico)"
```

```
unique(d$area_name[which(d$reg == "Northeast Atlantic EEZs")]) # Northeast Atlantic EEZs:
```

```
[1] "Azores Isl. (Portugal)"
[2] "Spain (mainland, Med and Gulf of Cadiz)"
[3] "Canary Isl. (Spain)"
[4] "Portugal (mainland)"
[5] "France (Atlantic Coast)"
[6] "Spain (Northwest)"
```

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```
unique(d$area_name[which(d$reg == "Eastern Central Atlantic EEZs")]) # Eastern Central At
```

```
[1] "Cape Verde"           "Equatorial Guinea"
[3] "Sao Tome & Principe" "Madeira Isl. (Portugal)"
[5] "Togo"                 "Ghana"
[7] "Guinea"               "Liberia"
[9] "Guinea-Bissau"        "Senegal"
[11] "Sierra Leone"        "Morocco (Central)"
[13] "Morocco (South)"      "Côte d'Ivoire"
[15] "Gabon"                 "Benin"
[17] "Gambia"                "Mauritania"
[19] "Nigeria"              "Cameroon"
[21] "Congo, R. of"         "Congo (ex-Zaire)"
```

```
unique(d$area_name[which(d$reg == "Southeast Atlantic EEZs")]) # Southeast Atlantic EEZs:
```

```
[1] "Ascension Isl. (UK)"      "South Africa (Atlantic and Cape)"
[3] "Saint Helena (UK)"       "Angola"
[5] "Namibia"                  "Tristan da Cunha Isl. (UK)"
```

```
unique(d$area_name[which(d$reg == "Southwest Atlantic EEZs")]) # Southwest Atlantic EEZs:
```

```
[1] "Trindade & Martim Vaz Isl. (Brazil)" "Uruguay"
```

```
unique(d$area_name[which(d$reg == "Mediterranean Sea EEZs")]) # Mediterranean Sea EEZs:
```

```
[1] "Italy (mainland)"      "Libya"
[3] "Malta"                 "Syria"
[5] "Sicily (Italy)"        "Sardinia (Italy)"
[7] "Balearic Islands (Spain)" "Tunisia"
[9] "Algeria"               "Morocco (Mediterranean)"
[11] "France (Mediterranean)" "Corsica (France)"
[13] "Croatia"               "Lebanon"
[15] "Albania"               "Greece (without Crete)"
[17] "Crete (Greece)"        "Cyprus (South)"
```

12.4 Summarize catch by regional EEZs

Now we summarize the catch by region by grouping the catch across the EEZs by region. We save these data for later analysis, and move on to analyzing only the Western Central and Northwest Atlantic jurisdictions.

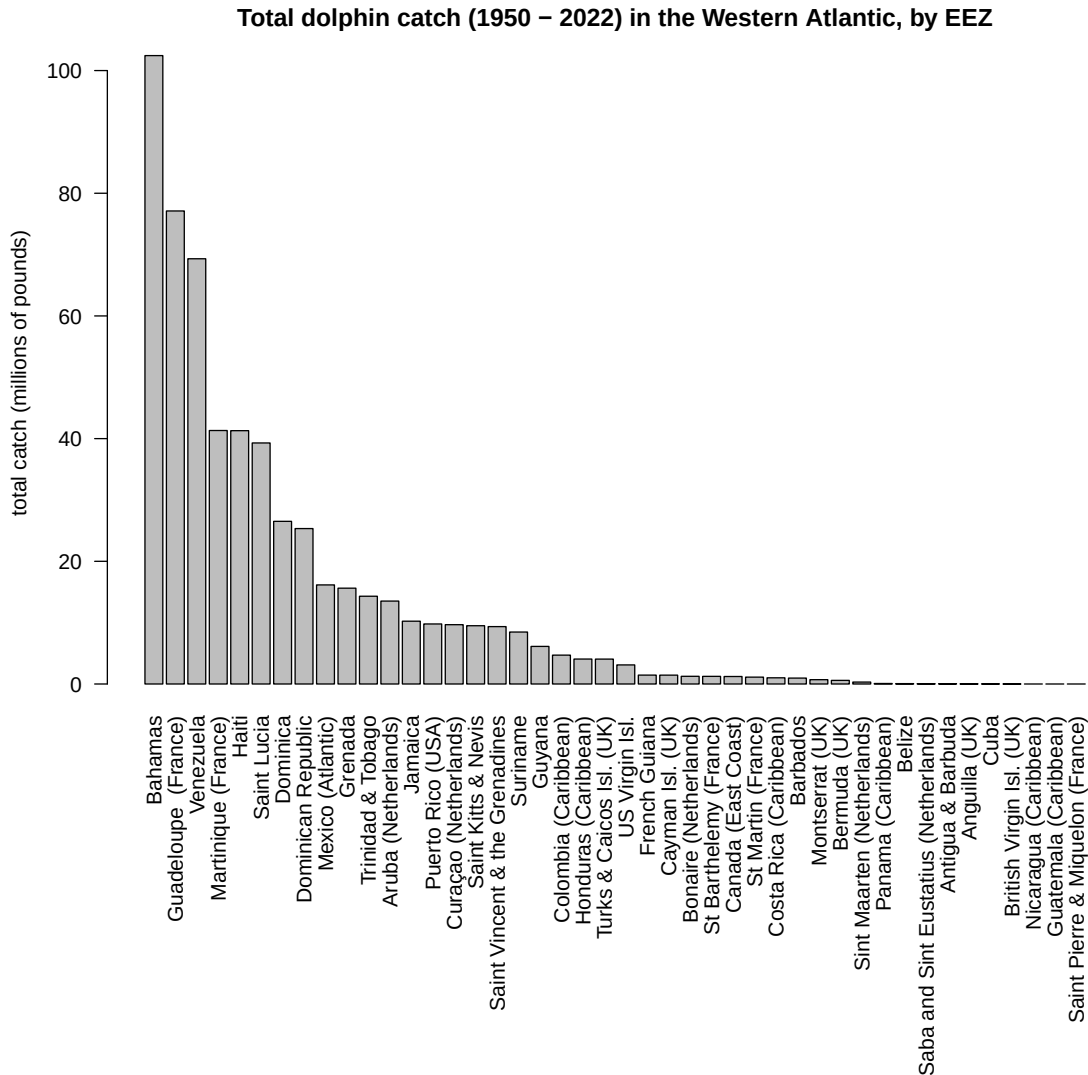
```
# summarize EEZ catch by region
tab <- tapply(d$lbs, list(d$year, d$reg), sum, na.rm = T)
write.csv(data.frame(tab), file = "data/outputs/intl_catches_allAtlantic.csv", row.names =

dwest <- d[which(d$reg == "Canadian EEZ" | d$reg == "Western Central Atlantic EEZs"), ]
save(dwest, file = "data/outputs/SAU_EEZs_WCA.RData")

tab <- tapply(dwest$lbs, list(dwest$year, dwest$area_name), sum, na.rm = T)

# eight countries are responsible for vast majority of catch with total catches across all
par(mar = c(17, 4, 3, 1))
barplot(sort(colSums(tab, na.rm = T)/10^6, decreasing = T), horiz = F, las = 2,
        main = "Total dolphin catch (1950 - 2022) in the Western Atlantic, by EEZ",
        ylab = "total catch (millions of pounds)")
```

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Note that Bermuda is actually in the NCA region and not the Greater Caribbean region. However, its catches constitute 0.1% of the total catch which is essentially negligible, and to avoid complicating the operating model and code unnecessarily we will leave those catches accounted for in the CAR region.

```
round(colSums(tab, na.rm = T)[7] / sum(colSums(tab, na.rm = T), na.rm = T) * 100, 2)
```

Bermuda (UK)

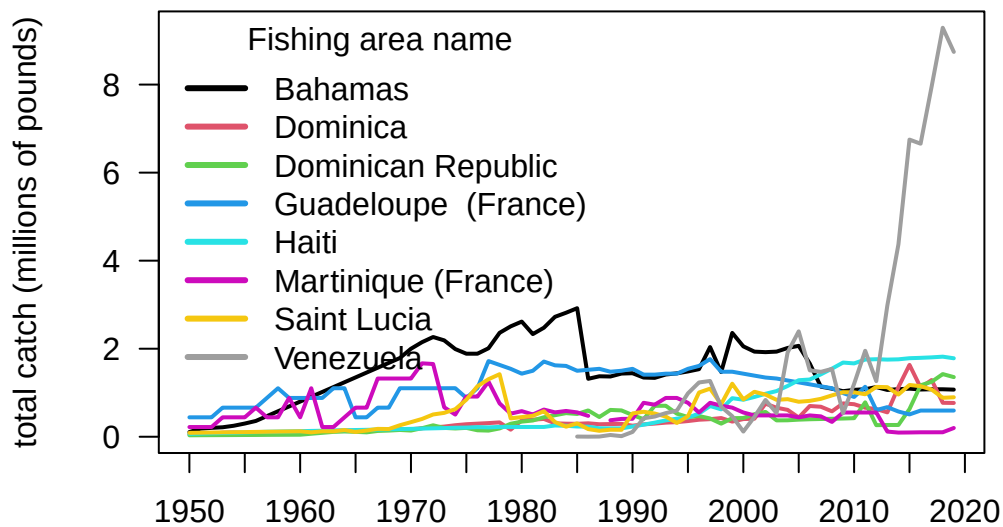
12 Analysis of international catches in territorial waters

0.1

```
lis <- names(sort(colSums(tab, na.rm = T), decreasing = T)[1:8]) # list of top 8 jurisdictions
tab1 <- tab[, colnames(tab) %in% lis]

par(mar = c(3, 5, 3, 1))
matplot(rownames(tab1), tab1/10^6, las = 2, type = "l", lty = 1, lwd = 2, pch = 19, col = 1:8,
        xlab = "", ylab = "total catch (millions of pounds)", axes = F,
        main = "Total dolphinfish catches in Caribbean EEZs (top 8 jurisdictions)")
axis(1, at = seq(1950, 2020, 5)); axis(2, las = 2); box()
legend("topleft", colnames(tab1), col = 1:8, lty = 1, lwd = 3, bty = "n", title = "Fishing")
```

Total dolphinfish catches in Caribbean EEZs (top 8 jurisdictions)



Note the rapid eight-fold increase in catches listed within the Venezuelan EEZ which occurs from 2013 - 2019. This increase is responsible for a rapid increase in estimated international catches within the Western Atlantic.

12.5 Look at Venezuela catches in detail

The figures above indicate that the database shows a rapid increase in international catches within the Western Atlantic, driven by a sudden increase in catches reported

12 Analysis of international catches in territorial waters

within Sea Around Us database within the Venezuelan EEZ. We investigate these catches in detail, as it seems odd that a relatively small fleet from a single country would be able to ramp up effort so rapidly. Data can be downloaded on a country-specific basis, the catches by taxon in the waters of Venezuela are accessed here.

```
rm(list = ls()) # clear the workspace

# download the data for waters of Venezuela
ven <- read.csv("data/SAU/SAU EEZ 862 v50-1.csv")

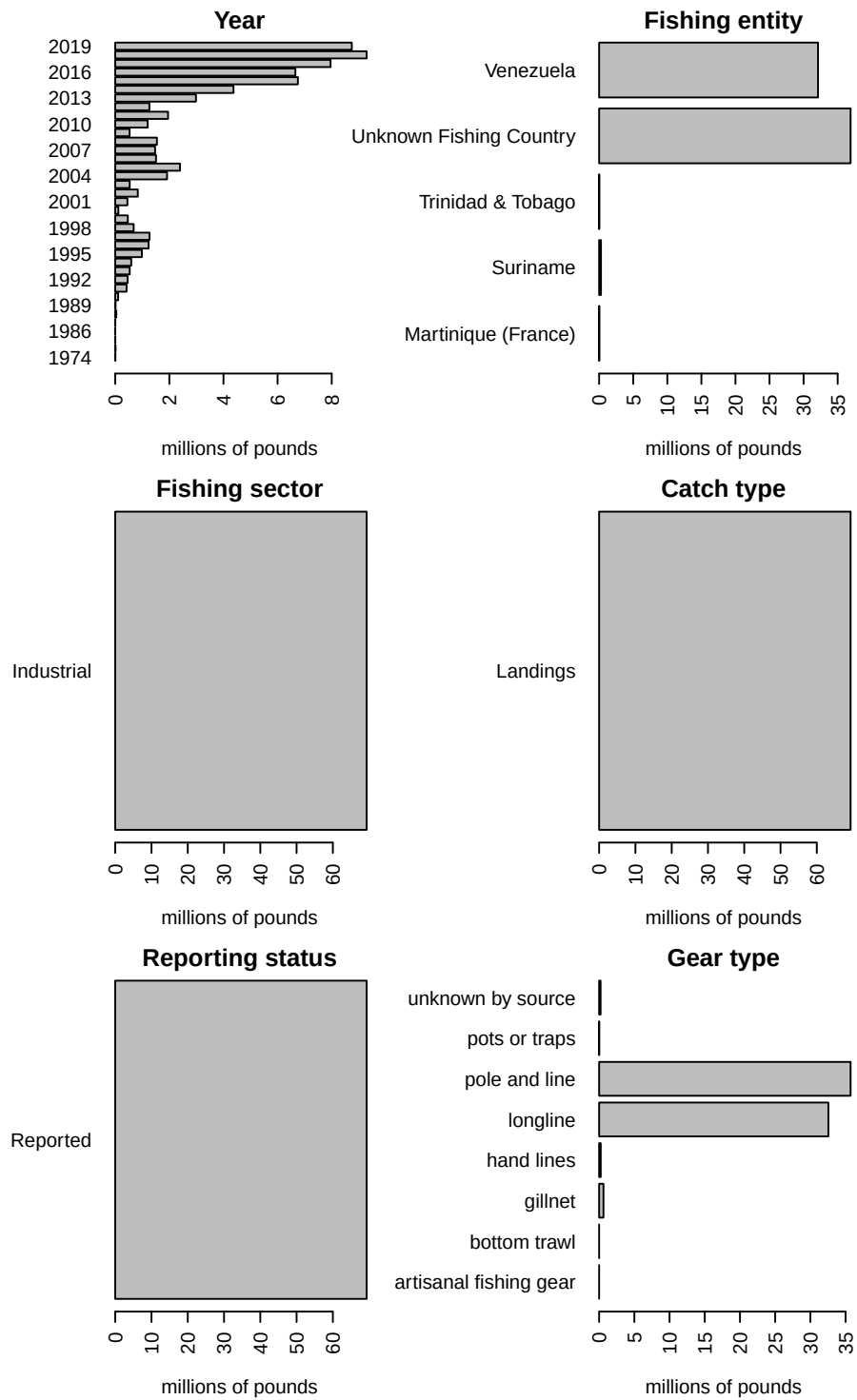
# subset dolphinfish from the data
v <- ven[which(ven$common_name == "Common dolphinfish"), ]

#apply(v[1:13], 2, table)

#convert to pounds
v$pounds <- v$tonnes * 1000 * 2.20462

# look at the characteristics of the data
par(mar = c(5, 10, 1, 1), mfrow = c(3, 2), mex = 0.9)
#barplot(tapply(v$pounds/10^6, v$area_name, sum, na.rm = T), las = 2, xlab = "millions of p
#barplot(tapply(v$pounds/10^6, v$area_type, sum, na.rm = T), las = 2, xlab = "millions of p
barplot(tapply(v$pounds/10^6, v$year, sum, na.rm = T), las = 2, xlab = "millions of pounds"
barplot(tapply(v$pounds/10^6, v$fishing_entity, sum, na.rm = T), las = 2, xlab = "millions
barplot(tapply(v$pounds/10^6, v$fishing_sector, sum, na.rm = T), las = 2, xlab = "millions
barplot(tapply(v$pounds/10^6, v$catch_type, sum, na.rm = T), las = 2, xlab = "millions of p
barplot(tapply(v$pounds/10^6, v$reporting_status, sum, na.rm = T), las = 2, xlab = "million
barplot(tapply(v$pounds/10^6, v$gear_type, sum, na.rm = T), las = 2, xlab = "millions of po
```

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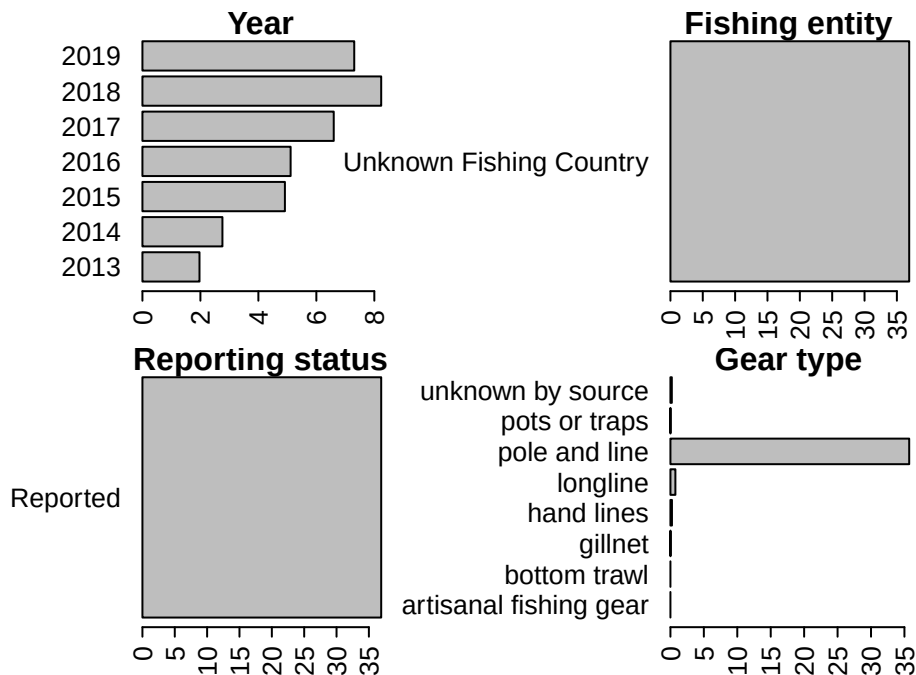


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Note that a large portion of the catch in the database is listed as coming from an "Unknown Fishing Country." We extract these catches and further investigate the characteristics.

```
# extract the Unknown Fishing Country catch
v1 <- v[which(v$fishing_entity == "Unknown Fishing Country"), ]
#apply(v1[1:15], 2, table)

# look at characteristics
par(mar = c(3, 10, 1, 5), mfrow = c(2, 2), mex = 0.6)
barplot(tapply(v1$pounds/10^6, v1$year, sum, na.rm = T), las = 2, xlab = "millions of pounds")
barplot(tapply(v1$pounds/10^6, v1$fishing_entity, sum, na.rm = T), las = 2, xlab = "millions of pounds")
barplot(tapply(v1$pounds/10^6, v1$reporting_status, sum, na.rm = T), las = 2, xlab = "millions of pounds")
barplot(tapply(v1$pounds/10^6, v1$gear_type, sum, na.rm = T), las = 2, xlab = "millions of pounds")
```



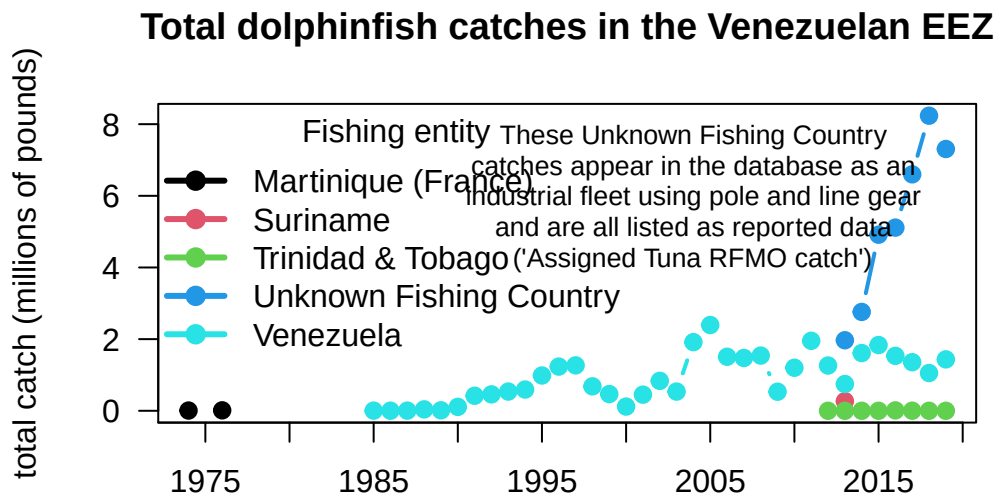
Here is another look at the catches within the venezuelan EEZ, separated by fishing entity.

```
# summarize Venezuela EEZ catches by fishing entity
tab <- tapply(v$pounds, list(v$year, v$fishing_entity), sum, na.rm = T)
head(tab)
```

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	Martinique (France)	Suriname	Trinidad & Tobago	Unknown Fishing Country
1974	7320.429	NA	NA	NA
1976	12814.641	NA	NA	NA
1985	NA	NA	NA	NA
1986	NA	NA	NA	NA
1987	NA	NA	NA	NA
1988	NA	NA	NA	NA
Venezuela				
1974	NA			
1976	NA			
1985	4699.563			
1986	2229.484			
1987	4585.610			
1988	39960.149			

```
matplot(rownames(tab), tab/10^6, las = 2, type = "b", lty = 1, lwd = 2, pch = 19, col = 1:5,
        xlab = "", ylab = "total catch (millions of pounds)", axes = F,
        main = "Total dolphinfish catches in the Venezuelan EEZ")
axis(1, at = seq(1950, 2020, 5)); axis(2, las = 2); box()
legend("topleft", colnames(tab), col = 1:5, pch = 19, lty = 1, lwd = 3, bty = "n", title =
text(2004, 6, cex = 0.8,
     "These Unknown Fishing Country\ncatches appear in the database as an\nindustrial fleet")
```



The very substantial increase in international Western Atlantic dolphin catches can be attributed solely to this Unknown Fishing Country catches which appear in the database beginning in 2013. The documentation of the catch reconstruction can be found in the Sea Around Us documentation files (see Mendoza et al. 2015). We spoke to Jeremy Mendoza and other experts who were involved in the reconstruction of domestic catches in Venezuela, and they noted that the “Assigned tuna RFMO catch” actually emerge from spatially reshuffled landing reports to ICCAT, according to the methods of Coulter et al. (2020). In this work, the Sea Around Us team developed a global spatial reallocation of landings of tunas and associated species that were reported to ICCAT. In short, this work uses the fraction of reported spatially disaggregated data to reallocate all data reported to ICCAT. This step is necessary because there are not many countries that report spatial data to ICCAT in the region, and this method may lead to a significant reallocation of landings from the Caribbean to the Venezuelan EEZ, where the local pole and line fishery is significant (J. Mendoza, personal communication). Thus, it is likely that landings from other EEZs, that were included in the reconstructed catch data layer, could have been reassigned to the Venezuelan EEZ.

Because there may be some overlap between the reconstructed data used in the national EEZ estimates, and the ICCAT reporting that was reassigned, there could potentially be a “double counting” of these catch estimates in the Sea Around Us database. We verified with Sea Around Us database managers that their method led to an error resulting in an overestimate of the catch, and they advised us to remove

these Unknown Fishing Country catches as they are difficult to trace back to the data source.

12.6 Compile catch in CAR and NED jurisdictional waters by discards and reporting type

Now that we have separated the EEZ catch by region, we will summarize it according to the areas used in the dolphin management strategy evaluation operating model. We will separate the catch by discards versus landings and reported versus unreported data so that we can use these data in various sensitivity analyses.

```
rm(list = ls()) # clear the workspace

# load data
load("data/outputs/SAU_EEZs_WCA.RData") # SAU EEZ data for NED and NCA saved from earlier
load("data/outputs/erroneous_catch_to_be_removed.RData") # double-counted catch values to

d <- dwest

# summarize the catch by area, discards/landings and reported/unreported
tapply(d$lbs, list(d$catch_type, d$reporting_status, d$reg), sum, na.rm = T)
```

, , Canadian EEZ

	Reported	Unreported
Discards	NA	NA
Landings	1220146	NA

, , Western Central Atlantic EEZs

	Reported	Unreported
Discards	NA	2179444
Landings	393279187	176215080

The catch from the Canadian EEZs is 100% landings, with no unreported data and no discards. In the WCA there are no reported discards, only unreported discards. Thus, we only need to separate out unreported discards and landings for the WCA.

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```
# summarize the catch by year, area, discards/landings and reported/unreported

d$year <- factor(d$year, levels = 1950:2019)
dc <- d[which(d$reg == "Canadian EEZ"), ]
dw <- d[which(d$reg == "Western Central Atlantic EEZs"), ]

# verify proper identification of the erroneous Venezuelan Unknown Fishing Country catches
bad <- dw[which(dw$area_name == "Venezuela" & dw$fishing_entity == "Unknown Fishing Country"), ]
#dim(bad)
bad_totals <- tapply(bad$lbs, bad$year, sum, na.rm = T)

cbind(tail(bad_totals, 10), tail(removecatch, 10)) # the numbers match exactly
```

	[,1]	[,2]
2010	NA	NA
2011	NA	NA
2012	NA	NA
2013	1968566	1968566
2014	2759603	2759603
2015	4915156	4915156
2016	5112450	5112450
2017	6599737	6599737
2018	8236857	8236857
2019	7307245	7307245

```
# now remove those bad catches from the database prior to summarizing
#dim(dw)
dw <- dw[-which(dw$area_name == "Venezuela" & dw$fishing_entity == "Unknown Fishing Country"), ]
#dim(dw)

CAN <- tapply(dc$lbs, list(dc$year, dc$catch_type, dc$reporting_status), sum, na.rm = T)
tail(CAN)
```

, , Reported

	Landings
2014	531022.55
2015	38945.76
2016	354370.65

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```
2017  83776.88
2018  12588.88
2019  36112.19
```

```
tab_dw <- tapply(dw$lbs, list(dw$year, dw$catch_type, dw$reporting_status), sum, na.rm = T)
tail(tab_dw)
```

, , Reported

	Discards	Landings
2014	NA	9923818
2015	NA	11590469
2016	NA	11225710
2017	NA	11702729
2018	NA	11460758
2019	NA	11066090

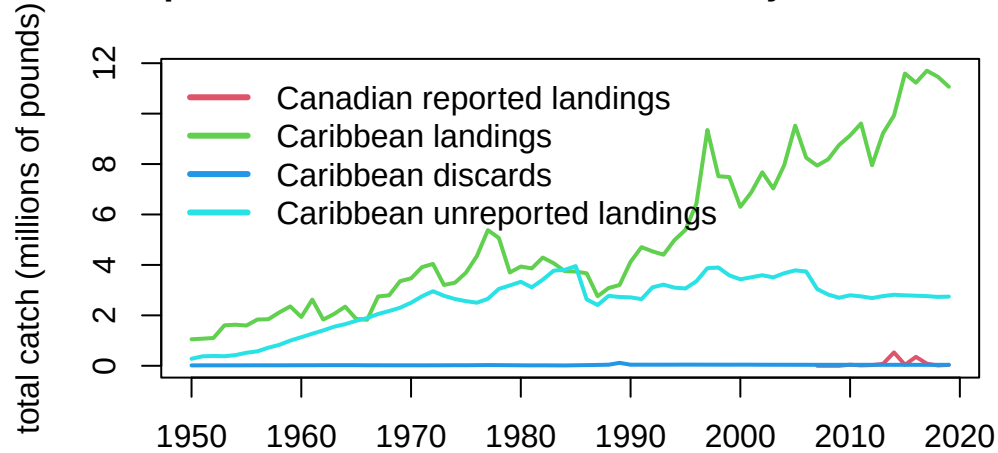
, , Unreported

	Discards	Landings
2014	38062.63	2816498
2015	39134.61	2794662
2016	38973.17	2778493
2017	38728.81	2762926
2018	38769.93	2732351
2019	38655.51	2743182

```
# combine CAR reported landings, unreported discards, unreported landings
CAR <- data.frame(cbind(tab_dw[, 2, 1], tab_dw[, , 2]))
names(CAR) <- c("landings", "discards", "unreported")

matplot(rownames(CAR), cbind(CAN, CAR)/10^6, type = "l", lwd = 2, lty = 1, col = 2:5,
        xlab = "", ylab = "total catch (millions of pounds)",
        main = "Total dolphinfish catches in NED and NCA jurisdictional waters")
legend("topleft", col = 2:5, c("Canadian reported landings", "Caribbean landings",
                              "Caribbean discards", "Caribbean unreported landings"), lty = 1, lwd =
```

Total dolphinfish catches in NED and NCA jurisdictional wa



```
round(sum(CAR$discards, na.rm = T) / (sum(CAR$discards, na.rm = T) + sum(CAR$landings, na.rm = T)), 2)
```

```
[1] 0.61
```

Note that the Caribbean unreported discards in the database are negligible (< 1%) and we exclude them from further analysis.

12.7 Distribute the territorial international catches across quarters of the year

The international catches are only reported as annual catches and do not have any month or season associated with them. However, the MSE operating model requires seasonal catches. Lacking other information on the seasonality of these fleets, we will assume that the fleet distribution of the U.S. pelagic longline is representative of the seasonality of the jurisdictional fleets. Now we parse the annual catches according to the seasonality of the U.S. fleet.

The pelagic longline logbook data is only available going back to 1997, but there are Caribbean catches extending back to the 1950s. To interpolate the seasonality for

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1986 - 1996, we take the average seasonality of the oldest 10 years of logbook data (1997 - 2006) and use those averages for the unknown years.

At the time of analysis, the SAU database only contained catches to 2019, so we interpolated the 2019 values to cover years 2020 - 2022.

```
#par(mar = c(5, 10, 3, 1))
#barplot(tapply(dw$lbs, dw$gear_type, sum, na.rm = T), horiz = T, las = 2)
#barplot(tapply(dc$lbs, dc$gear_type, sum, na.rm = T), horiz = T, las = 2)

# read in the percentage of the catch by area and year-quarter combinations from the U.S. P
load("data/outputs/per_PLLcatch_by_area_yearquarter.RData")

names(percatch[1, 1, ]) # matrix 2 == Caribbean, matrix 7 == NED (Atlantic Northwest)
```

```
[1] "NCA" "CAR" "FLK" "NCFL" "NNC" "VBM" "NED"
```

```
CAN <- CAN[which(rownames(CAN) >= 1997)] # PLL data are only available from 1997 on
CAN <- c(CAN, CAN[length(CAN)], CAN[length(CAN)], CAN[length(CAN)]) # interpolate 2019 cat

CANqrt <- percatch[, , 7] # create matrix for final catch data
for (i in 1:ncol(percatch)) {
  CANqrt[, i] <- percatch[, i, 7] * CAN[i] }

percatch_car <- percatch[, , 2] # create matrix for Caribbean percentages
int <- rowMeans(percatch_car[, 1:10]) # calculate the average seasonality using the oldest
percatch_car <- cbind(matrix(rep(int, length(1986:1996)), nrow = 4), percatch_car) # attac
colnames(percatch_car) <- 1986:2022 # full data frame for Caribbean seasonality 1986 - 20

CAR <- CAR[which(rownames(CAR) >= 1986), ] # only need Caribbean data from 1986 on
CAR <- rbind(CAR, CAR[nrow(CAR), ], CAR[nrow(CAR), ], CAR[nrow(CAR), ]) # interpolate 2019

#dim(CAR)
#dim(percatch_car)

CARrep <- percatch_car # create matrices for final catch data
CARunr <- percatch_car

for (i in 1:ncol(percatch_car)) {
  CARrep[, i] <- percatch_car[, i] * CAR[i, 1]
```

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```
CARunr[, i] <- percatch_car[, i] * CAR[i, 3]
}
```

```
# ensure sums are equal after parsing
sum(CARrep); sum(CAR$landings)
```

```
[1] 286220280
```

```
[1] 286220280
```

```
sum(CARunr); sum(CAR$unreported)
```

```
[1] 112754888
```

```
[1] 112754888
```

```
sum(CAN, na.rm = T); sum(CANqrt, na.rm = T)
```

```
[1] 1328482
```

```
[1] 1328482
```

The Canada jurisdictional data need to be combined with the NED high seas data calculated in the previous section, because both of these are a component of the international catches in the NED area.

```
load("data/outputs/NED_year_quarter.RData")
```

```
NEDtot <- NED + CANqrt
# ensure sums are correct
sum(NED, na.rm = T) + sum(CANqrt, na.rm = T); sum(NEDtot, na.rm = T)
```

```
[1] 1808855
```

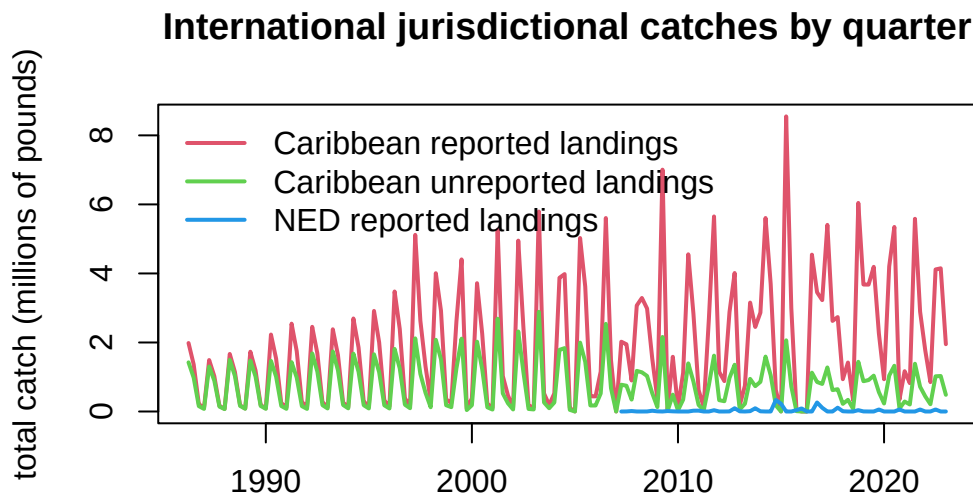
```
[1] 1808855
```

12 Analysis of international catches in territorial waters

```
NEDtot <- NEDtot[, !is.na(colSums(NEDtot))] # remove NA columns from CAN data

# plot the parsed out data by year-quarter
yrs <- sort(rep(as.numeric(colnames(CARrep)), 4))
qrt <- rep(1:4, length(yrs)/4)
yrs1 <- sort(rep(as.numeric(colnames(NEDtot)), 4))
qrt1 <- rep(1:4, length(yrs1)/4)

matplot(yrs + qrt/4, cbind(matrix(CARrep), matrix(CARunr))/10^6, lty = 1, lwd = 2,
        col = 2:3, type = "l", main = "International jurisdictional catches by quarter",
        xlab = "", ylab = "total catch (millions of pounds)")
lines(yrs1 + qrt1/4, as.numeric(matrix(NEDtot))/10^6, lwd = 2, col = 4)
legend("topleft", c("Caribbean reported landings", "Caribbean unreported landings", "NED re
        lwd = 2, col = 2:4, bty = "n")
```



Finally, we format the data in the format for input into the operating model.

```
# format for operating model - Caribbean
flt <- rep("Intl", length(yrs))
are <- rep("CAR", length(yrs))
fin1 <- data.frame(cbind(yrs, qrt, flt, are, matrix(CARrep)))
```

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```
flt <- rep("UnRep", length(yrs))
fin2 <- data.frame(cbind(yrs, qrt, flt, are, matrix(CARunr)))

findat <- data.frame(rbind(fin1, fin2), stringsAsFactors = FALSE)
names(findat) <- c("Year", "Quarter", "Fleet", "Area", "Catch_lbs")
findat$Catch_lbs <- as.numeric(findat$Catch_lbs)
head(findat)
```

	Year	Quarter	Fleet	Area	Catch_lbs
1	1986	1	Intl	CAR	1983610.3
2	1986	2	Intl	CAR	1363432.3
3	1986	3	Intl	CAR	216194.7
4	1986	4	Intl	CAR	104564.4
5	1987	1	Intl	CAR	1491251.1
6	1987	2	Intl	CAR	1025009.7

```
#plot(findat$Catch_lbs, type = "l")
#plot(findat$Catch_lbs ~ factor(findat$Fleet))
#plot(findat$Catch_lbs ~ factor(findat$Quarter))
#plot(findat$Catch_lbs ~ factor(findat$Year))
#apply(findat, 2, table)

# write the output file
write.csv(findat, file = "data/FINAL_files/CAR_Intl_unrep_TomFormat.csv", row.names = FALSE)

# format for operating model - NED
flt <- rep("Intl", length(yrs1))
are <- rep("NED", length(yrs1))
fin <- data.frame(cbind(yrs1, qrt1, flt, are, matrix(NEDtot)), stringsAsFactors = FALSE)
names(fin) <- c("Year", "Quarter", "Fleet", "Area", "Catch_lbs")
fin$Catch_lbs <- as.numeric(fin$Catch_lbs)
head(fin)
```

	Year	Quarter	Fleet	Area	Catch_lbs
1	2007	1	Intl	NED	0.000
2	2007	2	Intl	NED	1450.366
3	2007	3	Intl	NED	13279.912
4	2007	4	Intl	NED	0.000
5	2008	1	Intl	NED	0.000
6	2008	2	Intl	NED	1312.750

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```
#apply(fin, 2, table)

# write output file
write.csv(fin, file = "data/FINAL_files/NED_Intl_TomFormat.csv", row.names = FALSE)

#barplot(tapply(fin$Catch_lbs, list(fin$Quarter), sum, na.rm = T), col = rainbow(4))
```

12.8 References

Pauly D., Zeller D., Palomares M.L.D. (Editors), 2020. Sea Around Us Concepts, Design and Data (seaaroundus.org).

13 Data compilation for all fleets in the operating model

In this last step we will compile all of the output data files from the different data sources (NMFS commercial trip tickets, NMFS recreational statistics, Sea Around Us) and check the files for accuracy.

Recall that there are seven defined areas in the operating model, over which the catches are summed. Four of these areas are within the U.S. EEZ and the other three areas are international waters (high seas and jurisdictional waters of other countries).

13 Data compilation for all fleets in the operating model

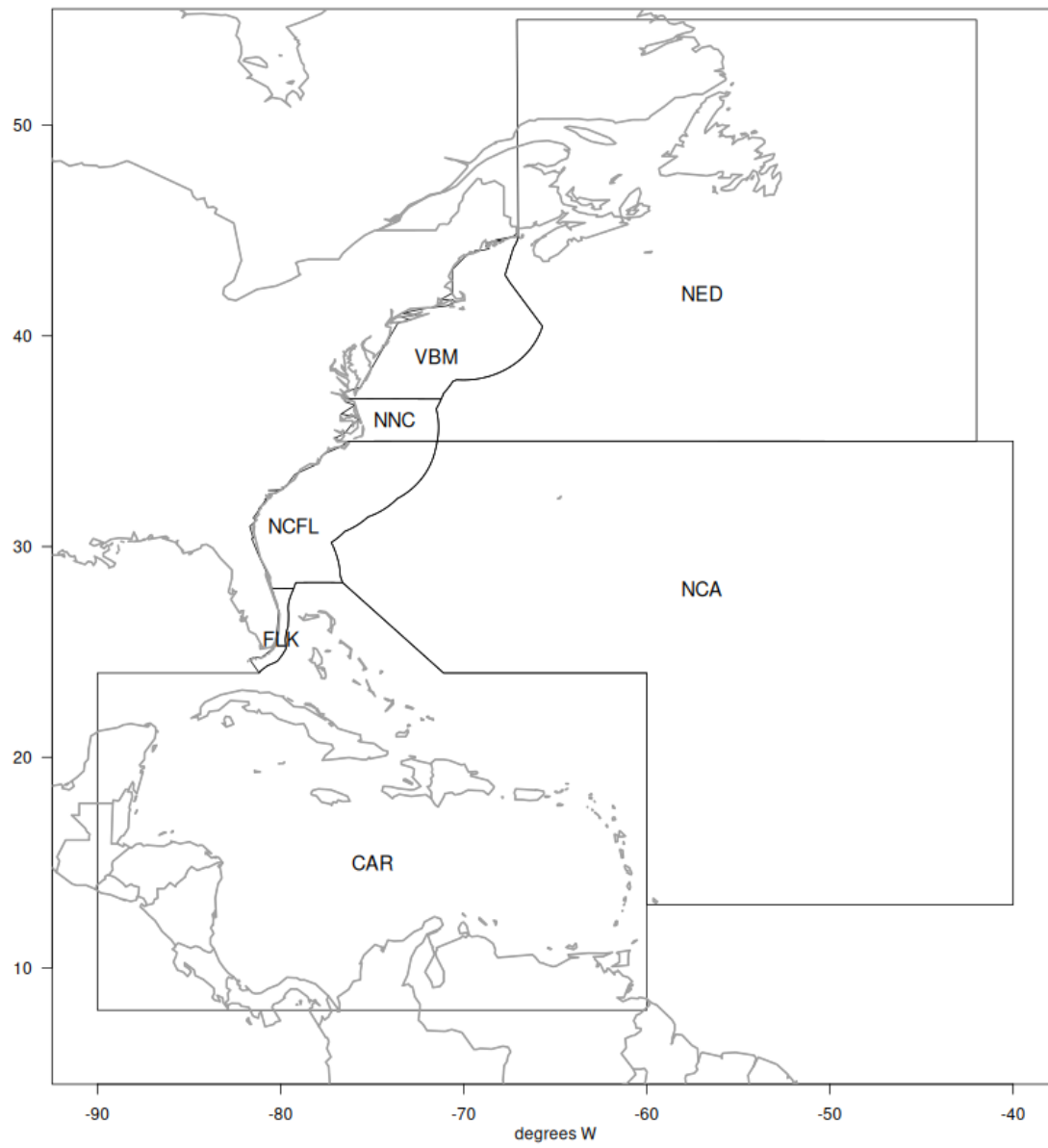


Figure 13.1: Areas defined in the operating model.

13.1 Data upload

First we access all of the final data files from the previous steps.

```
# clear workspace
rm(list = ls())

# view data files in directory
dir("data/FINAL_files/")
```

```
[1] "CAR_Intl_unrep_TomFormat.csv"
[2] "commercial_TomFormat.csv"
[3] "complete_catch_dataset_09052025b.csv"
[4] "NCA_Intl_TomFormat.csv"
[5] "NED_Intl_TomFormat.csv"
[6] "rec_catch_TomFormat.csv"
```

```
intc <- read.csv("data/FINAL_files/CAR_Intl_unrep_TomFormat.csv")
intn <- read.csv("data/FINAL_files/NCA_Intl_TomFormat.csv")
intw <- read.csv("data/FINAL_files/NED_Intl_TomFormat.csv")
com <- read.csv("data/FINAL_files/commercial_TomFormat.csv")
rec <- read.csv("data/FINAL_files/rec_catch_TomFormat.csv")
```

This file contains all international catches and unreported catches for the greater Caribbean region (jurisdictional waters of all countries). Recall that estimated discards were very small ($< 1\%$) and were removed from the summary.

```
apply(intc[1:4], 2, table, useNA = "always")
```

\$Year

1986	1987	1988	1989	1990	1991	1992	1993	1994	1995	1996	1997	1998	1999	2000	2001
8	8	8	8	8	8	8	8	8	8	8	8	8	8	8	8
2002	2003	2004	2005	2006	2007	2008	2009	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017
8	8	8	8	8	8	8	8	8	8	8	8	8	8	8	8
2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	<NA>										
8	8	8	8	8	0										

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\$Quarter

1	2	3	4	<NA>
74	74	74	74	0

\$Fleet

Intl	UnRep	<NA>
148	148	0

\$Area

CAR	<NA>
296	0

This file contains all international catches for the NCA region (i.e., FAO region 31), also known as the Western Central Atlantic. There are no territorial waters in this area (except for Bermuda, which as discussed previously is summarized with the CAR region) and there are no unreported catches or discards in the database.

```
apply(intn[1:4], 2, table, useNA = "always")
```

\$Year

1997	1998	1999	2000	2001	2002	2003	2004	2005	2006	2007	2008	2009	2010	2011	2012
4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	<NA>					
4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	0					

\$Quarter

1	2	3	4	<NA>
26	26	26	26	0

\$Fleet

Intl	<NA>
104	0

\$Area

13 Data compilation for all fleets in the operating model

```
NCA <NA>
104    0
```

This file contains all international catches for the NED region (i.e., FAO region 21), also known as the Northwest Atlantic. This includes NED high seas catches, as well as catches from Canadian and French territorial waters which fall in this region. There are no unreported catches or discards for this region in the database.

```
apply(intw[1:4], 2, table, useNA = "always")
```

\$Year

```
2007 2008 2009 2010 2011 2012 2013 2014 2015 2016 2017 2018 2019 2020 2021 2022
    4    4    4    4    4    4    4    4    4    4    4    4    4    4    4    4
<NA>
    0
```

\$Quarter

```
    1    2    3    4 <NA>
16   16   16   16    0
```

\$Fleet

```
Intl <NA>
64    0
```

\$Area

```
NED <NA>
64    0
```

This file contains all catches for the U.S. commercial fleet, including catches from U.S. EEZs and high seas. There are no unreported catches in this region. Recall that estimated dead discards were very small (< 2%) and were removed from the summary.

13 Data compilation for all fleets in the operating model

```
apply(com[1:4], 2, table, useNA = "always")
```

\$Year

1986	1987	1988	1989	1990	1991	1992	1993	1994	1995	1996	1997	1998	1999	2000	2001
28	28	28	28	28	28	28	28	28	28	28	28	28	28	28	28
2002	2003	2004	2005	2006	2007	2008	2009	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017
28	28	28	28	28	28	28	28	28	28	28	28	28	28	28	28
2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	<NA>										
28	28	28	28	28	0										

\$Quarter

1	2	3	4	<NA>	
259	259	259	259	0	

\$Fleet

UScom	<NA>				
1036	0				

\$Area

CAR	FLK	NCA	NCFL	NED	NNC	VBM	<NA>	
148	148	148	148	148	148	148	0	

This file contains all catches for the U.S. recreational fleet, which are all assumed to occur within the U.S. EEZs. There are no unreported catches in this region.

```
apply(rec[1:4], 2, table, useNA = "always")
```

\$Year

1986	1987	1988	1989	1990	1991	1992	1993	1994	1995	1996	1997	1998	1999	2000	2001
32	32	32	32	32	32	32	32	32	32	32	32	32	32	32	32
2002	2003	2004	2005	2006	2007	2008	2009	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017
32	32	32	32	32	32	32	32	32	32	32	32	32	32	32	32
2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	<NA>										
32	32	32	32	32	0										

13 Data compilation for all fleets in the operating model

\$Quarter

1	2	3	4	<NA>
296	296	296	296	0

\$Fleet

Hire	Rec	<NA>
592	592	0

\$Area

FLK	NCFL	NNC	VBM	<NA>
296	296	296	296	0

Now we combine the data files and create some figures with the final composite data file.

```
d <- rbind(intc, intn, intw, com, rec)

# how many rows contain zeros
#hist(d$Catch_lbs)
table(d$Catch_lbs == 0)
```

FALSE	TRUE
2047	637

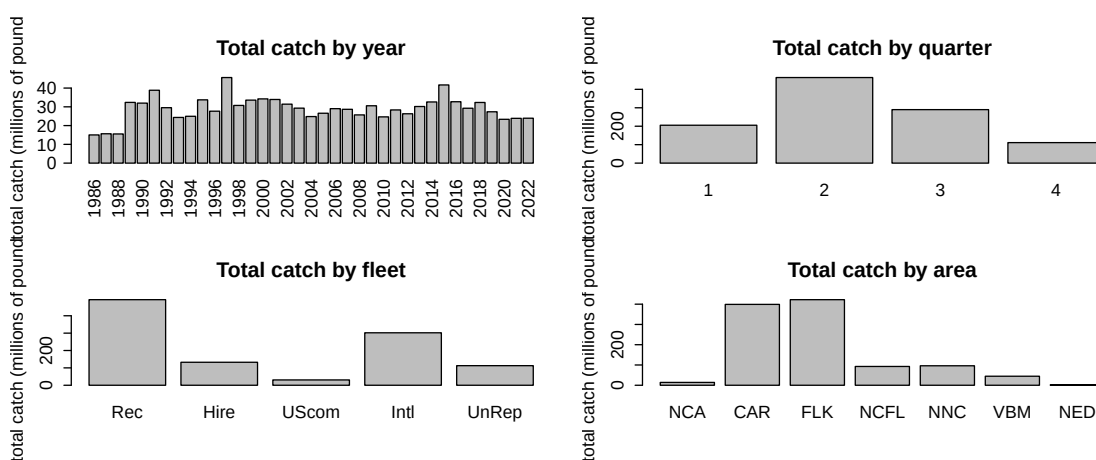
```
# resort levels geographically
d$Area <- factor(d$Area, levels = c("NCA", "CAR", "FLK", "NCFL", "NNC", "VBM", "NED"))
d$Fleet <- factor(d$Fleet, levels = c("Rec", "Hire", "UScom", "Intl", "UnRep"))
```

13.2 Visualizing the final data set

We plot the final data set in a number of different ways to detect any errors that may have occurred during processing.

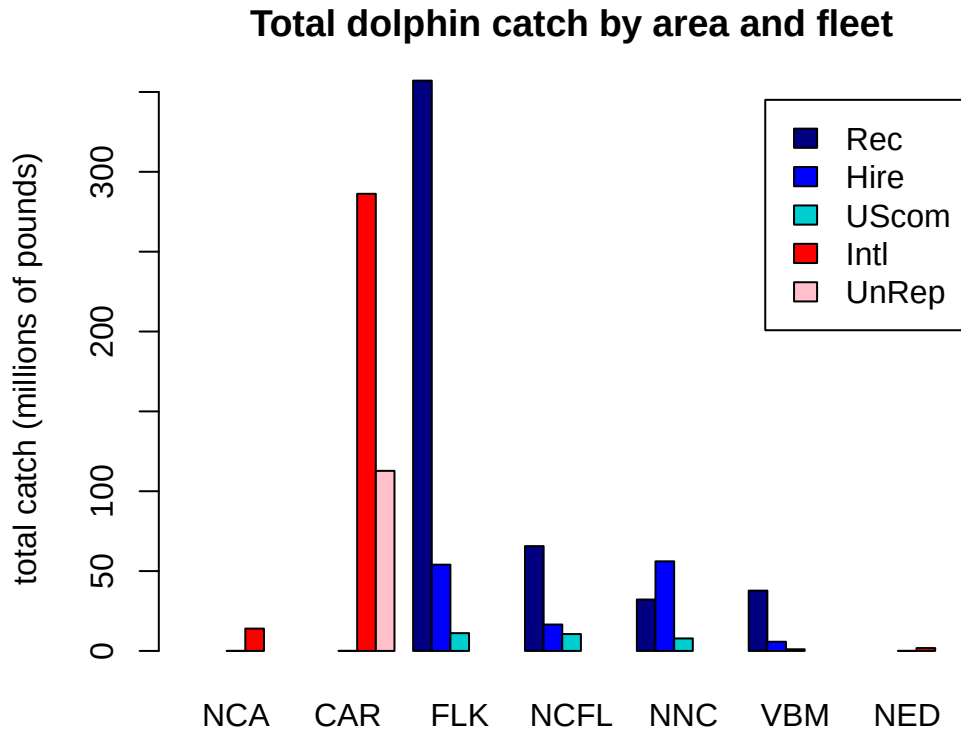
13 Data compilation for all fleets in the operating model

```
# plot the total catches by each factor
par(mfrow = c(2, 2), mex = 0.7)
barplot(tapply(d$Catch_lbs, d$Year, sum, na.rm = T)/10^6, las = 2,
        main = "Total catch by year", ylab = "total catch (millions of pounds)")
barplot(tapply(d$Catch_lbs, d$Quarter, sum, na.rm = T)/10^6,
        ylab = "total catch (millions of pounds)", main = "Total catch by quarter")
barplot(tapply(d$Catch_lbs, d$Fleet, sum, na.rm = T)/10^6,
        main = "Total catch by fleet", ylab = "total catch (millions of pounds)")
barplot(tapply(d$Catch_lbs, d$Area, sum, na.rm = T)/10^6,
        main = "Total catch by area", ylab = "total catch (millions of pounds)")
```



The total catch in the regions analyzed is highly variable but relatively stable over time with a slight decrease in recent years. Most of the catch is caught in quarter 2 (March - May). The largest sector is the U.S. private recreational sector, followed by international fleets (all types), the for-hire fleet and then the U.S. commercial fleet. Most of the fishing activity takes place in the Florida Keys and the Greater Caribbean, with other regions contributing much less.

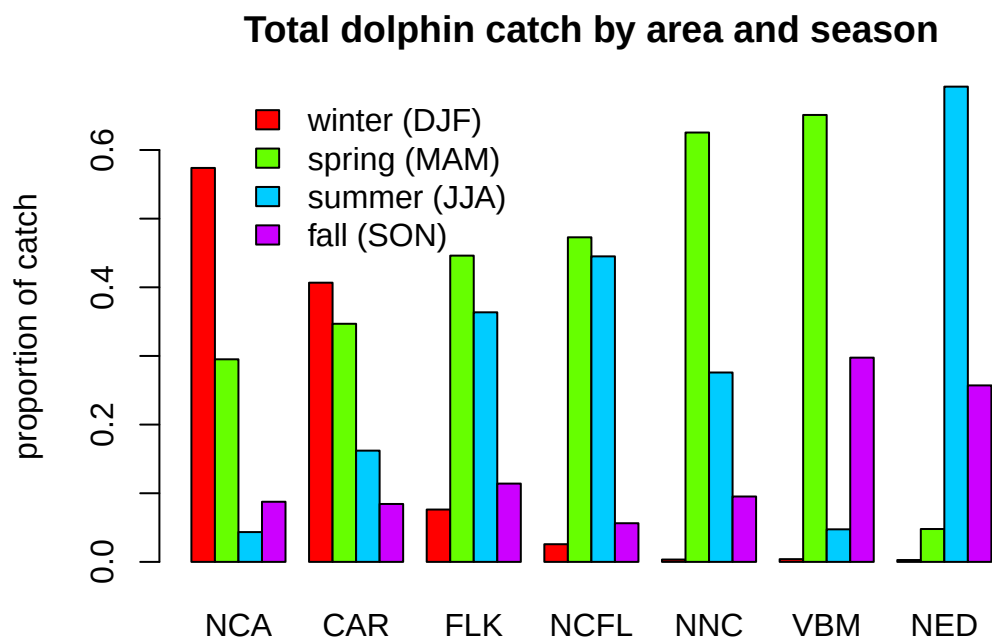
```
par(mfrow = c(1, 1), mar = c(2, 5, 3, 1))
tab <- tapply(d$Catch_lbs, list(d$Fleet, d$Area), sum, na.rm = T)/10^6
barplot(tab, beside = T, col = c("navy", "blue", "darkturquoise", "red", "pink"),
        , legend = rownames(tab),
        main = "Total dolphin catch by area and fleet",
        ylab = "total catch (millions of pounds)")
```



As expected, U.S. recreational fishing (private and for-hire) only takes place in the four U.S. EEZ regions (FLK, NCFL, NNC and VBM). The U.S. commercial fishery operates largely in those four U.S. EEZ regions, with small amounts of catch in the high seas of NCA, CAR and NED regions. International catches occur largely in the Caribbean, with lesser amounts in the NCA and NED high seas regions.

```
tab <- tapply(d$Catch_lbs, list(d$Quarter, d$Area), sum, na.rm = T)/10^6
tabp <- apply(tab, 2, function(x) x / sum(x, na.rm = T))

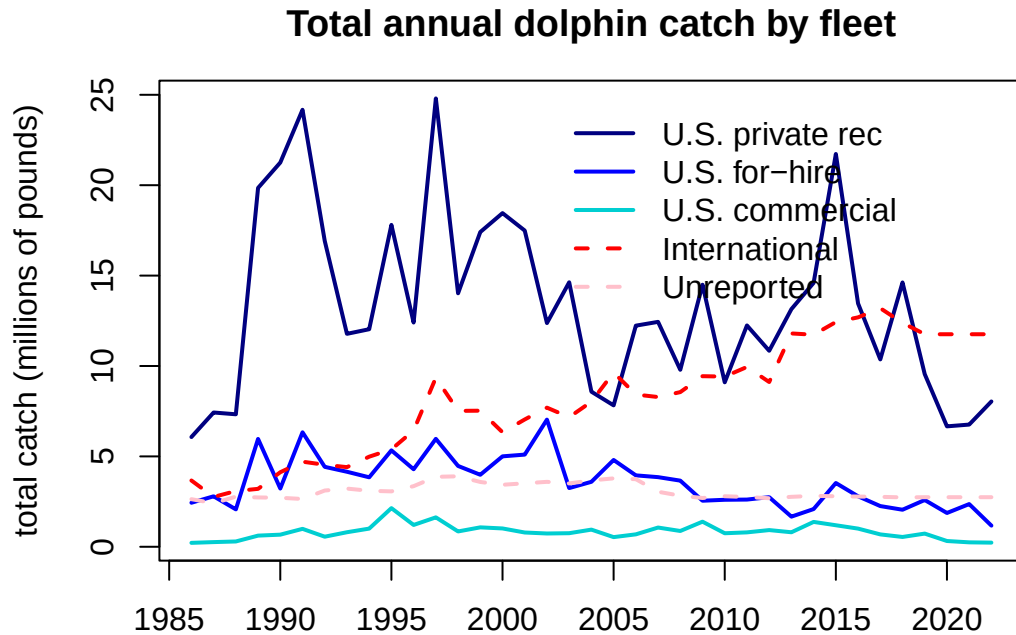
par(mar = c(2, 4, 3, 1))
barplot(tabp, beside = T, col = rainbow(4, end = 0.8),
        legend = c("winter (DJF)", "spring (MAM)", "summer (JJA)", "fall (SON)"),
        args.legend = list(x = 15, y = 0.7, bty = "n"),
        main = "Total dolphin catch by area and season",
        ylab = "proportion of catch")
```



This plot shows the seasonal movements of dolphin across the different regions, as expressed through the proportion of catch that occurs in each quarter within each area. In the NCA and CAR regions, most of the catch occurs in winter, whereas in the U.S. South Atlantic regions, most of the catch occurs in spring and summer. In the U.S. Mid-Atlantic the catch also occurs largely in spring, and also fall. In the NED region most of the catch occurs in summer.

```
tab <- tapply(d$Catch_lbs, list(d$Year, d$Fleet), sum, na.rm = T)/106

par(mar = c(2, 4, 3, 1))
matplot(rownames(tab), tab,
        col = c("navy", "blue", "darkturquoise", "red", "pink"),
        type = "l", lwd = 2, lty = c(rep(1, 3), 2, 2),
        main = "Total annual dolphin catch by fleet", xlab = "",
        ylab = "total catch (millions of pounds)")
legend(2002, 25, lwd = 2, lty = c(rep(1, 3), 2, 2), bty = "n",
      c("U.S. private rec", "U.S. for-hire", "U.S. commercial",
        "International", "Unreported"),
      col = c("navy", "blue", "darkturquoise", "red", "pink"))
```



This plot shows the time series of total annual dolphin catches by fleet. We can compare these figures with the plots from the previous chapters to ensure the data were processed correctly. The magnitude and variability of the catches match the expectations.

```
# output the final concatenated data file
write.csv(d, file = "data/FINAL_files/complete_catch_dataset_09052025b.csv", row.names = FALSE)

d1 <- d[which(d$Year == 2022), ]
d1$ar2 <- ""
d1$ar2[which(d1$Area == "FLK")] <- "S"
d1$ar2[which(d1$Area == "NCFL")] <- "S"
d1$ar2[which(d1$Area == "NNC")] <- "N"
d1$ar2[which(d1$Area == "VBM")] <- "N"
d1$cat <- paste0(d1$Fleet, d1$ar2)
d1$cat[which(d1$Fleet == "UScom")] <- "UScom"

round(tapply(d1$Catch_lbs, d1$cat, sum, na.rm = T)/10^6/2.205, 3)
```

```
HireN HireS Intl RecN RecS UnRep UScom
```

13 Data compilation for all fleets in the operating model

0.202 0.329 5.332 0.643 3.002 1.244 0.104

14 Predictive indices of dolphin abundance

Dolphin abundance in South Atlantic waters is driven by a combination of factors that are mostly outside of U.S. fishery management control, including environmental conditions and catch in international waters. In order to create a management procedure for the dolphin management strategy evaluation we need an index that can predict ahead of time whether the abundance of dolphin in U.S. waters is likely to be above or below average in a given year. Ideally this index can capture the dynamics early in the year or a season ahead in order to allow adequate time for management response. In the following sections we explore potential predictive indices of dolphin abundance.

14.1 Recreational catch as a proxy for availability

Because the recreational catch is generally unconstrained by management (the total catch quota is rarely reached and catches are on average well below the bag limits), the total recreational catch could serve as a proxy for dolphin availability in South Atlantic waters over time. We take the recreational data from Section 3 and summarize according to the areas specified by the management strategy evaluation: Florida Keys to Indian River County County (FLK), Brevard to Southern NC South of Hatteras (NCFL), Northern NC North of Hatteras to NC/VA border (NNC), and Virginia to Maine (VBM). We also include Gulf of America catches because dolphin are not managed in the Gulf region and thus the catch is not constrained by management and is most likely a function of availability.

```
# clear workspace
rm(list = ls())

# install library
if(!require("readr")) install.packages("readr")
library(readr)

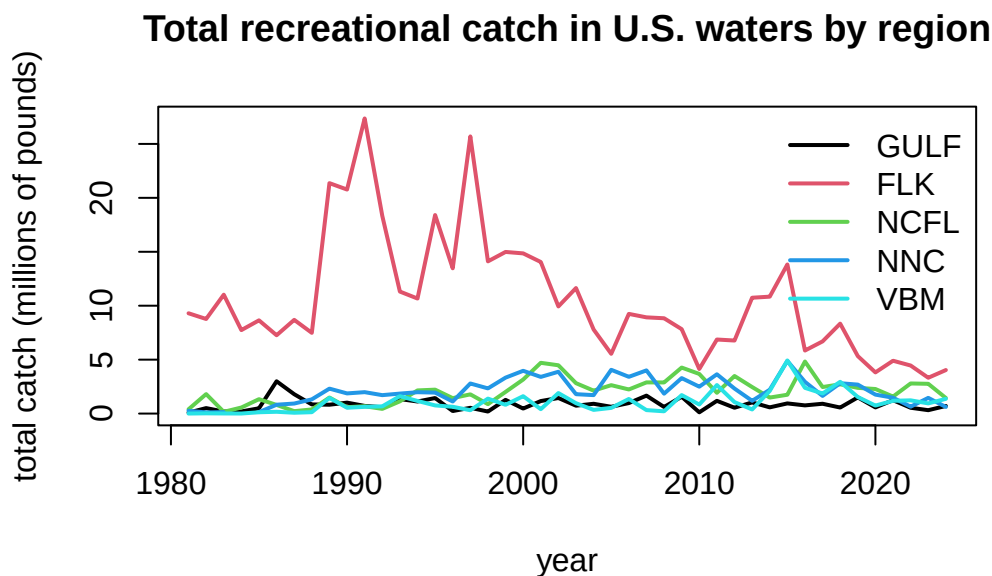
# read in data file
```

```
rec <- read.csv("data/recLandings.csv")
names(rec)[1] <- "Year"
```

14.2 Plot the recreational landings

Plotting the total recreational catch by region and the proportion of catch by region, we can observe that most of the catch in U.S. waters came from the FLK region, particularly in the earlier years. More recently, an increasing proportion of the catch has been coming from NCFL and further north, with FLK composing only about 50% of the catch. Gulf catches have historically been a small proportion of the total catch and have remained small throughout time. Catches in the VBM region were historically very small (~1%) but in recent years have varied between 10-18% of the catch.

```
# plot landings -----
matplot(rec$Year, rec[2:6]/10^6, type = "l", lty = 1, lwd = 2, col = 1:5,
        xlab = "year", ylab = "total catch (millions of pounds)",
        main = "Total recreational catch in U.S. waters by region")
legend("topright", colnames(rec)[2:6], col = 1:5, lty = 1, lwd = 2, bty = "n")
```

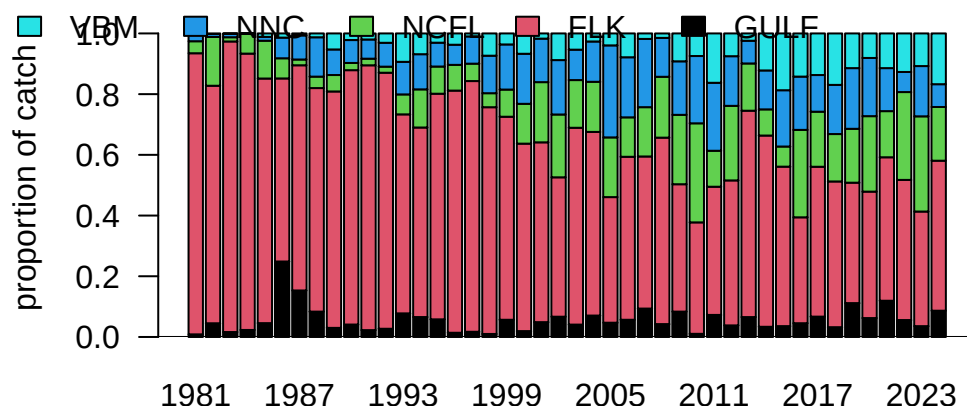


14 Predictive indices of dolphin abundance

```
# plot in terms of percentages -----
rec1 <- rec[2:6]
rec1 <- as.matrix(rec1/rowSums(rec1, na.rm = T))
rec1[is.na(rec1)] <- 0

b <- barplot(t(rec1), col = 1:5, names.arg = rec$Year, las = 1, ylim = c(0, 1.05),
             ylab = "proportion of catch",
             main = "Proportion of recreational catch in U.S. waters by region",
             legend.text = colnames(rec)[2:6], args.legend = list(x = 45, y = 1.15, horiz =
abline(h=0)
```

Proportion of recreational catch in U.S. waters by region



```
# calculate total catch and South Atlantic catch for later analysis
rec$ATL <- rowSums(rec[3:6], na.rm = T)
rec$ALL <- rec$GULF + rec$ATL

# subset data from 1990 forward
rec <- rec[which(rec$Year >= 1990), ]
```

Recreational monitoring was first established in 1979 and went through a number of changes in the 1980s, particularly related to monitoring of the for-hire fleet. We can

see a very large jump in catches in the late 1980s that we suspect is related to some of these changes in methodology. For our data explorations we will use recreational data from 1990 forward as a reference period in which the monitoring was more standardized.

14.3 Potential influence of El Niño Southern Oscillation

We note that many large peaks in recreational catch have occurred in years where there were severe El Niño events (e.g., 1997-1998, 2015). We first explore the El Niño Southern Oscillation (ENSO) as a potential environmental predictor of dolphin abundance. An index based on El Niño is potentially attractive because there is some ability for seasonal predictions of El Niño (3-6 months ahead of time). As large-scale disruptors of atmospheric conditions across the globe, El Niño events have impacts on the distribution of temperatures in the Atlantic and could trigger changes in fish distributions.

We use the multivariate ENSO index from NOAA's Physical Sciences Laboratory, which combines the influences of five different variables related to Pacific Ocean state into one index. The index is updated monthly and historical data can be downloaded directly from the site.

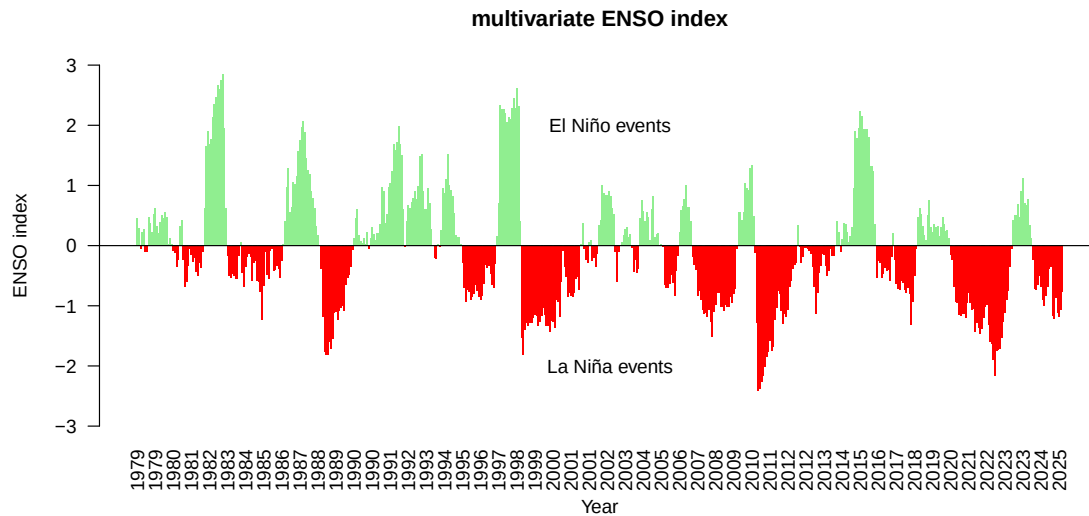
```
#download ENSO index
url <- "https://www.psl.noaa.gov/enso/mei/data/meiv2.data"
download.file(url = url, destfile = "data/enso.txt")

all_lines <- readLines("data/enso.txt")
footer_start <- grep("-999", all_lines)
e <- read.table("data/enso.txt", skip = 1, nrow = footer_start[1] - 2)
names(e) <- c("Year", "DJ", "JF", "FM", "MA", "AM", "MJ", "JJ", "JA", "AS", "SO", "ON", "ND")

ets <- as.vector(as.matrix(t(e[2:13])))
years <- sort(rep(e$Year, 12)) + rep((0:11)/12, length(min(e$Year):max(e$Year)))

barplot(ets, names.arg = floor(years), las = 2,
        col = ifelse(ets >= 0, "lightgreen", "red"), border = NA, ylim = c(-3, 3),
        main = "multivariate ENSO index", xlab = "Year", ylab = "ENSO index")
abline(h = 0)
text(346, 2, "El Niño events")
text(346, -2, "La Niña events")
```

14 Predictive indices of dolphin abundance



Here is the raw time series, showing positive and negative anomalies in the ENSO state.

Now we will compare the ENSO index to the recreational catches. First we compare the annual average ENSO index to the catches from the different regions. We report adjusted R-squared values and p-values for linear regression of the ENSO index versus the catches; significant relationships are highlighted in blue.

```
# calculate mean
e$mean <- rowMeans(e[2:13], na.rm = T)

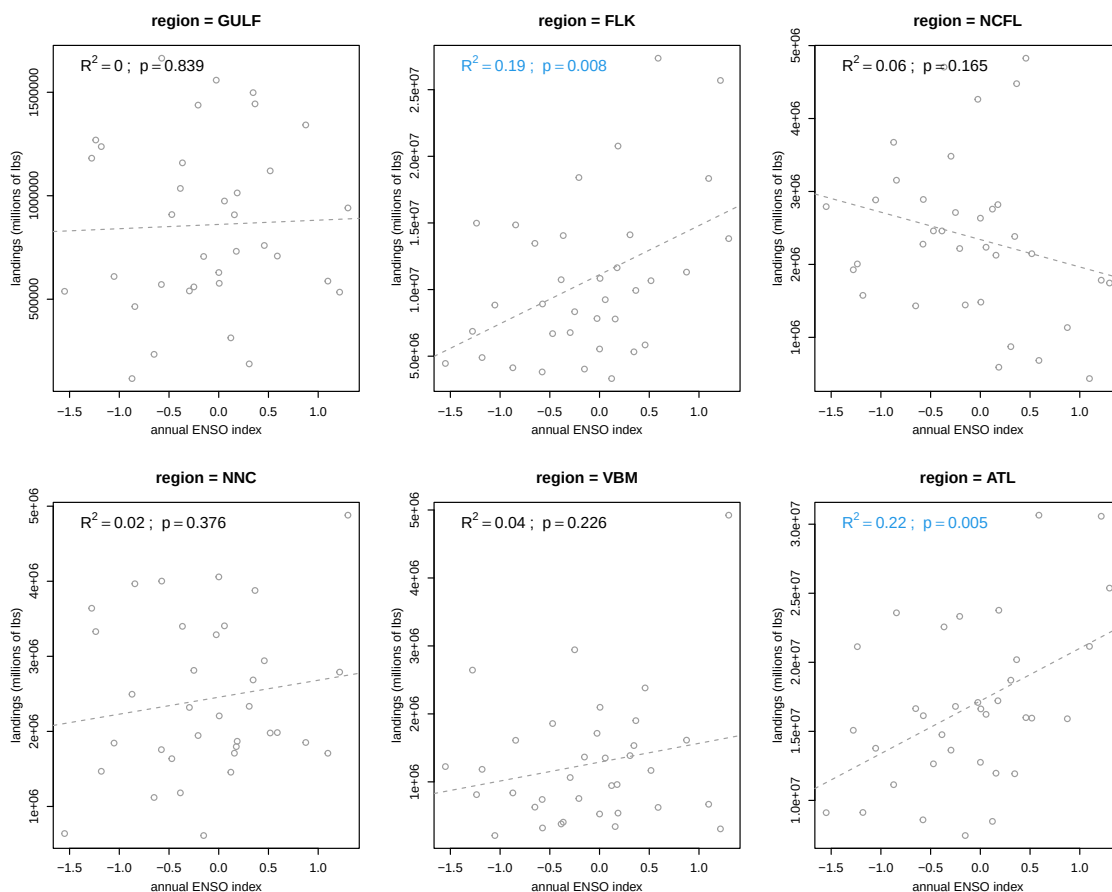
# merge years with recreational catch data
d <- merge(rec, e, by = "Year")
#head(d)

lis <- names(d)[2:7]
par(mfrow = c(2, 3), mex = 0.8, mgp = c(2.5, 1, 0))
for(i in 1:6) {
  catch <- d[, which(names(d) == lis[i])]
  plot(d$mean, catch, xlab = "annual ENSO index", ylab = "landings (millions of lbs)",
       col = 8, main = paste0("region = ", lis[i]))
  out <- lm(catch ~ d$mean)
  abline(out, col = 8, lty = 2)

  r2 <- summary(out)$r.squared
```

14 Predictive indices of dolphin abundance

```
p_val <- summary(out)$coefficients[2, 4]
p_display <- ifelse(p_val < 0.001, "p < 0.001", paste("p =", round(p_val, 3)))
co <- 1
if (p_val < 0.01) { co <- 4 }
if (p_val < 0.001) { co <- 5 }
legend("topleft",
      legend = bquote(R^2 == .(round(r2, 2)) ~ "; " ~ p == .(round(p_val, 3))),
      bty = "n", cex = 1.2, text.col = co)
}
```



The ENSO index appears to be most closely related to the total recreational catch across the South Atlantic (driven primarily by catches in the FLK region). The relationship is highly significant and the ENSO index explains 19% of the variation in the total catches.

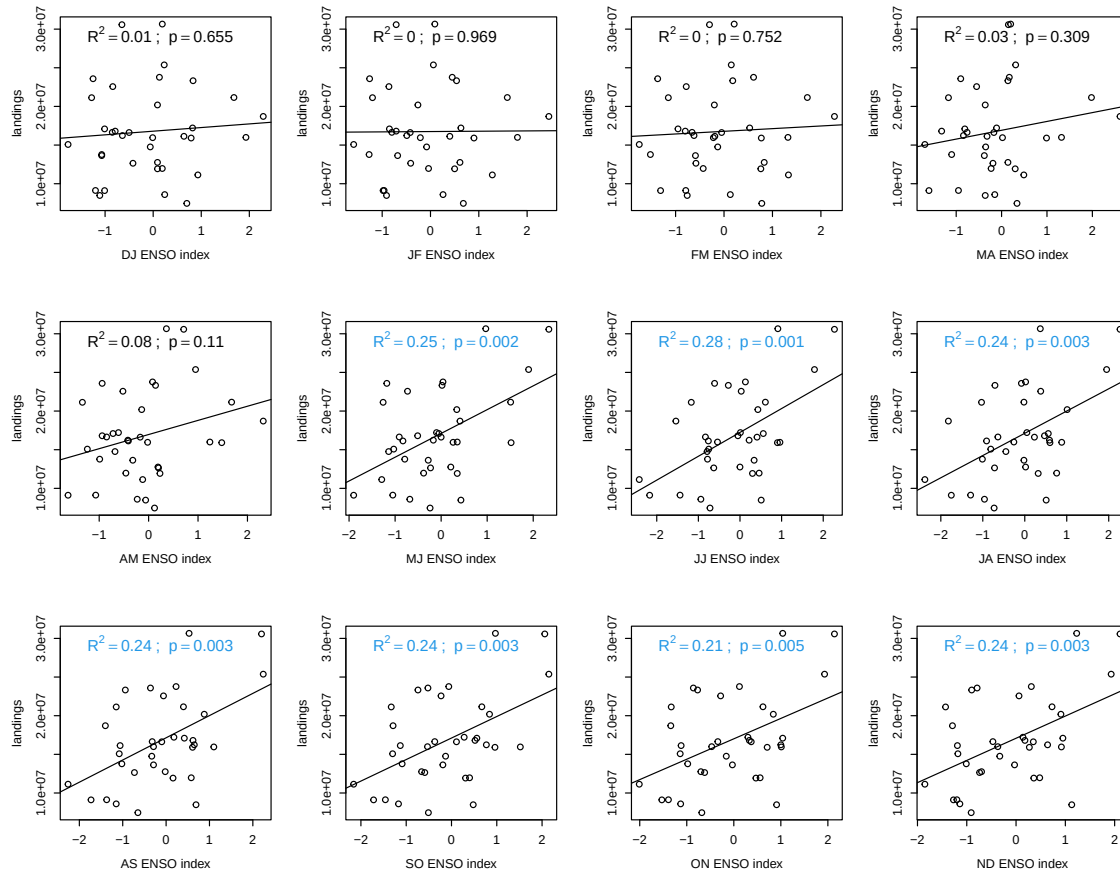
14.4 Seasonal influence of El Niño Southern Oscillation

Now we will consider the seasonal influence of ENSO, looking at correlations between the index during individual months and the catches. Since the strongest relationship occurs with the total South Atlantic catch, we will use these catches in the analysis.

```
lis <- names(e)[2:13]
par(mfrow = c(3, 4), mex = 0.8)
for(i in 1:12) {
  ind <- d[, which(names(d) == lis[i])]
  plot(ind, d$ATL, xlab = paste(lis[i], "ENSO index"), ylab = "landings")
  out <- lm(d$ATL ~ ind)
  abline(out)

  r2 <- summary(out)$r.squared
  p_val <- summary(out)$coefficients[2, 4]
  p_display <- ifelse(p_val < 0.001, "p < 0.001", paste("p =", round(p_val, 3)))
  co <- 1
  if (p_val < 0.01) { co <- 4 }
  if (p_val < 0.001) { co <- 5 }
  legend("topleft",
        legend = bquote(R^2 == .(round(r2, 2)) ~ "; " ~ p == .(round(p_val, 3))),
        bty = "n", cex = 1.2, text.col = co)
}
```

14 Predictive indices of dolphin abundance



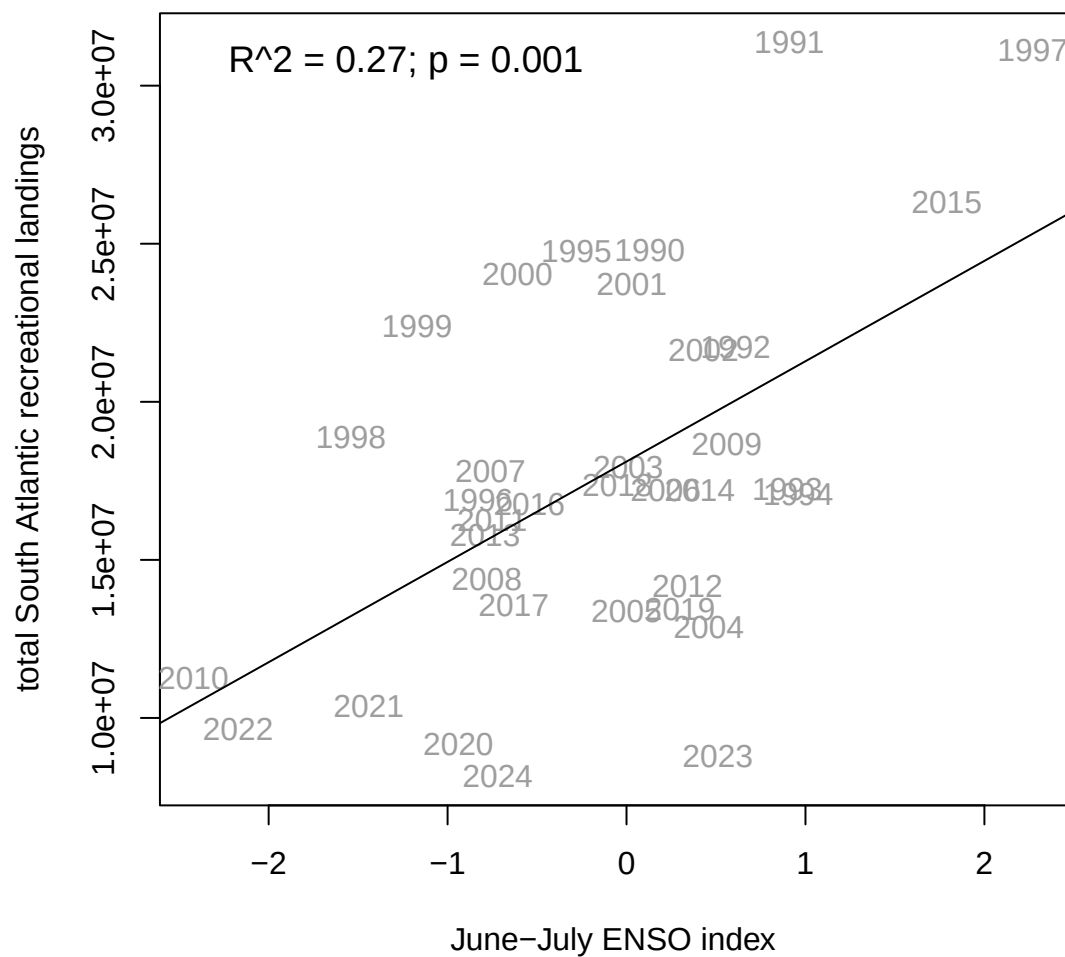
A significant relationship between the monthly ENSO index and total South Atlantic recreational landings occurs with the May-June index, but the strongest relationship occurs in June-July (with 28% of the variance in landings explained by the index in that month). The relationship in the late summer and fall months are also significant, which is expected since the ENSO index is highly correlated from month to month.

We will test the June-July ENSO index in the management procedure as it has the strongest relationship.

```
par(mfrow = c(1, 1))
plot(d$JJ, d$ALL, xlab = "June-July ENSO index", ylab = "total South Atlantic recreational
text(d$JJ, d$ALL, d$Year, col = 8)
out <- lm(d$ALL ~ d$JJ)
abline(out, col = 1)
p <- summary(out)$coef[2, 4]
```

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```
legend("topleft", paste0("R^2 = ", round(summary(out)$adj.r.squared, 2), "; p = ",
                          round(p, 3)), cex = 1.2, bty = "n", text.col = 1)
```



```
summary(out)
```

Call:

14 Predictive indices of dolphin abundance

```
lm(formula = d$ALL ~ d$JJ)
```

Residuals:

Min	1Q	Median	3Q	Max
-10935438	-3445376	-196026	2340561	10363627

Coefficients:

	Estimate	Std. Error	t value	Pr(> t)
(Intercept)	18110117	866688	20.896	< 2e-16 ***
d\$JJ	3173692	870635	3.645	0.00091 ***

Signif. codes: 0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1

Residual standard error: 5061000 on 33 degrees of freedom

Multiple R-squared: 0.2871, Adjusted R-squared: 0.2655

F-statistic: 13.29 on 1 and 33 DF, p-value: 0.0009095

```
# save the index to the indices file
```

```
ind <- data.frame(cbind(d$Year, d$JJ))
```

```
write.csv(ind, file = "indices/enso_index.csv", row.names = F)
```

15 Impacts of Atlantic temperature distribution

Dolphins have a circumtropical distribution, migrating to temperate waters in summer and tropical waters in winter, in a circular pattern around the Atlantic Ocean. Studies using satellite tagging have shown that, similar to other highly migratory species, they prefer waters within a narrow temperature range, of 27-30 degrees Celsius Schlenker et al. 2021. To determine whether shifting temperature distributions across the Atlantic could be impacting the abundance in U.S. waters, we analyzed Atlantic Ocean temperature patterns at the large spatial and temporal scale.

15.1 Accessing temperature data

For this analysis we need a historical temperature record that is available at large spatial (entire Atlantic) and temporal (monthly-yearly) scales. We use NOAA's Extended Reconstructed Sea Surface Temperature (ERSST) data, provided by the NOAA National Centers for Environmental Information and available through ERDDAP. This temperature record goes back to the mid-1800s, is available at monthly time steps and a 2°x2° grid size resolution, and is suitable for looking at large-scale patterns over decades. We download the data from 1980 - present and subset for the Atlantic Ocean from 100°W - 0°W longitude and 0°N - 70°N latitude.

```
# clear workspace
rm(list = ls())

# install libraries
if(!require("maps")) install.packages("maps")
# if(!require("ncdf4")) install.packages("ncdf4")
# if(!require("lubridate")) install.packages("lubridate")
# if(!require("rerddap")) install.packages("rerddap")

library(maps)
```

15 Impacts of Atlantic temperature distribution

```
# library(ncdf4)
# library(lubridate)
# library(rerddap)

# get ERDDAP info
# id <- info('nceiErsstv5') #https://coastwatch.pfeg.noaa.gov/erddap/griddap/nceiErsstv5.

# download data using griddap - initially takes a long time
# uncomment lines below to update analysis
#sst_grab <- griddap(id, fields = 'sst',
#                    time = c('1980-01-15', '2025-12-15'),
#                    longitude = c(260, 358), latitude = c(0, 70))

# open nc file and extract variables
# nc <- nc_open(sst_grab$summary$filename, write=FALSE, readunlim=TRUE, verbose=FALSE)
# v1 <- nc$var[[1]]
# sst <- ncvar_get(nc, v1)
# lon <- v1$dim[[1]]$vals - 360
# lat <- v1$dim[[2]]$vals
# nc_close(nc)

# save(v1, sst, lon, lat, file = "data/ERSST.RData")

load("data/ERSST.RData")

# convert time variable to month and year
tim <- as.POSIXct(v1$dim[[4]]$vals, origin = "1970-01-01")
mon <- as.numeric(substr(tim, 6, 7))
yr <- substr(tim, 1, 4)
dim(sst)
```

```
[1] 50 36 552
```

```
# check conversions
tim[1:5]
```

```
[1] "1980-01-01 UTC" "1980-02-01 UTC" "1980-03-01 UTC" "1980-04-01 UTC"
[5] "1980-05-01 UTC"
```

15 Impacts of Atlantic temperature distribution

```
table(mon)
```

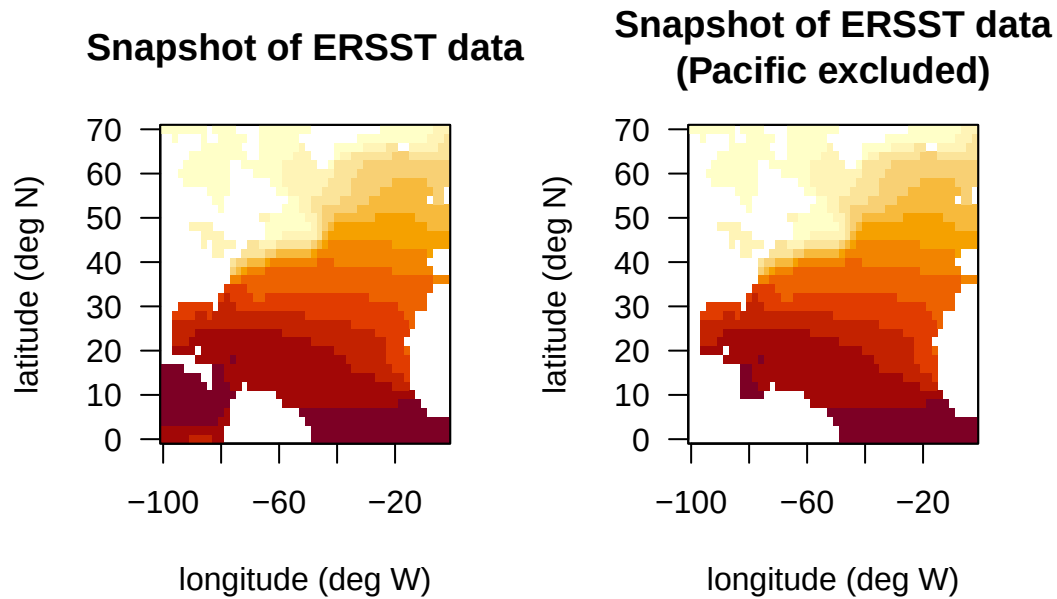
```
mon
 1  2  3  4  5  6  7  8  9 10 11 12
46 46 46 46 46 46 46 46 46 46 46 46
```

```
table(yr)
```

```
yr
1980 1981 1982 1983 1984 1985 1986 1987 1988 1989 1990 1991 1992 1993 1994 1995
   12   12   12   12   12   12   12   12   12   12   12   12   12   12   12   12
1996 1997 1998 1999 2000 2001 2002 2003 2004 2005 2006 2007 2008 2009 2010 2011
   12   12   12   12   12   12   12   12   12   12   12   12   12   12   12   12
2012 2013 2014 2015 2016 2017 2018 2019 2020 2021 2022 2023 2024 2025
   12   12   12   12   12   12   12   12   12   12   12   12   12   12
```

```
# plot SST on map for first time step
par(mfrow = c(1, 2))
image(lon, lat, sst[, , 100], las = 1, xlab = "longitude (deg W)", ylab = "latitude (deg N)",
      main = "Snapshot of ERSST data"); box()

# fill Pacific Ocean with NAs so values are not included
sst[which(lon <= (-92)), which(lat <= 17.5), ] <- NA
sst[which(lon <= (-85)), which(lat <= 15), ] <- NA
sst[which(lon <= (-83)), which(lat <= 10), ] <- NA
sst[which(lon <= (-77)), which(lat <= 8.5), ] <- NA
sst[which(lon <= (-78) & lon >= (-80)), which(lat <= 9), ] <- NA
image(lon, lat, sst[, , 100], las = 1, xlab = "longitude (deg W)", ylab = "latitude (deg N)",
      main = "Snapshot of ERSST data\n(Pacific excluded)"); box()
```



15.2 Analyzing high and low availability years

In order to identify potential temperature patterns that are influential in driving dolphin abundance in the U.S. South Atlantic waters, we identify the years of highest and lowest landings and look at the temperature distributions monthly in those years.

```
# upload recreational landings
rec <- read.csv("data/recLandings.csv")
names(rec)[1] <- "Year"

# summarize by basin and total
rec$ATL <- rowSums(rec[3:6], na.rm = T)
rec$ALL <- rec$GULF + rec$ATL

# consider 1990 and forward
rec <- rec[which(rec$Year >= 1990), ]

# sort years from lowest to higher catches
sortyr <- rec$Year[order(rec$ALL)]
```

15 Impacts of Atlantic temperature distribution

```
# cols <- rainbow(100, start = 0.1, end = 0.65)[100:1]
cols <- c(0, rainbow(3, start = 0.4, end = 0.6), 2)

# set up plot
nf <- layout(matrix(c(2:56, rep(1, 11), 57:111), 11, 11, byrow = FALSE),
                c(rep(3, 5), 2, rep(3, 5)), c(4, rep(3, 11)))
#layout.show(nf)

#legend
par(mar = c(0, 0, 0, 0))
plot(1, type = "n", axes = FALSE, xlab = "", ylab = "")
legend("center", fill = cols, c("<26", "26-27", "27-28.5", "28.5-30", ">30"),
      border = c(1, 0, 0, 0, 0),
      pt.cex = 2, bty = "n",
      title = "SST\n(deg C)", title.font = 2)

# sort years from lowest to highest landings
yrs <- c(sortyr[1:5], sortyr[(length(sortyr)-4): length(sortyr)])
#yrs
status <- c(rep("low", 5), rep("high", 5))
status[1] <- "lowest"
status[10] <- "highest"

# for lowest and highest years, visualize temperature patterns across the Atlantic
for (j in 1: length(yrs)) {
  k <- which(yr == yrs[j])
  par(mex = 0.5, mar = c(2, 2, 2, 2)+1)
  plot(rec$Year, rec$ALL/10^6, type = "l", col = 4, ylim = c(0, 32), lwd = 2, ylab = "rec c
        main = yrs[j])
  text(1990, 3, status[j], pos = 4)
  abline(v = yrs[j], col = 8, lwd = 3)

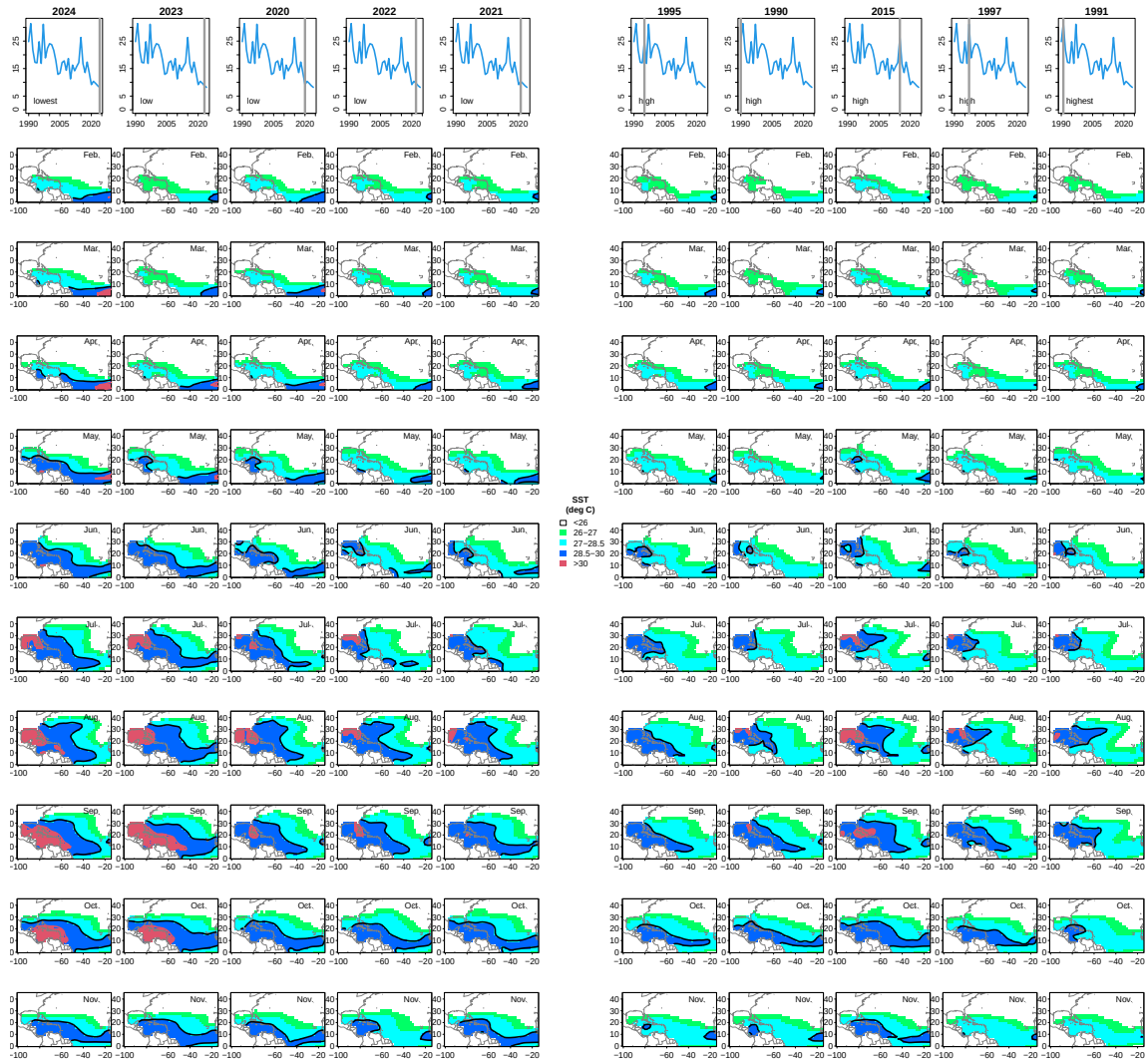
  # plot months February through November
  for (i in k[2:11]) {
    par(mex = 0.3, mar = c(2, 3, 2, 0))
    map("world", xlim = c(-100, -15), ylim = c(0, 45), col = 0)
    axis(1); axis(2, las = 2); box()
    image(lon, lat, sst[, , i], add = T, col = cols, breaks = c(-2, 26, 27, 28.5, 30, 32))
    text(-33, 40, paste(month.abb[mon[i]]), cex = 1)
    map("world", add = T, col = gray(0.5)); box()
```

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```

contour(lon, lat, sst[, , i], levels = c(30), add = T, col = c(2), lwd = 2, drawlabels =
contour(lon, lat, sst[, , i], levels = c(28.5), add = T, col = 1, lwd = 2, drawlabels =
}
}

```



Looking at the set of plots on the left side (low abundance years) versus the right side (high abundance years), there seems to be a particularly notable pattern with respect to temperatures in the range of 28.5° - 30° Celsius. In the low abundance years, temperatures in this range are distributed in a band across the Atlantic near the equator. In the high abundance years, waters near the equator are much cooler and

the 28.5° - 30° temperatures appear to be concentrated in a very small area near the Florida Keys. This pattern seems most prominent in the months of May and June.

15.3 May temperature distributions

We will take a closer look at May temperature distributions across the Atlantic for the full time series. Here we display all of the May temperatures from 1990 to present, ordered from lowest to highest years of recreational catch in the U.S. South Atlantic.

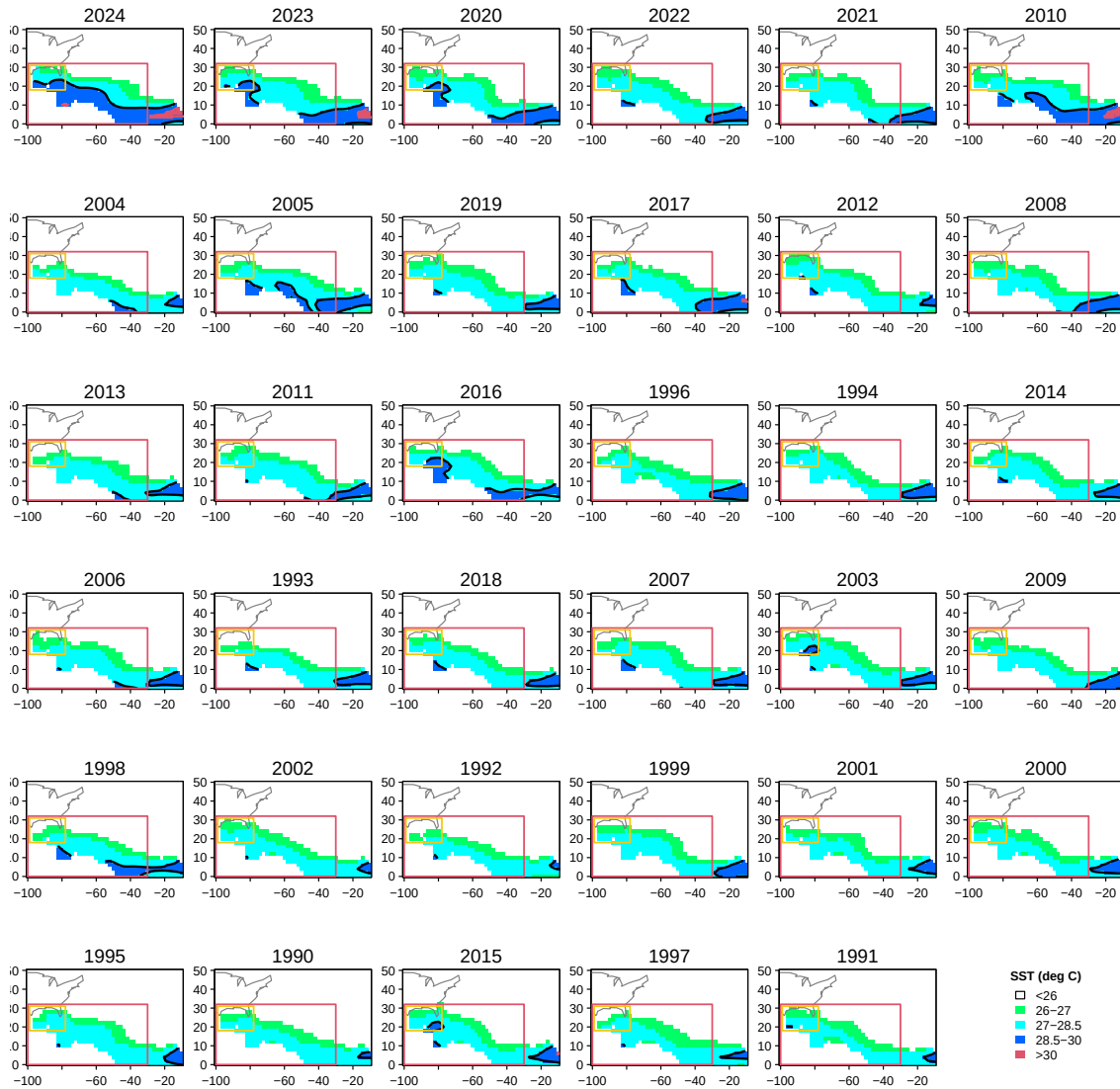
```
# look at May patterns -----

par(mfrow = c(6, 6), mex = 0.5, mar = c(2, 2, 2, 0))

for (j in 1: length(sortyr)) {
  k <- which(yr == sortyr[j])
  for (i in k[5]) {
    map("world", xlim = c(-100, -10), ylim = c(0, 50), col = 0)
    axis(1); axis(2, las = 2); box()
    image(lon, lat, sst[, , i], add = T, col = cols, breaks = c(-2, 26, 27, 28.5, 30, 32))
    map("usa", add = T, col = gray(0.5)); box()
    mtext(side = 3, line = 0.5, sortyr[j])
    contour(lon, lat, sst[, , i], levels = c(30), add = T, col = c(2), lwd = 2, drawlabels = F)
    contour(lon, lat, sst[, , i], levels = c(28.5), add = T, col = 1, lwd = 2, drawlabels = F)
    rect(-100, 0, -30, 32, col = NA, border = 2, lwd = 1.5)
    rect(-99, 18, -78, 31, col = NA, border = 7, lwd = 1.5)
  }
}

par(mar = c(0, 0, 0, 0))
plot(1, type = "n", axes = FALSE, xlab = "", ylab = "")
legend("center", fill = cols, c("<26", "26-27", "27-28.5", "28.5-30", ">30"),
      border = c(1, 0, 0, 0, 0),
      pt.cex = 2, bty = "n",
      title = "SST (deg C)", title.font = 2)
```

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The pattern with 28.5° - 30° C waters seems to hold across all years, with low abundance years (top) tending to have these waters distributed across the Atlantic, and high abundance years (bottom) tending to have these waters restricted to a small area near the Gulf and U.S. South Atlantic.

15.4 Quantifying the temperature distribution in an index

We can attempt to quantify these patterns in an index by calculating a proportion of waters covered by the dark blue water mass. It seems most useful to consider the coverage of this water mass that occurs in U.S. South Atlantic waters (approximately the yellow box; 100°W-78°W and 18°N-32°N) versus the coverage of this water mass in the larger North Atlantic region (the larger red box; 100°W-30°W and 0°-32°N). We first calculate the number of cells in which these 28.5° - 30° C waters occur in each box, and then divide to obtain an overall proportion.

```
# calculate proportion of 28.5 - 30 degree C waters in US South Atlantic waters
```

```
# subset the temperature data to 100W - 30W and 0N - 32N
```

```
lons <- which(lon >= (-100) & lon <= (-30))
```

```
lats <- which(lat >= (0) & lat <= (32))
```

```
lon[lons]
```

```
[1] -100 -98 -96 -94 -92 -90 -88 -86 -84 -82 -80 -78 -76 -74 -
72
[16] -70 -68 -66 -64 -62 -60 -58 -56 -54 -52 -50 -48 -46 -44 -
42
[31] -40 -38 -36 -34 -32 -30
```

```
lat[lats]
```

```
[1] 0 2 4 6 8 10 12 14 16 18 20 22 24 26 28 30 32
```

```
# find indexing for 100W - 78W and 18N - 32N
```

```
lonind <- which(lon[lons] <= (-78) & lon[lons] >= (-100))
```

```
latind <- which(lat[lats] <= 32 & lat[lats] >= 18)
```

```
# subset SST data for all May months
```

```
kar <- sst[lons, lats, which(mon == 5)]
```

```
# create empty data frame
```

```
ind <- data.frame(matrix(ncol = 2, nrow = dim(kar)[3],
                        dimnames = list(NULL, c("Year", "perar"))))
```

```
ind$Year <- yr[which(mon == 5)]
```

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```
# for each year, identify SST cells between 28.5 and 30 degrees
# calculate the proportion of those waters within the small box out of the large box
for (i in 1:dim(kar)[3]) {
  k1 <- kar[, , i]
  k2 <- (k1 >28.5 & k1 < 30.0)
  ind$perar[i] <- length(which(k2[lonind, latind] == TRUE))/ length(which(k2 == TRUE))
}

# replace NA values with zero
ind$perar[which(is.na(ind$perar))] <- 0
ind
```

	Year	perar
1	1980	0.4000000
2	1981	0.0000000
3	1982	0.0000000
4	1983	0.0000000
5	1984	0.0000000
6	1985	0.0000000
7	1986	0.0000000
8	1987	0.0000000
9	1988	0.0000000
10	1989	0.0000000
11	1990	0.0000000
12	1991	1.0000000
13	1992	0.0000000
14	1993	0.0000000
15	1994	0.0000000
16	1995	0.0000000
17	1996	0.0000000
18	1997	0.0000000
19	1998	0.0000000
20	1999	0.0000000
21	2000	0.0000000
22	2001	0.0000000
23	2002	0.0000000
24	2003	0.9000000
25	2004	0.0000000
26	2005	0.0000000
27	2006	0.0000000

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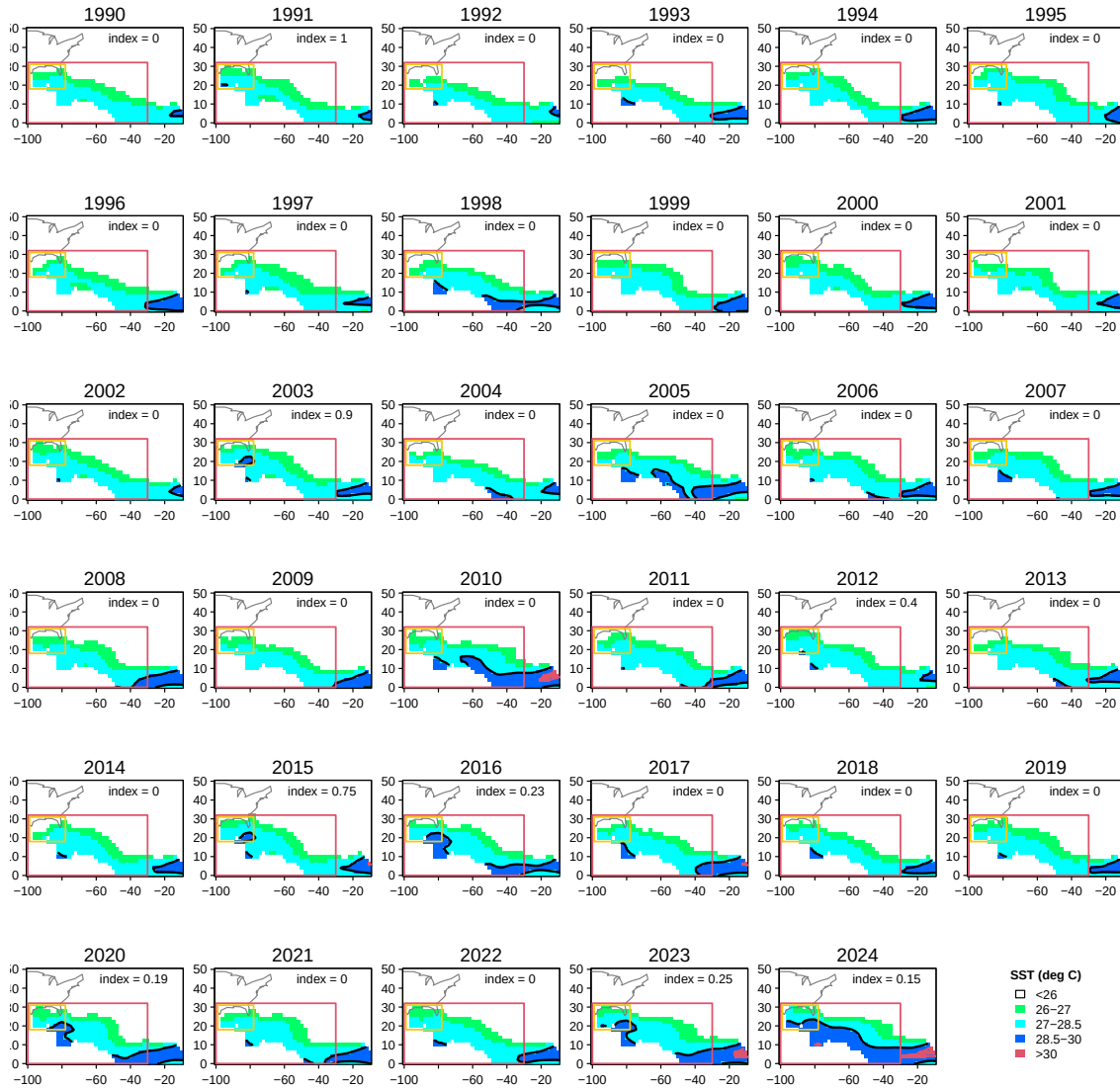
```
28 2007 0.0000000
29 2008 0.0000000
30 2009 0.0000000
31 2010 0.0000000
32 2011 0.0000000
33 2012 0.4000000
34 2013 0.0000000
35 2014 0.0000000
36 2015 0.7500000
37 2016 0.2343750
38 2017 0.0000000
39 2018 0.0000000
40 2019 0.0000000
41 2020 0.1929825
42 2021 0.0000000
43 2022 0.0000000
44 2023 0.2500000
45 2024 0.1538462
46 2025 0.2500000
```

```
yrs <- sortyr[order(sortyr)]

par(mfrow = c(6, 6), mex = 0.5, mar = c(2, 2, 2, 0))
for (j in 1:length(yrs)) {
  k <- which(yr == yrs[j])
  for (i in k[5]) {
    map("world", xlim = c(-100, -10), ylim = c(0, 50), col = 0)
    axis(1); axis(2, las = 2); box()
    image(lon, lat, sst[, , i], add = T, col = cols, breaks = c(-2, 26, 27, 28.5, 30, 32))
    map("usa", add = T, col = gray(0.5)); box()
    mtext(side = 3, line = 0.5, yrs[j])
    text(-38, 45, paste("index =", round(ind$perar[which(ind$Year == yrs[j])], 2)))
    contour(lon, lat, sst[, , i], levels = c(30), add = T, col = c(2), lwd = 2, drawlabels = F)
    contour(lon, lat, sst[, , i], levels = c(28.5), add = T, col = 1, lwd = 2, drawlabels = F)
    rect(-100, 0, -30, 32, col = NA, border = 2, lwd = 1.5)
    rect(-99, 18, -78, 31, col = NA, border = 7, lwd = 1.5)
  }
}
par(mar = c(0, 0, 0, 0))
plot(1, type = "n", axes = FALSE, xlab = "", ylab = "")
legend("center", fill = cols, c("<26", "26-27", "27-28.5", "28.5-30", ">30"),
```

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```
border = c(1, 0, 0, 0, 0),
pt.cex = 2, bty = "n",
title = "SST (deg C)", title.font = 2)
```



To ensure correct calculation of the index we re-display the May temperature patterns in chronological order and note the index value on each plot.

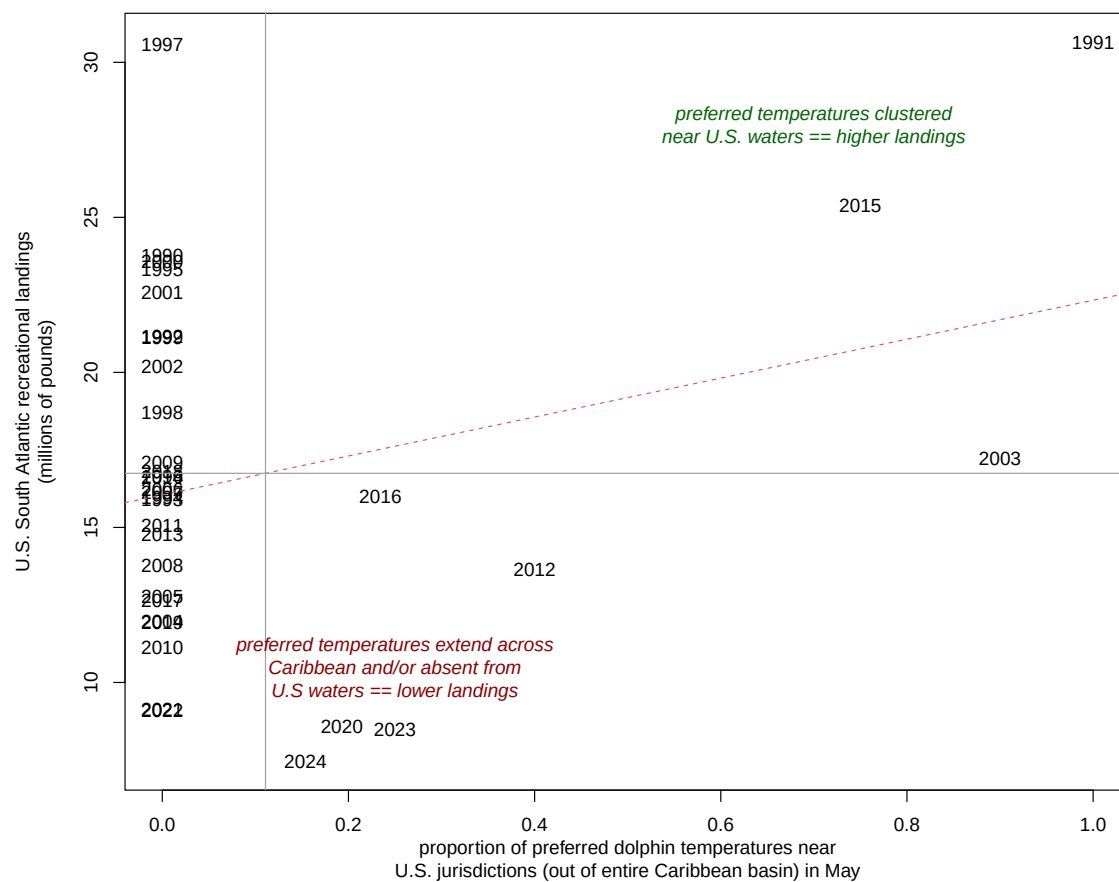
15.5 Comparison of “blue blob” index with landings

Now we plot the “blue blob” index against the recreational landings.

```
# merge new index with landings data
d <- merge(rec, ind, by = "Year")
#head(d)

# plot the "blue blob" index against recreational landings
par(mar = c(5, 5, 1, 1))
plot(d$perar, d$ATL/10^6, col = 0,
      xlab = "proportion of preferred dolphin temperatures near\nU.S. jurisdictions (out of",
      ylab = "U.S. South Atlantic recreational landings\n(millions of pounds)")
text(d$perar, d$ATL/10^6, d$Year)
out <- lm(d$ATL/10^6 ~ d$perar)
abline(out, lty = 2, col = 2)
abline(v = mean(d$perar), col = 8)
abline(h = mean(d$ATL)/10^6, col = 8)
text(0.7, 28, "preferred temperatures clustered\nnear U.S. waters == higher landings", col = 8)
text(0.25, 10.5, "preferred temperatures extend across\nCaribbean and/or absent from\nU.S w
```

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We can see that a statistical relationship does exist, whereby above average “blue blob” index values are associated with above average recreational landings in U.S. South Atlantic waters, and below average index values are associated with below average landings. Gray lines denote the mean values for the index and the catch; we see that this relationship holds true for almost all years in the time series.

The “blue blob” index explains about 45% of the variation in the landings in the U.S. South Atlantic.

```
summary(out)
```

Call:

```
lm(formula = d$ATL/10^6 ~ d$perar)
```

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Residuals:

Min	1Q	Median	3Q	Max
-9.5589	-4.1000	-0.0911	4.3782	14.5264

Coefficients:

	Estimate	Std. Error	t value	Pr(> t)
(Intercept)	16.049	1.051	15.276	<2e-16 ***
d\$perar	6.276	3.775	1.663	0.106

Signif. codes: 0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1

Residual standard error: 5.701 on 33 degrees of freedom

Multiple R-squared: 0.07728, Adjusted R-squared: 0.04932

F-statistic: 2.764 on 1 and 33 DF, p-value: 0.1059

```
# output the index
write.csv(ind, file = "indices/blue_blob_index.csv", row.names = F)
```